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RUSSIAN WOMEN
IN ARBITRATION

STUDY

ON APPOINTMENT OF ARBITRATORS IN
RUSSIA-RELATED DISPUTES

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INTRODUCTION

In recent years, the constitution of arbitral tribunals has become an increasingly important issue. The composition of a tribunal affects not only the efficiency of arbitration and the quality of dispute resolution, but also the parties' trust in arbitration as a means of dispute resolution. Against the backdrop of the transformation of the legal landscape in Russia, the changing profile of legal market participants, and increasing attention to issues of transparency, independence, impartiality, and diversity of arbitrators, there is a growing need for a systematic analysis of existing approaches and practices for selecting and appointing arbitrators.

Against this background, the RWA team* conducted a large-scale study aimed at collecting and consolidating information on the approaches to the selection and appointment of arbitrators that have developed in Russia, as well as identifying the significance of certain characteristics – gender, age, and nationality – in this process. The empirical basis of the study consisted of results of the survey of Russian law firms involved in arbitration, as well as the results of the survey and statistical data of Russian and foreign permanent arbitral institutions (PAIs).

The primary objective of the study was to examine approaches to constituting arbitral tribunals in domestic and international Russia-related disputes during the period from 2019 to 2024, from two key perspectives: first, that of counsel representing the parties, and second, that of arbitral institutions, which establish the institutional framework for arbitration and shape trends in its development. Wherever possible, the RWA team analysed the data over time in order to identify both enduring trends and changes in approaches to constituting arbitral tribunals.

Selected findings of the study were presented at an RWA event held under the auspices of the Russian International Arbitration Congress (RIAC) in May 2025. Feedback received during the discussion was taken into account in the preparation of the final text of the study.

We hope that the findings of this study will contribute to the promotion of diversity in arbitration and encourage a more thoughtful and balanced approach to the constitution of arbitral tribunals in disputes connected with Russia.

When referring to or using the results of this study, we kindly ask that they be accompanied by a citation to the original publication.**

Should you have any comments or suggestions after reviewing the study's findings, we would be grateful to receive your feedback by email at: rwa.russianwomenarbitration@gmail.com.

* The project was led by Polina Tulina, RWA Special Projects Coordinator. The study was also prepared by members of the RWA Steering Committee: Anna Avdulova and Margarita Drobyshevskaya.

** Recommended citation format: *Study on Appointment of Arbitrators in Russia-Related Disputes, 2019–2024*. Russian Women in Arbitration (RWA), 2026. Available at: <https://russianwomeninarbitration.ru/study/>.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Arbitration Practice in Russia

- Women are well represented in the field of arbitration, both in Russian law firms and in PAIs. While the gender balance within law firm teams is generally even (with women accounting for approximately half of the team in 70% of respondent firms), the case management teams of nearly all arbitral institutions under study are predominantly composed of women.
- At the leadership level, women are also better represented in PAIs than in law firms. In all arbitral institutions under study, women serve on the collegiate governing bodies responsible for decision-making on matters within their mandate under the arbitration rules, with their share ranging from 14% to 50%, depending on the institution. By contrast, in more than half of the respondent law firms (61%), the partners practicing arbitration are exclusively men.
- Russian law firms are primarily involved in international arbitration: for 73% of the surveyed firms, international disputes make up a significant part of their practice. Among Russian arbitral institutions, most respondents represented parties in proceedings at the International Commercial Arbitration Court at the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of the Russian Federation (ICAC), with 91% of respondent firms reporting experience in cases administered by this institution. Among foreign arbitral institutions, the leading institutions during the period 2019–2024 were LCIA, ICC, HKIAC, PCA, and SCC (listed in descending order of mentions): more than 65% of respondent firms had experience handling disputes administered by these institutions in that period.
- Russian law firms primarily handle commercial disputes (100%) across a wide range of economic sectors, including construction (87%), energy (70%), and banking and finance (74%), as well as corporate disputes (74%). 70% of respondent firms also reported experience in investor-state arbitration.

General Approach to the Constitution of Arbitral Tribunals

- When selecting arbitrators, Russian law firms primarily take into account the arbitrator's area of specialisation, prior experience, reputation and peer recommendations, as well as qualification in the applicable law and legal position on disputed issues. In international disputes, however, the approach of most respondents (around 70%) to arbitrator selection changes: greater importance is attached to factors such as the arbitrator's nationality and place of residence, as well as their political neutrality, driven by the desire of Russian parties to constitute a neutral arbitral tribunal in the current geopolitical context.
- Notably, Russian law firms are actively involved in the appointment of arbitrators: apart from appointing co-arbitrators (party-appointed arbitrators), 74% of respondent firms also participated in the selection and appointment of presiding arbitrators, while 39% were involved in appointing sole arbitrators. This may be explained by the parties' desire to maintain greater control over the constitution of the arbitral tribunal.
- Russian law firms mainly search for arbitrators using arbitral institution lists, including those with user-friendly databases: around 70% of respondents indicated use of this resource. However, firms rely even more heavily on their own experience and peer recommendations in both domestic and international disputes, as indicated by 91% of respondents.
- When selecting arbitrators, respondent firms either always (70%) or, depending on the circumstances (26%), prepare internal lists of candidates. One third of firms (35%) always seek

to ensure that such lists of potential arbitrators are diverse, while almost half (43%) do so occasionally.

- Arbitral institutions also seek to promote diversity in the constitution of arbitral tribunals. This policy is explicitly enshrined in the official documents of some institutions (for example, RAC, HKIAC, and ICC) or implemented by institutions in practice.
- Lists of arbitrators guide appointments not only by law firms but also by arbitral institutions. Some Russian arbitral institutions explicitly provide in their governing documents that arbitrators are selected from the lists run by them. In practice, approximately half of all arbitrators – whether appointed by the parties or by the arbitral institution – are included in at least one of the lists maintained by the institution administering the arbitration.
- Arbitrator lists maintained by arbitral institutions demonstrate a moderate level of female representation (on average, women account for no more than 30% of all arbitrators included in the lists). The highest proportion of women is found in the united recommended lists of arbitrators of Russian arbitral institutions (around 40%), which may be partly explained by the statutory requirement to include retired judges in those lists, as the vast majority of judges in Russia are women.
- From the perspective of arbitrators' nationality, lists maintained by foreign arbitral institutions are more diverse, whereas lists of Russian arbitral institutions consist predominantly of Russian nationals. This may be explained by strict legal requirements applicable to recommended lists of arbitrators, as well as the comparatively smaller share of international disputes handled by Russian arbitral institutions compared with the foreign ones.

Gender as a Factor in the Selection and Appointment of Arbitrators

- Most respondent law firms proposed women as arbitrators: in 2022–2024, 84% of respondents proposed female arbitrator candidates in domestic disputes and 91% in international disputes. Women were proposed as co-arbitrators significantly more often than as presiding or sole arbitrators. Respondents proposed female arbitrators not only in commercial disputes, but also in construction, energy, and investor-state disputes.
- The majority of respondent firms (78%) do not consider the arbitrator's gender to confer any professional advantages, although some respondents noted characteristics associated with female arbitrators such as attention to detail, the ability to listen to both parties, a more balanced and structured approach to proceedings, the ability to "balance" male arbitrators, a more responsible approach to work, and greater diligence in handling documents.
- According to 2019–2024 statistics, men constitute the majority of arbitrators appointed in Russia-related disputes, both in Russian and foreign arbitral institutions. Women are more frequently appointed as sole arbitrators, whereas male arbitrators predominate in multi-member tribunals. Arbitral institutions appoint female arbitrators significantly more often than parties.

Age as a Factor in the Selection and Appointment of Arbitrators

- Most respondent firms are willing to consider young arbitrators for appointment in disputes involving relatively low-value claims: more than half (approximately 60%) of respondents indicated that they would appoint an arbitrator under 35 in domestic disputes valued at up to RUB 10 million and an arbitrator under 40 in international disputes valued at up to USD 10 million, while a further approximately 30% reported that they are rather inclined to do so. The likelihood of appointing young arbitrators decreases as the value of claims increases, in both domestic and international disputes.

- In domestic disputes with claims of up to RUB 100 million and international disputes of up to USD 100 million, arbitrators aged 36–45 were most often considered the most suitable, while in disputes exceeding RUB 100 million and USD 100 million arbitrators aged 46–60 were preferred. None of the respondents indicated an arbitrator under the age of 35 as the most suitable for hearing an international dispute, regardless of the value of the claim. Nevertheless, one third of respondents consider that the arbitrator’s age is not relevant in any type of dispute.
- The majority of respondents (74%) identified advantages associated with young arbitrators under 35–40, including a lighter caseload as arbitrators, greater willingness to apply international standards in domestic disputes, technological proficiency, openness to unconventional approaches, and proactiveness.
- In domestic and international disputes administered by RAC – the only Russian arbitral institution publishing and providing data on the age of appointed arbitrators – the most represented group is arbitrators aged 36–45. Arbitrators under 35 and over 60 are the least represented groups.
- Among foreign arbitral institutions, age-related statistics are published only by ICC and VIAC. In 2019–2024, the average age of arbitrators in all ICC proceedings was 55–57, with arbitrators under 50 accounting for no more than 40% of all appointments. At VIAC, the most common age group is 46–55, while in Russia-related disputes, arbitrators aged 46–60 and over 60 predominated, reflecting a tendency to appoint senior arbitrators in international disputes.

Nationality as a Factor in the Selection and Appointment of Arbitrators

- Foreign arbitrators continue to play a central role in international disputes handled by Russian law firms: all respondent firms appointed foreign arbitrators during the period under study. Data from foreign arbitral institutions also confirm the predominance of foreign arbitrators in Russia-related disputes.
- The influence of geopolitical factors on arbitrator selection is increasing. The vast majority of respondent firms (approximately 90%) take into account the “friendliness” of the state of the arbitrator’s nationality, residence, or place of work. Nevertheless, experience, reputation, and recognised authority within the international arbitration community remain key selection criteria, regardless of the candidate’s connection to any particular country.
- Since 2022, a noticeable expansion in the geographic diversity of foreign arbitrators has been observed. While arbitrators from the United Kingdom (UK) and Europe continue to be widely appointed, interest in candidates from Asia, the Middle East, and Latin America has increased significantly, as reflected both in responses from law firms and in data from arbitral institutions. The trend toward greater geographic diversity of foreign arbitrators is also observed in Russian arbitral institutions, using RAC as an example. Whereas in 2019–2021 foreign arbitrators predominantly came from the UK, European Union (EU), North America, and East Asia, in 2022–2024 this group expanded to include representatives of the CIS, Southeast Asia, and European countries outside the EU.
- More than half of respondent firms proposed Russian arbitrators in international disputes and did so more frequently in 2022–2024 than in 2019–2021. The main reasons for selecting Russian arbitrators include the connection of the dispute to Russia, and the expectation of a better understanding of the specifics of Russian business. Despite the limited number of appointments of Russian arbitrators in foreign arbitral institutions, such appointments have continued throughout the entire period under study. Russian arbitrators are most frequently appointed as co-arbitrators.

1 SELECTION AND APPOINTMENT OF ARBITRATORS FROM THE PERSPECTIVE OF RUSSIAN LAW FIRMS

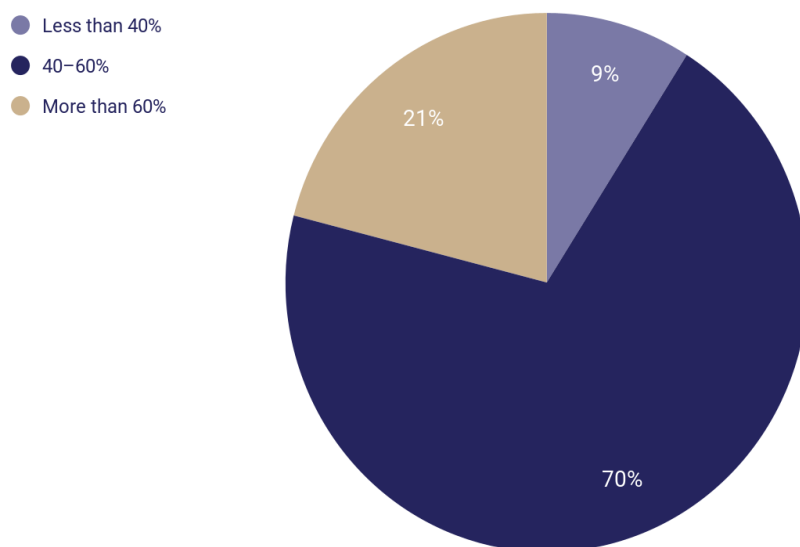
1.1 GENERAL INFORMATION ON THE PRACTICE OF RESPONDENT FIRMS

Before turning to the main part of the study, we sought to develop a profile of a Russian law firm representing clients in arbitral proceedings.¹ Given the confidentiality of projects and the sensitivity of client information, this section summarises data on the composition of respondents' arbitration practices,² the arbitral institutions in which respondents have experience handling disputes, and the categories of disputes forming the core of their practice.

1.1.1 Gender Composition of Respondents' Practices

One of RWA's objectives is to promote gender equality. We are pleased to note that women (regardless of position) are represented in the teams of all respondents, and the vast majority of teams have a broadly balanced gender composition.

Figure 1. Percentage of Women in Respondents' Practices (All Positions)³



At the same time, the number of women in partner positions within respondents' practices is significantly lower than that of men. According to publicly available information, arbitration practices of most respondents are led exclusively by men.⁴ Female partners are represented in fewer than half of the respondents' practices.

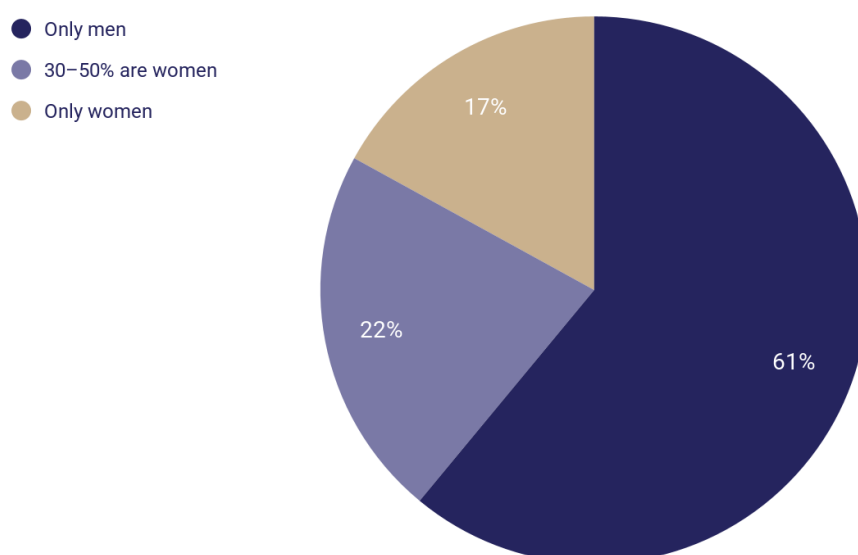
¹ The footnote is omitted in the English version of the study.

² For the avoidance of doubt, and unless otherwise indicated, the term "practice" in this section refers to the respondent's practice handling domestic and international arbitration matters.

³ Based on the findings of the survey carried out in March–April 2025.

⁴ We analysed the lists of partners published on the websites of respondent firms as of January 2026. The calculations are based on practice-area classifications (e.g. "international arbitration", "dispute resolution", etc.) and on references to arbitration as the partner's main area of practice in their profile. The percentage of women was calculated as the ratio of female partners in the international arbitration practice to the total number of partners in that practice. Where a respondent operates as a solo legal practitioner and does not publish team composition, only the gender of the founding partner was taken into account.

Figure 2. Gender Composition of Partners in Respondents' Practices



To date, there is no comprehensive study in Russia that allows for an assessment of the gender balance at partner level overall, and in the field of arbitration in particular. According to a study published by Pravo.ru in 2020, women accounted for 26% of partners in Russian law firms.⁵ The study does not provide data specifically on partners practicing arbitration. However, it is noteworthy that “arbitrazh (commercial) litigation” (representation of clients before commercial (arbitrazh) courts in Russia) is listed among the practice areas with the lowest proportion of female partners: women account for only 15% of the total number of partners working in this practice.

The above data indicate that the representation of women at partner level in Russia is lower than at junior levels. However, this conclusion is not unique to the legal market. For example, as of 2023, approximately 28% of partners in all U.S. law firms were women, whereas the gender distribution at associate level was close to parity.⁶ A similar trend is also observed in the English legal market.⁷

1.1.2 Geography of Disputes in Respondents' Practice

All respondents represent clients in international disputes,⁸ with the majority primarily handling international disputes.

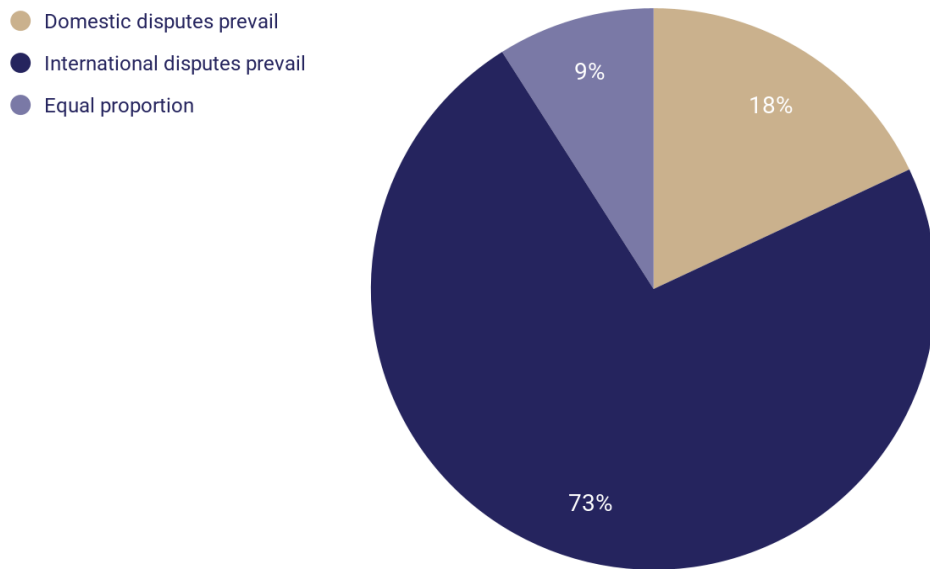
⁵ “Women in Law: Stereotypes, Barriers, and Successes”, Pravo.ru, 6 March 2020, available [here](#) (in Russian).

⁶ “2023 Report on Diversity in U.S. Law Firms”, National Association for Law Placement, 2024, available [here](#).

⁷ “Diversity in law firms’ workforce”, Solicitors Regulation Authority, 11 March 2026, available [here](#).

⁸ Although one respondent chose not to answer this question, its team’s involvement in international disputes is indicated in publicly available sources. At the same time, we take the respondent’s preference to refrain from answering certain questions into account in the subsequent analysis.

Figure 3. Ratio of Domestic and International Disputes in Respondents' Practice



RIAC 2025 Highlight

For Russian law firms, arbitration is predominantly an international practice. One factor that may explain this market structure is the common approach of entrusting domestic arbitration disputes to in-house legal departments rather than instructing external counsel.

In 2019–2024, the vast majority of respondent firms handled disputes administered by ICAC.⁹ Other Russian arbitral institutions – RAC¹⁰ and Arbitration Centre at RSPP¹¹ – were mentioned by respondents three times less frequently, while MAC¹² appeared five times less frequently.

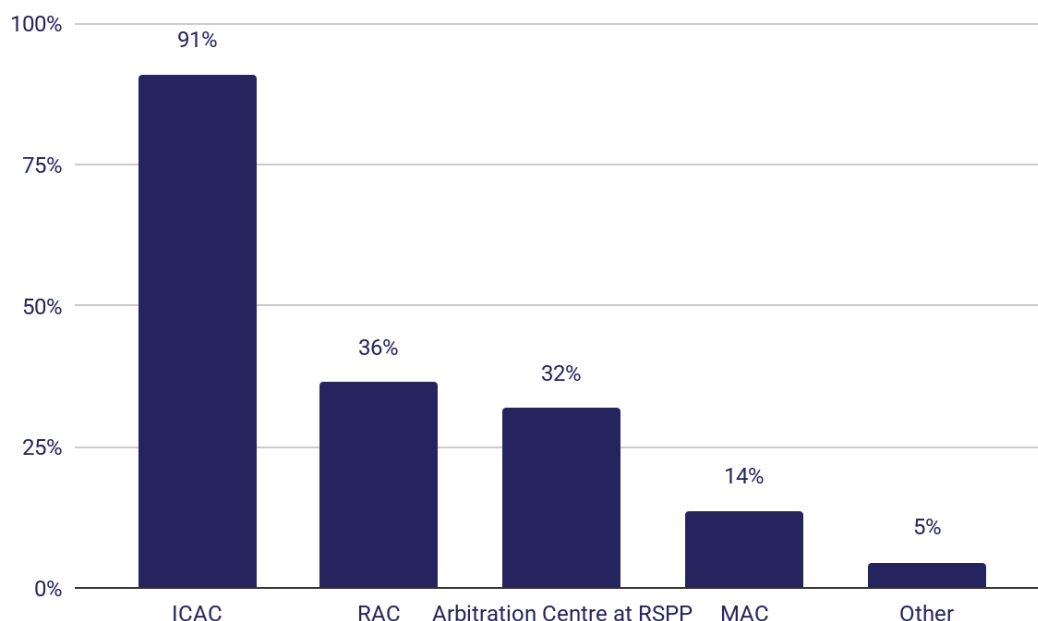
⁹ International Commercial Arbitration Court at the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of the Russian Federation (ICAC) is one of the oldest arbitral institutions in Russia. ICAC is “the successor to Foreign Trade Arbitration Commission which was created in 1932”. More information is available on the [website](#).

¹⁰ Russian Arbitration Center (RAC) is a subdivision of the Russian Institute of Modern Arbitration (RIMA), “whose activities are aimed at developing and popularising arbitration in Russia, as well as increasing the attractiveness of Russian jurisdiction as a place of doing business and a place for resolving civil disputes”. More information is available on the [website](#).

¹¹ “Arbitration Centre at RSPP was established under the Russian Union of Industrialists and Entrepreneurs (RSPP), a nationwide public organisation that has served since 1991 as an open platform for dialogue between business and government and represents the interests of the business community in Russia and internationally”. More information is available on the [website](#).

¹² Maritime Arbitration Commission at the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of the Russian Federation (MAC) was established in 1930 and “now ranks among the world’s oldest maritime arbitration institutions”. More information is available on the [website](#).

Figure 4. Share of Respondents Who Handled Disputes in Russian Arbitral Institutions¹³



Among foreign arbitral institutions administering respondents' disputes, LCIA¹⁴ held the leading position during the 2019–2024 period. ICC¹⁵ ranked second, while HKIAC,¹⁶ PCA,¹⁷ and SCC¹⁸ shared third place in terms of the number of mentions.

The least commonly used fora were specialised (industry-specific) arbitration under the rules of GAFTA,¹⁹ FOSFA,²⁰ and LMAA,²¹ as well as arbitration administered by CIETAC²² and ICA CCI KR,²³ which are selected less frequently by Russian parties.

¹³ One respondent chose not to answer.

¹⁴ London Court of International Arbitration. More information is available on the [website](#).

¹⁵ ICC International Court of Arbitration. The institution's headquarters are located in Paris, France. It has held the status of a PAI in Russia since 2021. More information is available on the [website](#).

¹⁶ Hong Kong International Arbitration Centre. It has held the status of a PAI in Russia since 2019. More information is available on the [website](#).

¹⁷ Permanent Court of Arbitration. The institution's headquarters are located in The Hague, the Netherlands. More information is available on the [website](#).

¹⁸ SCC Arbitration Institute. More information is available on the [website](#).

¹⁹ Grain and Feed Trade Association. More information is available on the [website](#).

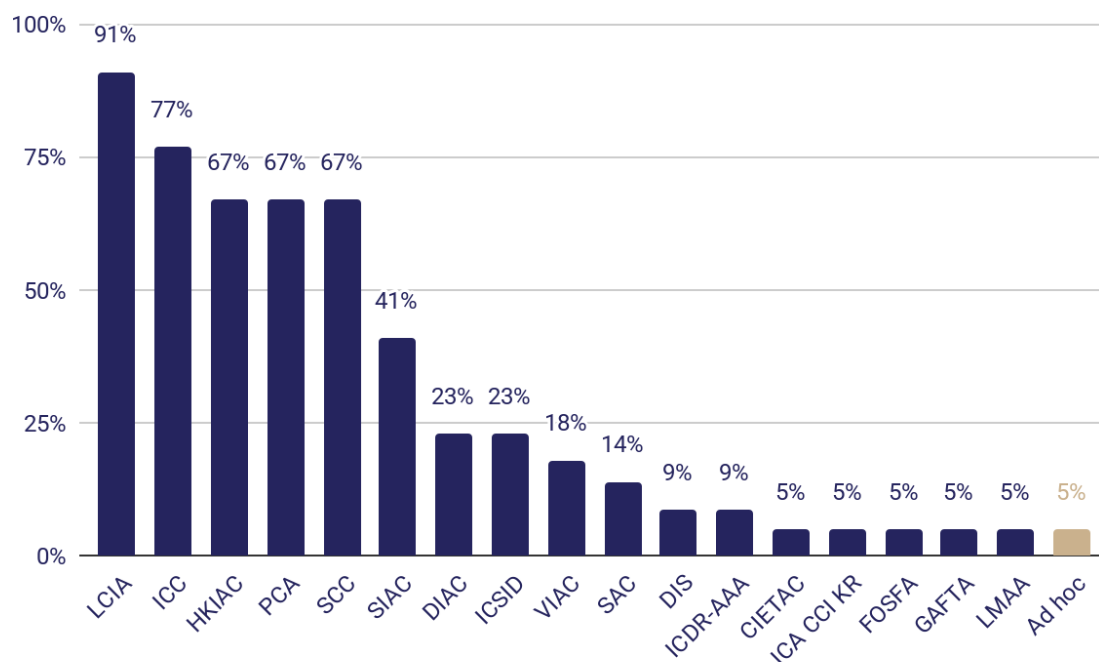
²⁰ Federation of Oils, Seeds and Fats Associations. More information is available on the [website](#).

²¹ London Maritime Arbitrators Association. More information is available on the [website](#).

²² China International Economic and Trade Arbitration Commission. More information is available on the [website](#).

²³ International Court of Arbitration in affiliation with the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of the Kyrgyz Republic. More information is available on the [website](#).

Figure 5. Share of Respondents Who Handled Disputes in Foreign Arbitral Institutions and under Rules of International Sector-Specific Associations²⁴



The RWA team did not ask respondents to provide the total number of disputes handled before any particular arbitral institution, either overall or over time. Accordingly, references to Russian and foreign arbitral institutions are intended solely to illustrate the diversity of respondents' experience in handling international disputes during the period from 2019 to 2024.

Nevertheless, RWA's findings are broadly consistent with the results of the study "The Most Popular Arbitral Institutions Among Russian Users" conducted by Pravo.ru.²⁵ According to the Pravo.ru study, between August 2023 and August 2025 Russian law firms were involved in the largest number of disputes administered by LCIA (74), ICAC and ICC (63 each), SCC (35), SIAC²⁶ (33), and HKIAC (30). In terms of the aggregate value of disputes, the leading institutions were LCIA (USD 37.5 billion), ICC (USD 37 billion), and SIAC (USD 17.4 billion).

Notably, according to the results of our study, HKIAC was the only arbitral institution located outside the "traditional" arbitration jurisdictions (Europe and the UK) to rank among the top three most frequently mentioned institutions by respondents.

²⁴ One respondent chose not to answer.

²⁵ "The Most Popular Arbitral Institutions Among Russian Users", Pravo.ru, 2025, available [here](#) (in Russian).

²⁶ Singapore International Arbitration Centre. It has held the status of a PAI in Russia since 2021. More information is available on the [website](#).

Figure 6. Frequency of Respondents' References to Foreign Arbitral Institutions and International Sector-Specific Associations (by Location of Their Principal Office or Headquarters)

UK		Europe		Asia	
LCIA	91%	ICC	77%	HKIAC	67%
GAFTA	5%	PCA	67%	SIAC	41%
FOSFA	5%	SCC	67%	CIETAC	5%
LMAA	5%	VIAC	18%		
		SAC	14%	North America	
Middle East		DIS	9%	ICSID	23%
DIAC	23%			ICDR-AAA	9%
		CIS			
		ICA CCI KR	5%		

It is important to note that, since 2022, Russian parties have increasingly been moving away from selecting Western arbitral institutions and are instead turning to alternative venues, primarily in “friendly”²⁷ jurisdictions.²⁸

RIAC 2025 Highlight

Over the next several years, the range of arbitral institutions in which law firms handle disputes involving Russian clients is expected to change significantly, with a greater number of Russia-related cases being administered by institutions based in Asia and the Middle East.

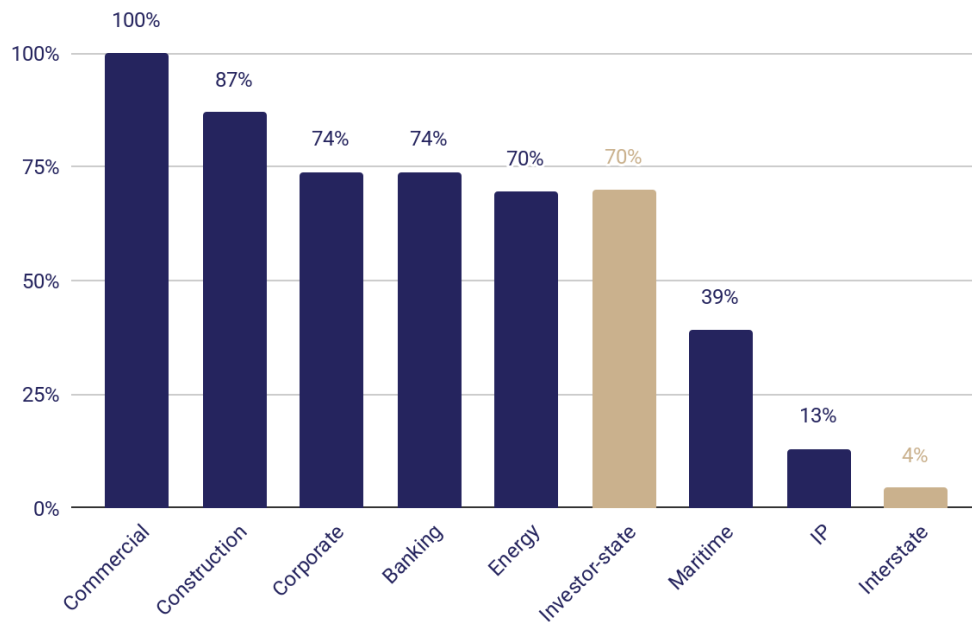
1.1.3 Nature of Disputes in Respondents' Practice

In terms of the nature of disputes, all respondents handled commercial disputes during the period from 2019 to 2024. The vast majority of respondents represented clients in construction, corporate, and banking disputes.

²⁷ In 2022, the Government of the Russian Federation approved a list of foreign states and territories that commit unfriendly actions against the Russian Federation, Russian legal entities, and individuals. The list includes Australia, Albania, Andorra, the Bahamas, the UK (including the Crown Dependencies and British Overseas Territories), the Member States of the European Union, Iceland, Canada, Liechtenstein, Micronesia, Monaco, New Zealand, Norway, the Republic of Korea, San Marino, North Macedonia, Singapore, the United States of America, Taiwan (China), Ukraine, Montenegro, Switzerland, and Japan, available [here](#) (in Russian).

²⁸ See, for example, “10 Trends in International Arbitration: Findings from a Study of the International Commercial Arbitration (ICA) Market in Russia”, Pravo.ru, 2025, available [here](#) (in Russian).

Figure 7. Nature of Disputes Handled by Respondents (by Frequency of Mention by Respondents)



The high proportion of corporate disputes in respondents' practice correlates with the findings of a study on M&A transactions in Russia. According to this study, in 77% of M&A transactions concluded in 2022–2024 the parties preferred arbitration rather than state courts as the dispute resolution forum.²⁹ A similar trend is observed in corporate agreements, where an arbitration agreement was included in 83% of cases.³⁰

Notably, there is also a significant share of references to investor-state disputes, as well as the presence of interstate disputes in respondents' practice. This finding is consistent with the frequent mention of PCA as an administering arbitral institution in respondents' responses (see [Figure 5](#) above). PCA traditionally administers disputes involving states, intergovernmental organisations, and state-controlled entities. According to PCA's annual reports for 2019–2024, public international law disputes (investor-states and interstate disputes) accounted for between 50% and 65% in different years.³¹

²⁹ "Study of M&A Transactions in Russia for 2022–2024", prepared jointly by ALRUD, KKMP, Nikolskaya Consulting, Orion, Stonebridge Legal, Mansors, and Melling, Voitishkin & Partners, p. 13, available [here](#) (in Russian).

³⁰ Ibid., p. 43.

³¹ PCA Annual Reports are available [here](#).

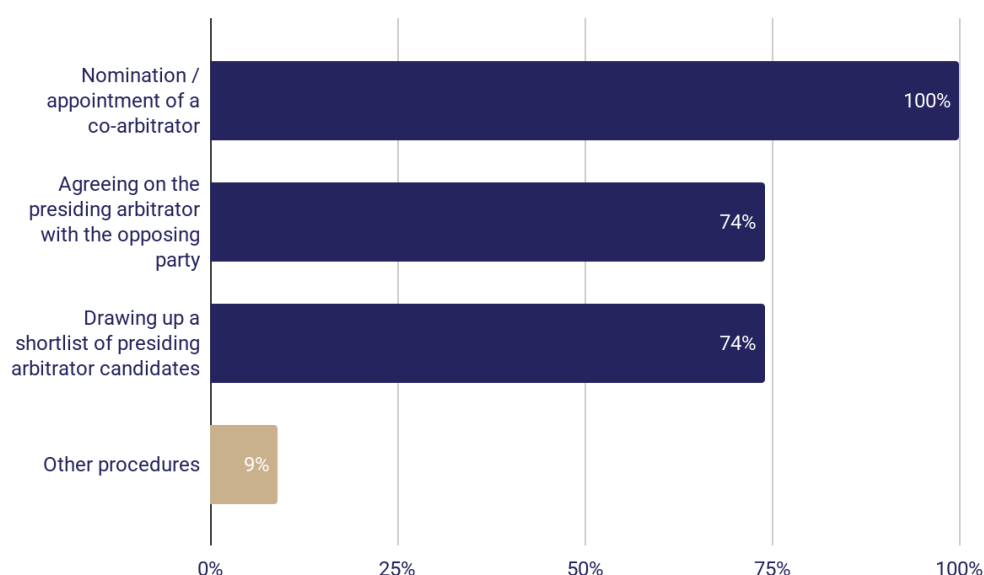
1.2 APPROACHES OF RESPONDENT FIRMS TO THE CONSTITUTION OF THE ARBITRAL TRIBUNAL

We asked respondents to indicate their general approach to the constitution of arbitral tribunals, including their involvement in the selection and appointment³² of arbitrators, the procedures used, and the criteria applied.

1.2.1 Procedures Used by Respondents in the Selection and Appointment of Arbitrators

All respondents participated in the formation of a multi-member tribunal through the selection and appointment of co-arbitrators. It appears that resolution of a dispute by a panel of arbitrators (typically consisting of three arbitrators) is the preferred option for Russian parties.³³

Figure 8. Participation of Respondents in the Constitution of the Multi-Member Tribunal (by Frequency of Mention by Respondents)



Most respondents participated in the selection and appointment of the presiding arbitrator by agreeing on a candidate directly with the opposing party or by drawing up a shortlist of candidates for subsequent appointment by the arbitral institution. Several respondent firms (9%) also took part in other procedures for appointing the presiding arbitrator, namely:

- agreed on the candidate for presiding arbitrator with the co-arbitrator appointed by them;
- requested that the arbitral institution appoint the presiding arbitrator meeting specific criteria;
- participated in a list procedure in which a list of candidates was prepared by the arbitral institution and circulated to the parties for ranking and elimination of unsuitable candidates; or

³² For the purposes of the survey, respondents were informed that “selection and appointment” of arbitrators refers to “the direct appointment of an arbitrator or advising the client on a suitable arbitrator candidate”, so as to capture the widest possible range of situations in which respondents considered appointing a particular arbitrator. Accordingly, the terms “selection”, “appointment”, and “nomination” were used in different questions throughout the questionnaire, depending on the context. It should be noted, however, that arbitral rules may use this terminology differently and, for example, distinguish between the “selection” or “nomination” of an arbitrator by a party and the “appointment” carried out by the competent authority of an arbitral institution, both in cases where the parties have made a nomination and where they have not.

³³ See, for example, “The Ideal Arbitrator: Who They Are and How to Choose Them”, Pravo.ru, 8 October 2025, available [here](#) (in Russian) (the article notes that the “classic” model involves the appointment of three arbitrators).

- nominated a candidate for subsequent appointment by the appointing authority.

This level of party involvement in the selection and appointment of the presiding arbitrator may be considered relatively high, as, normally, the presiding arbitrator is appointed either by the arbitral institution administering the dispute or by two co-arbitrators without the participation of the parties.³⁴

Nearly one third of respondents (39%) also participated in the appointment of a sole arbitrator, either by agreeing on a candidate with the opposing party or by taking part in a list procedure.

It is noteworthy that 17% of respondents agreed on a shortlist of arbitrator candidates already at the stage of concluding the arbitration agreement, rather than at the time the dispute arose, which departs from standard practice.

RIAC 2025 Highlight

In the current geopolitical context, Russian parties seek greater control over the arbitrator appointment process and therefore more frequently agree on list procedures for the appointment of a presiding arbitrator or a sole arbitrator. This preference may also explain the agreement on arbitrator candidates at the contract drafting stage in individual cases.

1.2.2 Criteria Used by Respondents in the Selection of Arbitrators

The most important criterion guiding respondents in the selection of an arbitrator is his or her specialisation in the subject matter of the dispute, a factor selected by all respondents. Other important characteristics influencing arbitrator selection include (in order of importance): (1) the arbitrator's legal position on issues raised in the dispute, (2) his or her standing within the arbitration community, (3) prior experience as an arbitrator, and (4) peer recommendations.

One quarter of respondents noted that the relevance of these criteria depends on the nature of the dispute.

Figure 9. Criteria Influencing Respondents' Selection of Arbitrators

Characteristic	Frequency of Mention ³⁵	Aggregate Ranking Score ³⁶
Specialisation in the subject matter of the dispute	100%	38
Prior experience as an arbitrator	96%	34
Standing within the arbitration community	91%	34
Qualification in the applicable law	91%	13
Peer recommendations	87%	28
Legal position on issues raised in the dispute	87%	37
Nationality (citizenship)	83%	9
Language	83%	1
Statements at public events or on social media	83%	22

³⁴ See, for example, Article 16(7) of the Rules of Arbitration of International Commercial Disputes of ICAC.

³⁵ This column presents the responses of respondents to Question 10 of the questionnaire, in which they were asked to select an unlimited number of characteristics from a list of 24 options and, if desired, to provide additional characteristics of their own (see [Appendix 1](#)). The percentage shown in this column reflects the share of respondents who selected or indicated the relevant characteristic.

³⁶ This column presents the responses of respondents to Question 11 of the questionnaire, in which they were asked to select the five most important characteristics of a prospective arbitrator affecting the likelihood of their appointment, and to rank them from least important (1) to most important (5) (see [Appendix 1](#)). The score shown in this column represents the sum of the weights assigned to each characteristic by all respondents.

Political views	83%	19
Arbitrator workload	78%	7
Client instructions	78%	15
Personal contact with the arbitrator candidate	78%	25
Origin	74%	0
Education	70%	0
Age	61%	0
Place of residence	57%	0
Prior experience with applicable institutional rules	48%	2
Academic experience	43%	4
Gender	39%	0
Prior experience as counsel or in-house lawyer	35%	0
Availability for a pre-appointment interview	35%	5
Membership in legal associations or professional communities	26%	0
Other (ability to defend their position in discussions with co-arbitrators)	4%	4
Other (common sense)	4%	3

Thus, for respondents, the most important factors are, first and foremost, the arbitrator's professional qualities and reputation within the professional community, rather than formal characteristics.

This finding is also consistent with the approach of foreign practitioners to arbitrator selection. According to the international study by Cortex Capital, which involved hundreds of arbitration professionals worldwide, the most important factors influencing arbitrator selection likewise include subject matter expertise, prior personal experience interacting with the arbitrator, the candidate's experience as an arbitrator, legal qualifications, and positive peer recommendations.³⁷

At the same time, the majority of respondents in our survey (approximately 70%) noted that their approach to arbitrator selection varies depending on whether the dispute is domestic or international:

- almost all respondents indicated that in international disputes, the arbitrator's nationality, origin, and place of residence become more important, as do political views and public statements, in order to ensure the appointment of a neutral arbitrator;
- some respondents noted that in international disputes greater importance is attached to foreign language proficiency, qualifications in the law governing the dispute, experience in international arbitration, and international reputation;
- one respondent noted that in domestic disputes, personal contact with the arbitrator candidate becomes more important.

Thus, for Russian parties in international disputes, unsurprisingly, the political neutrality of the arbitrator currently plays a significant role. These findings are also supported by other analytical materials published in recent years.³⁸

It is interesting to note that Russian practitioners did not previously place such emphasis on arbitrators' nationality, origin, or political views. In the 2017 survey by the Russian Arbitration Association (RAA) on arbitrator appointment, respondents were also asked which criteria are most important in arbitrator selection, and none explicitly mentioned these characteristics. Just over 30% of the RAA survey

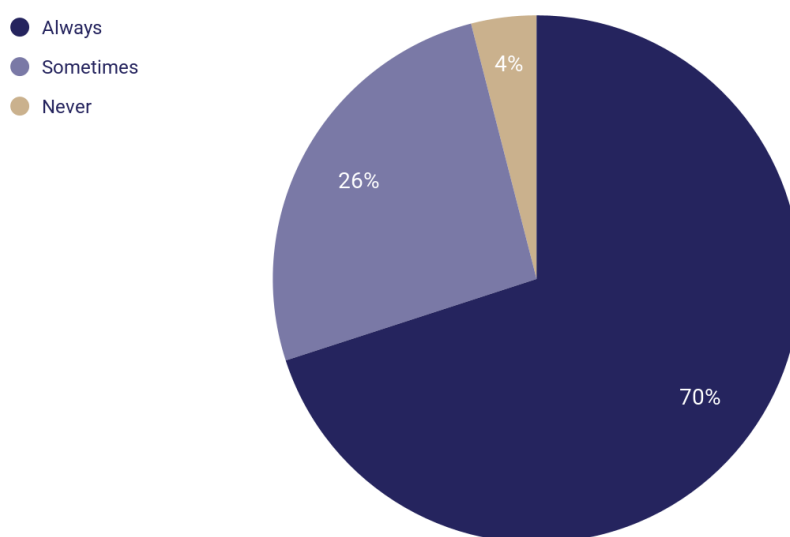
³⁷ "The usual suspects: decision-making in arbitrator selection", Cortex Capital, October 2023, p. 18, available [here](#).

³⁸ See, for example, "The Ideal Arbitrator: Who They Are and How to Choose Them", Pravo.ru, 8 October 2025, available [here](#) (in Russian).

respondents noted that it is important for the arbitrator’s “views” to generally align with the party’s case strategy, while only around 5% specifically highlighted the importance of arbitrator’s independence and impartiality.³⁹

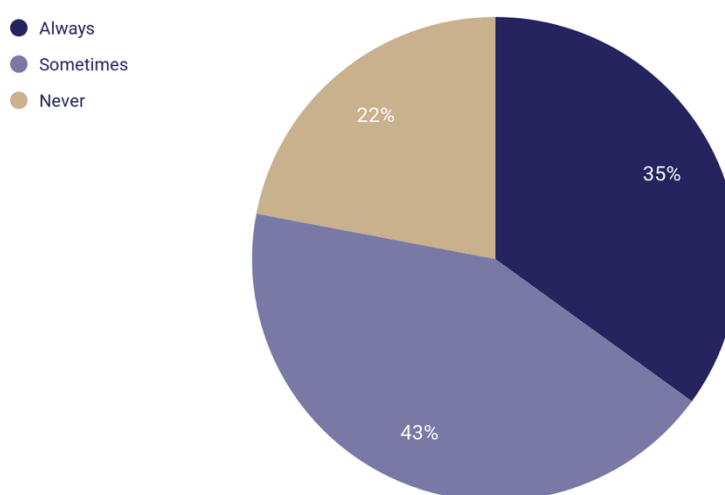
The vast majority of respondents always prepare an internal shortlist of arbitrator candidates, supported by a detailed analysis of their experience.

Figure 10. Preparation of an Internal Shortlist of Candidates by Respondents, Including Analysis of Their Experience



When preparing such a shortlist of candidates, one third of respondents seek to ensure diversity in terms of gender, age, or nationality, while almost half do so depending on the size or nature of the dispute.

Figure 11. Respondents’ Efforts to Ensure Diversity When Preparing an Internal Shortlist of Candidates



These findings are consistent with international practice. According to the Cortex Capital study, 83% of respondents to some extent seek to promote diversity, for example by reviewing their shortlists to

³⁹ “Russian Arbitration Association (RAA) Survey 2017: Women’s Participation in Arbitration as Arbitrators”, RAA, 2017, pp. 14, 30, available [here](#) (in Russian).

ensure the inclusion of arbitrators of different genders, ages, and nationalities.⁴⁰ As the authors of the study note, if diversity is not considered at all in the selection process, the pool of candidates ultimately becomes narrow and homogeneous, and less conventional candidates have fewer opportunities to be included on the list.⁴¹

The 2021 International Arbitration Survey published by Queen Mary University of London (QMUL) and White & Case also confirms that practitioners' efforts to prepare diverse shortlists of arbitrator candidates are regarded as one of the most effective ways to promote diversity.⁴² However, the study notes that the final selection of an arbitrator is often made by the client, and clients are not always willing to consider new candidates with whom they are relatively unfamiliar; it is therefore important that both counsel and in-house lawyers equally strive to promote diversity in the selection and appointment of arbitrators.

In this regard, it is worth noting the Equal Representation in Arbitration – Pledge (ERA Pledge),⁴³ whose supporters commit to taking measures to increase the number of female arbitrators. By signing the ERA Pledge, practitioners commit, *inter alia*, to ensuring, where possible, a fair representation of female arbitrators when selecting candidates for appointment, as well as when preparing shortlists of potential arbitrator candidates. The ERA Pledge now has more than 6,000 signatories, including law firms, companies, arbitral institutions, and individual practitioners. We are pleased to note that the ERA Pledge has been signed by four Russian law firms, as well as more than fifteen Russian lawyers in their individual capacity.

1.2.3 Resources Used by Respondents in Arbitrator Selection

To identify suitable candidates for appointment in domestic disputes, the majority of respondents rely on their own judgement and peer recommendations, as well as on lists of arbitrators provided by the administering institution or other institutions with a user-friendly arbitrator database. Only one third of respondents rely on legal rankings.

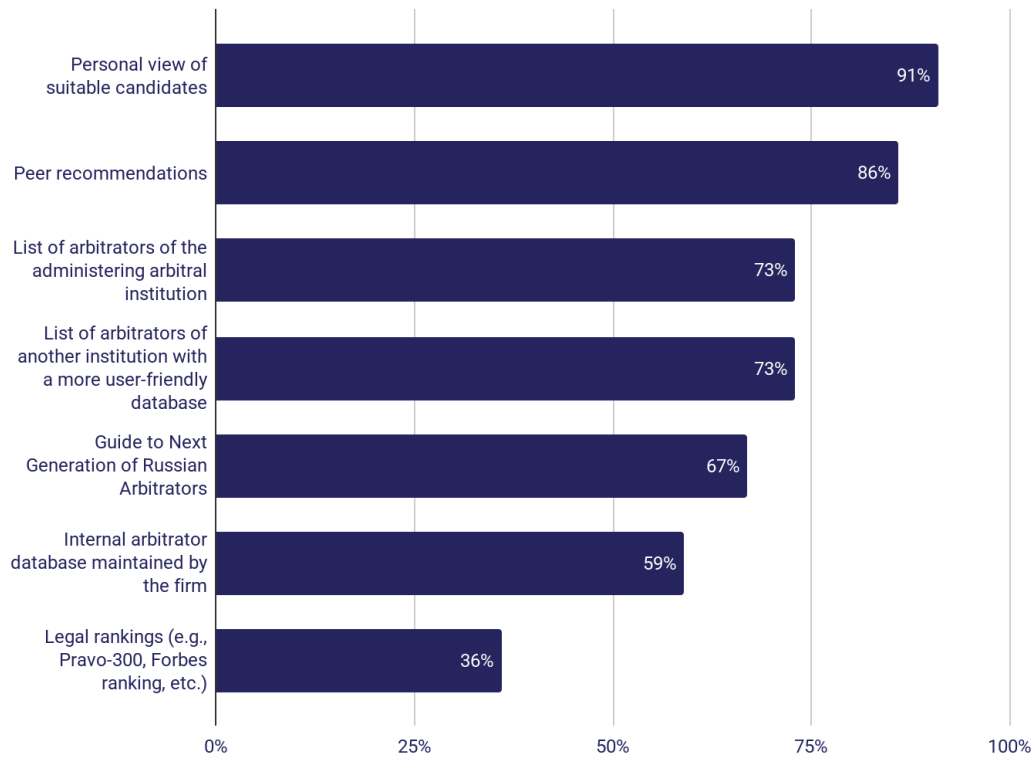
⁴⁰ "The usual suspects: decision-making in arbitrator selection", Cortex Capital, October 2023, p. 27, available [here](#).

⁴¹ *Ibid.*, p. 28.

⁴² "2021 International Arbitration Survey: Adapting arbitration to a changing world", QMUL, White & Case, 2021, p. 18, available [here](#).

⁴³ We analysed the list of signatories as of 1 May 2026. More information about the initiative is available on its [website](#).

Figure 12. Resources Used to Find Arbitrators for Domestic Disputes
(by Frequency of Mention by Respondents)⁴⁴

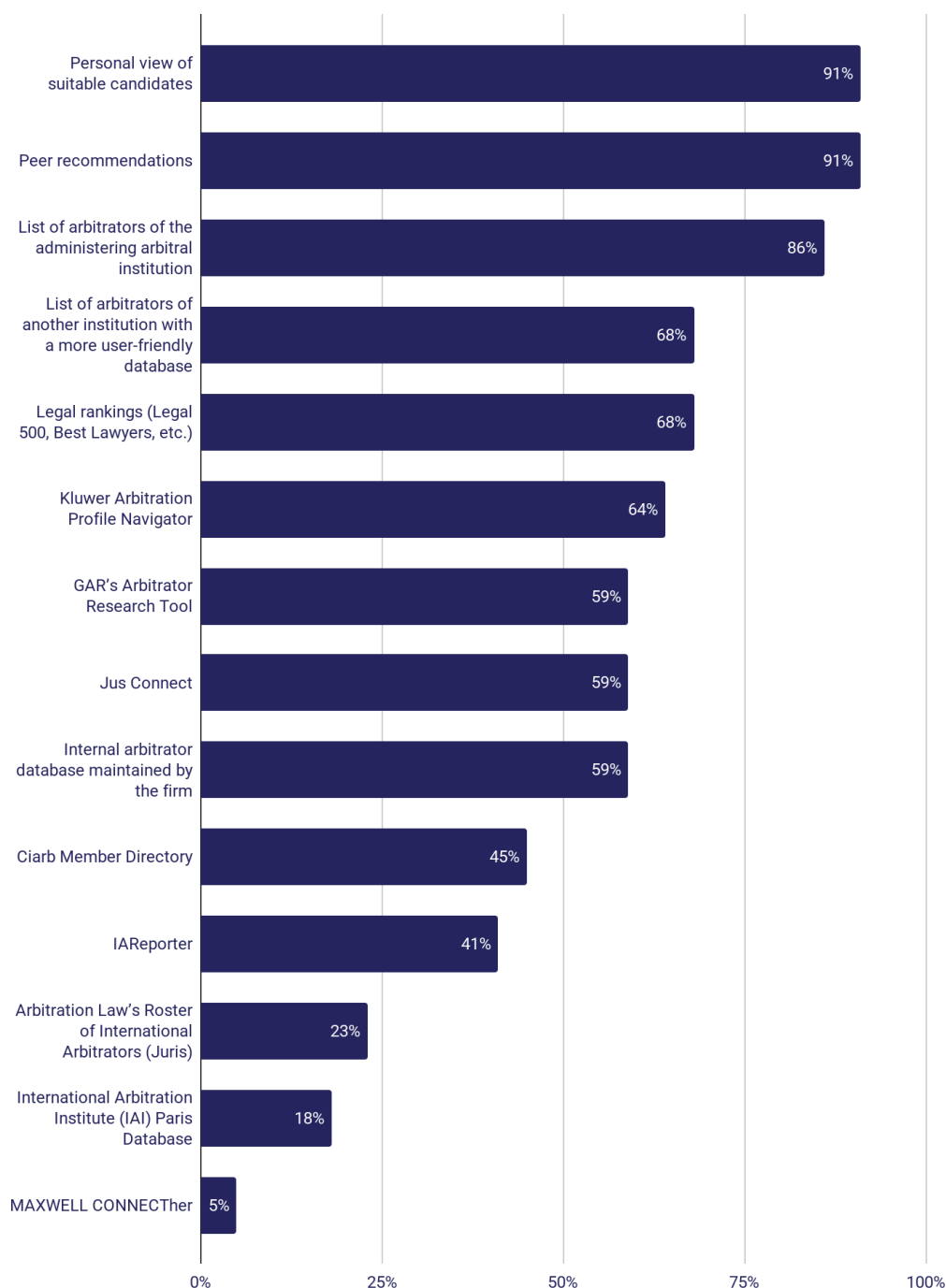


Respondents' own judgement and peer recommendations, as well as the lists of the administering arbitral institution, remain the leading sources when selecting arbitrators for international disputes. At the same time, the importance of legal rankings increases. Among specialised international databases, respondents most frequently use the Kluwer Arbitration Profile Navigator.⁴⁵

⁴⁴ One respondent chose not to answer.

⁴⁵ More information about Kluwer Arbitration Profile Navigator is available on the [website](#).

Figure 13. Resources Used to Find Arbitrators for International Disputes
(by Frequency of Mention by Respondents)⁴⁶



The survey results are consistent with the findings of an international study, according to which practitioners' own understanding of the legal market and arbitral institutions' lists also rank among the leading sources.⁴⁷

⁴⁶ One respondent chose not to answer.

⁴⁷ "The usual suspects: decision-making in arbitrator selection", Cortex Capital, October 2023, p. 21, available [here](#).

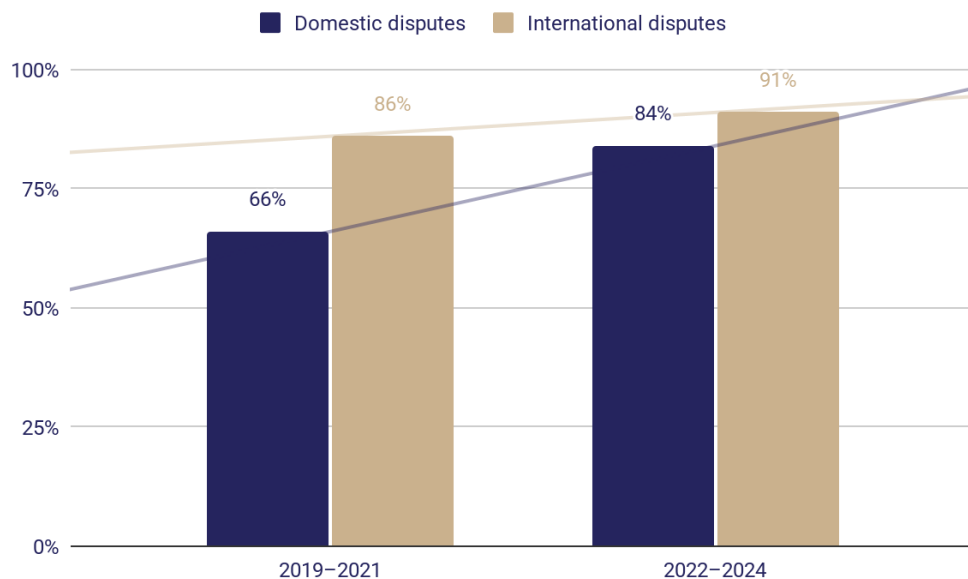
1.3 GENDER AS A FACTOR IN ARBITRATOR SELECTION

International studies on statistics of arbitrator appointment indicate that parties appoint female arbitrators less frequently than arbitral institutions do.⁴⁸ Against this backdrop, respondents were asked whether they had ever selected female arbitrators, in what types of disputes they proposed female arbitrators for appointment, and whether they could identify any advantages of female arbitrators.

1.3.1 Selection of Female Arbitrators by Respondents

Respondents were asked to assess their experience in selecting and appointing female arbitrators during two time periods: 2019–2021 and 2022–2024. Although 9% of respondent firms had never proposed a woman as an arbitrator, the results generally indicate a significant expansion in the practice of selecting and appointing women in both domestic and international disputes. During the period of 2022–2024, 84% of respondents proposed female arbitrators for appointment in domestic disputes, while 91% did so in international disputes.

Figure 14. Share of Respondents Who Proposed Female Arbitrators for Appointment in Domestic and International Disputes (Over Time)⁴⁹



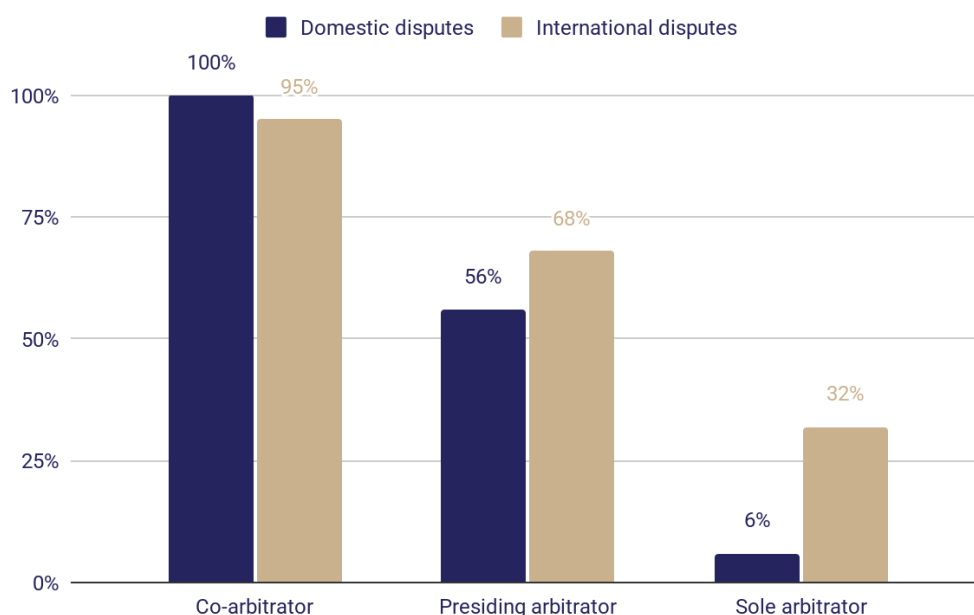
Notably, although the increase in the number of respondents who proposed female arbitrators has been more pronounced in domestic disputes, respondents continue to propose women as arbitrators more frequently in international disputes.

An analysis of selection and appointment procedures demonstrates that female arbitrators are more commonly nominated to serve as co-arbitrators. Their candidacies are put forward considerably less often for appointment as presiding arbitrators or sole arbitrators, particularly in domestic disputes.

⁴⁸ “Report of the Cross-institutional Task Force on Gender Diversity in Arbitral Appointments and Proceedings”, ICCA, 2026, p. 75, available [here](#).

⁴⁹ One respondent chose not to answer the question regarding the appointment of female arbitrators in international disputes, while another respondent had not been involved in international disputes during the 2019–2021 period. In addition, five respondents had not handled domestic disputes in 2019–2021, and four respondents had not handled domestic disputes in 2022–2024.

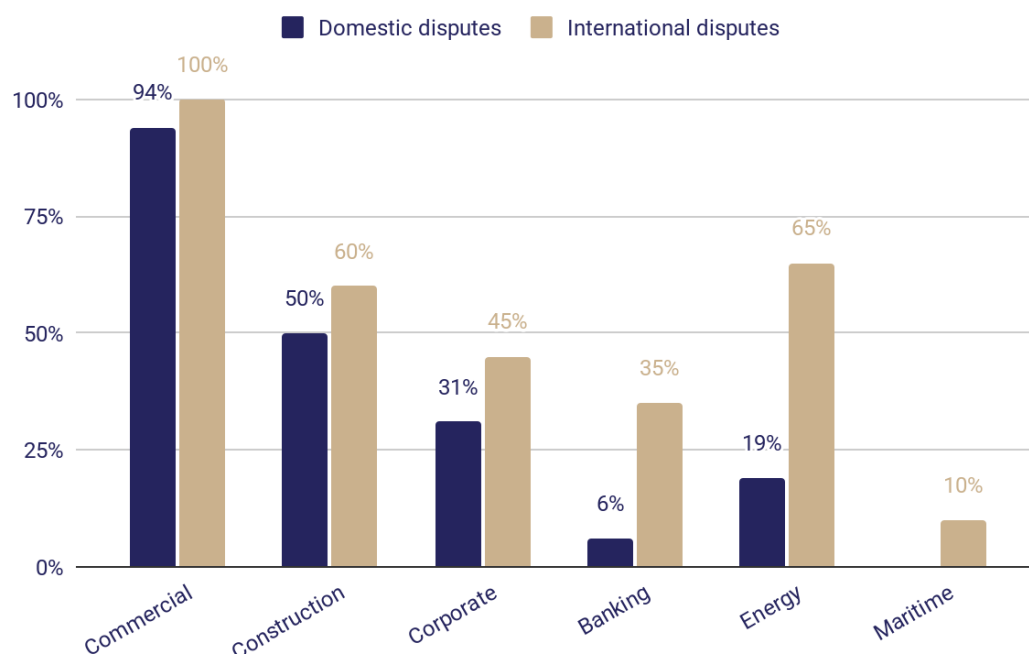
Figure 15. Share of Respondents Who Proposed Female Arbitrators for Appointment in Domestic and International Disputes (by Role within the Tribunal)⁵⁰



1.3.2 Nature of Disputes in Which Female Arbitrators Were Proposed for Appointment

Respondents most actively proposed female arbitrators in commercial disputes, both domestic and international, where the proportion reaches its highest levels.

Figure 16. Share of Respondents Who Proposed Female Arbitrators for Appointment in Domestic and International Disputes (by Nature of Dispute)⁵¹



⁵⁰ Seven respondents chose not to answer the question relating to domestic disputes, while four respondents chose not to answer the corresponding question relating to international disputes.

⁵¹ Seven respondents chose not to answer the question relating to domestic disputes, while three respondents chose not to answer the corresponding question relating to international disputes.

It is noteworthy that more than half of the respondents had proposed female arbitrators in energy and construction disputes, which require technical expertise and are often perceived as more male-dominated fields.⁵² In the 2017 RAA survey on appointment of arbitrators, some respondents explicitly indicated that men were better suited to hear “more technical disputes”, including disputes “in the field of business law”, construction disputes, and similar matters, whereas women were viewed as better suited to family law disputes and situations “requiring empathy”.⁵³

We are pleased to observe that such stereotypes appear to be receding. In an interview for the RWA InspoWoman project, Irina Akulenko, who serves as an arbitrator and expert in the field of construction and engineering, noted that she does not see “any difference between female and male professionals in the construction sector, although with the caveat that this observation primarily relates to design, engineering, legal, and other advisory services (including expert services)”.⁵⁴

More than one-third of respondents additionally indicated that they had proposed female arbitrators in investor-state disputes. As noted above, respondents are actively involved in investor-state arbitration, with 70% having acted in such disputes (see [Figure 7](#) above). Notably, in the 2017 RAA survey, investor-state disputes were also identified by respondents as a type of disputes for which female arbitrators were particularly well suited.⁵⁵

The overwhelming majority of respondents do not use specialised tools or databases to search for female arbitrators. For example, only 5% of respondents reported using MAXWELL CONNECTher,⁵⁶ a database of female arbitrators practicing in the Asia-Pacific region (see [Figure 13](#) above). Nevertheless, one-third of respondents indicated that there is demand for the creation of a similar database of Russian female arbitrators, which may reflect a growing commitment to promoting gender diversity in arbitral tribunal appointments.

1.3.3 Perceived Advantages of Female Arbitrators

The majority of respondents (78%) stated that they do not perceive any advantages associated with arbitrators’ gender. The remaining respondents indicated that female arbitrators are characterised by:

- greater attention to detail;
- an ability to listen to both parties;
- a more balanced and structured approach to conducting proceedings;
- an ability to “balance” male arbitrators on the tribunal;
- a more responsible approach to their work; and
- greater diligence in working with documents.

In the 2017 RAA survey, some respondents also noted that women possess stronger organisational skills, a greater ability to reach agreement with fellow arbitrators, and an enhanced capacity to process large volumes of information.⁵⁷

⁵² See, for example, K. Franklin “Women in Construction Adjudication”, Ciarb, 15 September 2023, available [here](#).

⁵³ “Russian Arbitration Association (RAA) Survey 2017: Women’s Participation in Arbitration as Arbitrators”, RAA, 2017, pp. 24–25, available [here](#) (in Russian).

⁵⁴ The interview is available [here](#).

⁵⁵ “Russian Arbitration Association (RAA) Survey 2017: Women’s Participation in Arbitration as Arbitrators”, RAA, 2017, p. 24, available [here](#) (in Russian).

⁵⁶ More information about MAXWELL CONNECTher is available at the [website](#).

⁵⁷ “Russian Arbitration Association (RAA) Survey 2017: Women’s Participation in Arbitration as Arbitrators”, RAA, 2017, pp. 17, 19–20, available [here](#) (in Russian).

RIAC 2025 Highlight

In a survey conducted at the event, 59% of respondents indicated that they see advantages in appointing female arbitrators, while 49% identified advantages in appointing male arbitrators.

Although identifying perceived advantages of female arbitrators may be viewed as a positive development, in practice the attribution of particular qualities as either “male” or “female” can itself reinforce imbalances in appointments. Researchers have observed that unconscious bias (including bias arising from gender stereotypes) has a significant impact on decision-making processes, particularly when women are considered for leadership or other key positions. Such bias is regarded as one of the most important factors explaining the disparity in the appointment of men and women as arbitrators.⁵⁸

⁵⁸ “Report of the Cross-institutional Task Force on Gender Diversity in Arbitral Appointments and Proceedings”, ICCA, 2026, p. 104, available [here](#).

1.4 AGE AS A FACTOR IN ARBITRATOR SELECTION

In international arbitration, arbitrators are generally professionals of senior age. While parties' preference for appointing experienced arbitrators is understandable, the issue of age is not straightforward. Experience is undoubtedly often correlated with age; however, available data indicate that the average age of international arbitrators is relatively high – around 55 years⁵⁹ – which may suggest that young arbitrators are appointed less frequently, even when they possess sufficient experience. According to the 2017 study by Berwin Leighton Paisner (now BCLP), nearly one-third of respondents (28%) reported losing appointments due to their young age.⁶⁰

To understand how Russian law firms perceive young arbitrators, respondents were asked about the likelihood of appointing young arbitrators in domestic and international disputes, the optimal age of arbitrators for different categories of disputes, and whether they find any advantages associated with young arbitrators.

1.4.1 Likelihood of Appointment of Young Arbitrators by Respondents

As part of the study, respondents were asked to assess the likelihood of appointing arbitrators of a certain age depending on the amount in dispute. Given the differences between domestic and international disputes, both the age thresholds and the value brackets of claims were differentiated.

- For the purposes of this study, young arbitrators were defined as professionals under 35 in domestic disputes and under 40 in international disputes. This distinction reflects differences in professional development across jurisdictions. In Russia, lawyers typically enter the profession earlier than in many other countries, where admission to legal practice requires passing qualification examinations and completing additional preparatory requirements.⁶¹
- Domestic disputes were divided into three categories based on the amount in dispute: up to RUB 10 million, RUB 10–100 million, and over RUB 100 million. A similar approach was applied to international disputes, with categories defined as up to USD 10 million, USD 10–100 million, and over USD 100 million.

Respondents were asked to assess the likelihood of appointing young arbitrators in these categories of disputes. The results show that in cases involving relatively low-value claims, respondents are generally more open to appointing young arbitrators. Slightly more than half of respondents are willing to appoint a young arbitrator in domestic disputes involving claims up to RUB 10 million and in international disputes involving claims up to USD 10 million. A further 30% of respondents indicated that they are more likely than not to make such appointments.

⁵⁹ I.A. Müller, "Diversity and Lack Thereof Amongst International Arbitrators - Between Discrimination, Political Correctness and Representativeness", TDM, July 2025, p. 12, available [here](#). See also A. Alvarez, M. Williams and T. Williams, "The Int'l Arbitration Diversity Landscape By The Numbers", Law360, 8 November 2024, p. 3, available [here](#) (according to the ICC statistics, only 38% of arbitrators are under 50 years of age).

⁶⁰ "International Arbitration Survey: Diversity on Arbitral Tribunals. Are We Getting There?", Berwin Leighton Paisner, 2017, p. 6, available [here](#).

⁶¹ Normally, international professional arbitration associations define the age threshold for "young practitioners" as under 40 (for example, Young ICCA and YIAG).

Figure 17. Likelihood of Appointing Young Arbitrators Under 35 in Domestic Disputes (Depending on the Amount in Dispute)⁶²

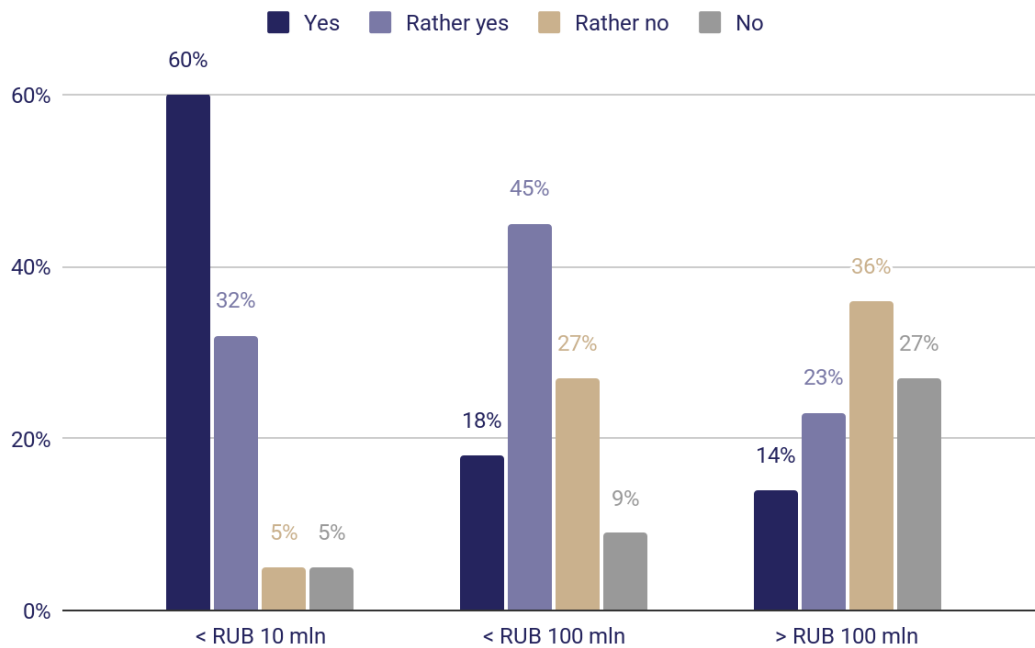
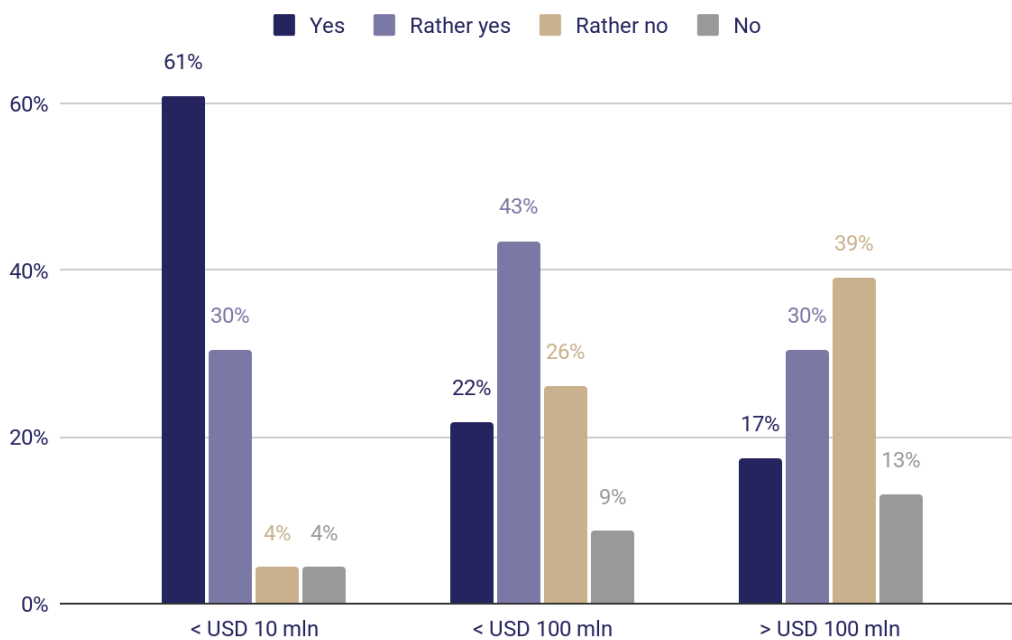


Figure 18. Likelihood of Appointing Young Arbitrators Under 40 in International Disputes (Depending on the Amount in Dispute)



As the amount in dispute increases, respondents are less willing to appoint young arbitrators. This indicates that the willingness to appoint a young arbitrator depends on the complexity and value of the dispute. This trend is consistently observed in both domestic and international arbitration.

⁶² One respondent chose not to answer.

RIAC 2025 Highlight

At first glance, it may appear that lower-value disputes are more suitable for the appointment of young arbitrators. However, arbitration rules often provide for the resolution of such disputes by a sole arbitrator under expedited procedure. In practice, this procedural framework may in fact require greater experience from the arbitrator, particularly in terms of efficient case management – experience that a young arbitrator may not yet possess.

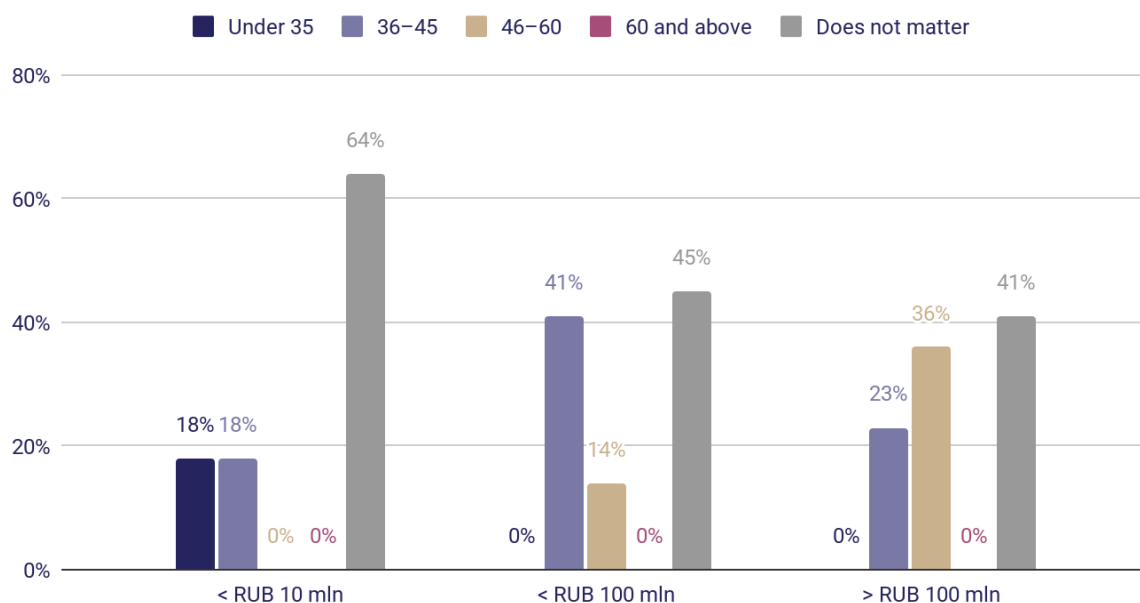
1.4.2 Most Appropriate Age of Arbitrators for Domestic and International Disputes

Respondents were asked to identify the age of arbitrators they consider most suitable for resolving domestic or international disputes with a given amount in dispute.

For the majority of respondents (61%), the age of the arbitrator is not a relevant factor in domestic disputes involving claims of up to RUB 10 million. At the same time, some respondents consider arbitrators under 45 to be the most suitable for such disputes.

As the value of domestic disputes increases, the perceived importance of the arbitrator's age increases slightly: in cases involving claims of up to RUB 100 million and over RUB 100 million, the proportion of respondents who do not consider age to be relevant decreases, although it remains significant. The remaining respondents indicated that arbitrators aged 36–45 are the most suitable for disputes involving claims under RUB 100 million, while arbitrators aged 46–60 are considered most suitable for disputes exceeding RUB 100 million.

Figure 19. Most Appropriate Age of Arbitrator for Domestic Disputes
(Depending on the Amount in Dispute)⁶³

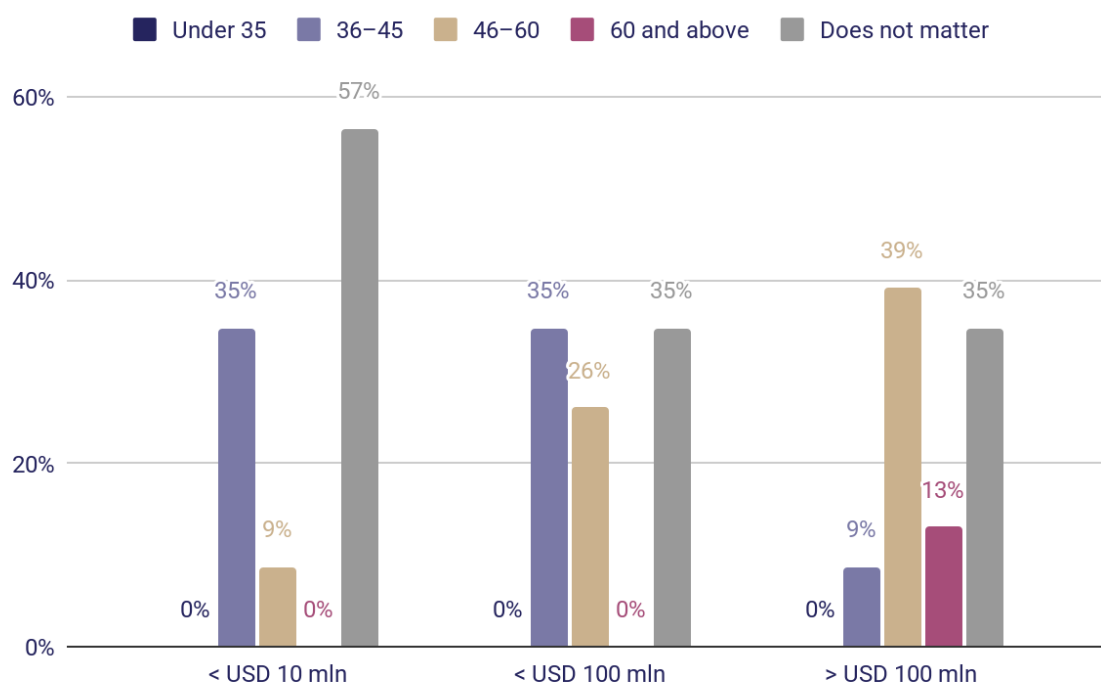


Similar trends are observed in the appointment of arbitrators in international disputes. However, an important distinction is that none of the respondents consider arbitrators under 35 to be suitable for hearing international disputes, regardless of the amount in dispute. In addition, unlike in domestic

⁶³ One respondent chose not to answer.

disputes, some respondents identified arbitrators over 60 as the most suitable for disputes exceeding USD 100 million.

Figure 20. Most Appropriate Age of Arbitrator for International Disputes
(Depending on the Amount in Dispute)



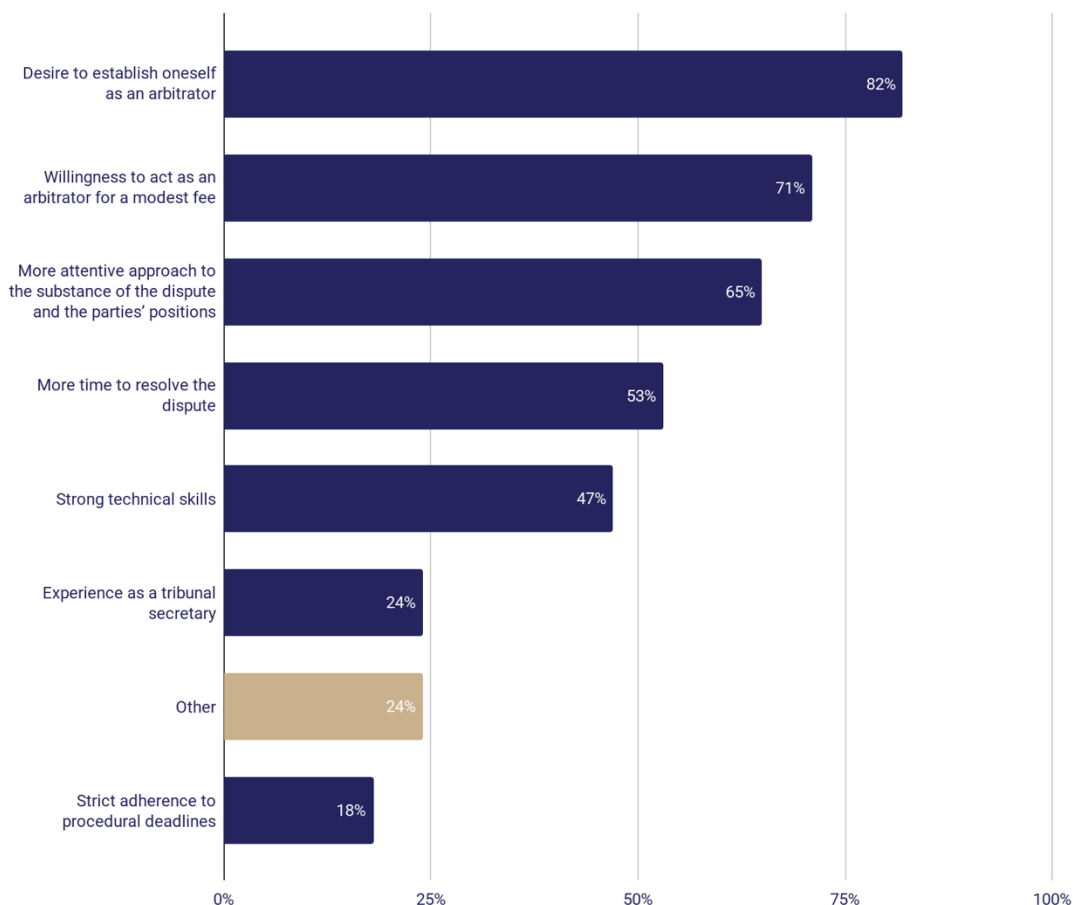
1.4.3 Perceived Advantages of Young Arbitrators

The majority of respondents (74%) indicated that arbitrators under 40 have certain advantages, the most frequently cited being their willingness to establish themselves as arbitrators.

RIAC 2025 Highlight

Based on the experience of arbitral institutions, young arbitrators tend to communicate more actively with the institution in their early appointments.

Figure 21. Advantages of Arbitrators Under 40 (by Frequency of Mention by Respondents)⁶⁴



Some respondents (24%) identified other advantages of young arbitrators, including:

- lower caseload as arbitrators;
- readiness to apply international standards in domestic disputes;
- technological proficiency;
- openness to unconventional approaches; and
- proactiveness.

In the analytical report of SCC on the diversity of arbitrators appointed in the institution's arbitral proceedings, it is noted that young arbitrators are more frequently appointed in less complex cases with lower fees. According to SCC, less experienced arbitrators are generally more available for such cases and are able to devote more time to them compared to more experienced arbitrators, which in turn may enhance the value of their work for the parties.⁶⁵ A study by the International Council for Commercial Arbitration (ICCA) on arbitrator appointments also notes that respondents often receive their first appointments in lower-value disputes, as the remuneration in such cases may be less attractive to more experienced arbitrators.⁶⁶

⁶⁴ Six respondents chose not to answer, as they do not perceive any advantages associated with young arbitrators.

⁶⁵ "Diversity in arbitrator appointments In SCC cases 2015–2019", SCC, p. 22, available [here](#).

⁶⁶ "Report of the Cross-institutional Task Force on Gender Diversity in Arbitral Appointments and Proceedings", ICCA, 2026, pp. 147–148, available [here](#).

1.5 NATIONALITY AS A FACTOR IN ARBITRATOR SELECTION

Many arbitration rules refer to the presence or absence of a link between an arbitrator and the states of the disputing parties as one of the factors taken into account when constituting an arbitral tribunal.⁶⁷ Such a link may be reflected in the arbitrator's nationality, origin, place of work, or place of residence.

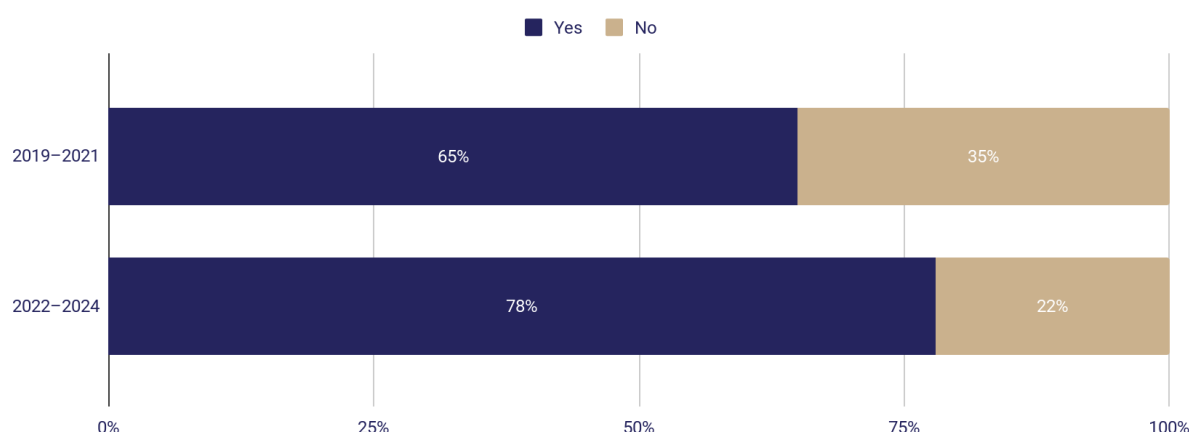
In recent years, these characteristics have become particularly important for Russian parties, especially in light of restrictive measures (sanctions) imposed by foreign states on Russian businesses (see [Section 1.2.2](#) above). To assess the extent to which current geopolitical developments influence arbitrator selection, respondents were asked about the selection (i.e., proposing for appointment) of Russian and foreign arbitrators in international disputes in 2019–2024.

The questions concerned solely the nationality of arbitrators. For the purposes of this study, Russian arbitrators are defined as Russian citizens residing or working either in Russia or abroad.⁶⁸ Accordingly, foreign arbitrators are defined as citizens of other states, regardless of their place of residence or employment.

1.5.1 Selection of Russian Arbitrators in International Disputes

More than half of the respondents proposed Russian arbitrators for appointment in international disputes. At the same time, the number of respondents proposing Russian arbitrators increased in 2022–2024 compared to 2019–2021.

Figure 22. Selection of Russian Arbitrators by Respondents in International Disputes



Recent analytical materials have repeatedly noted that following the imposition of sanctions and other restrictions in 2022, the number of appointments of Russian arbitrators in international disputes, including in “unfriendly” jurisdictions, increased.⁶⁹

All respondents proposed Russian arbitrators as co-arbitrators.⁷⁰ Around one-third of respondents proposed agreeing on a Russian arbitrator as a presiding arbitrator (39%) or included such candidates in lists of potential presidents under list procedures (28%). A small number of respondents (11%) also proposed Russian arbitrators as sole arbitrators under list procedures.

⁶⁷ See, for example, Article 13 of the ICC Arbitration Rules 2021.

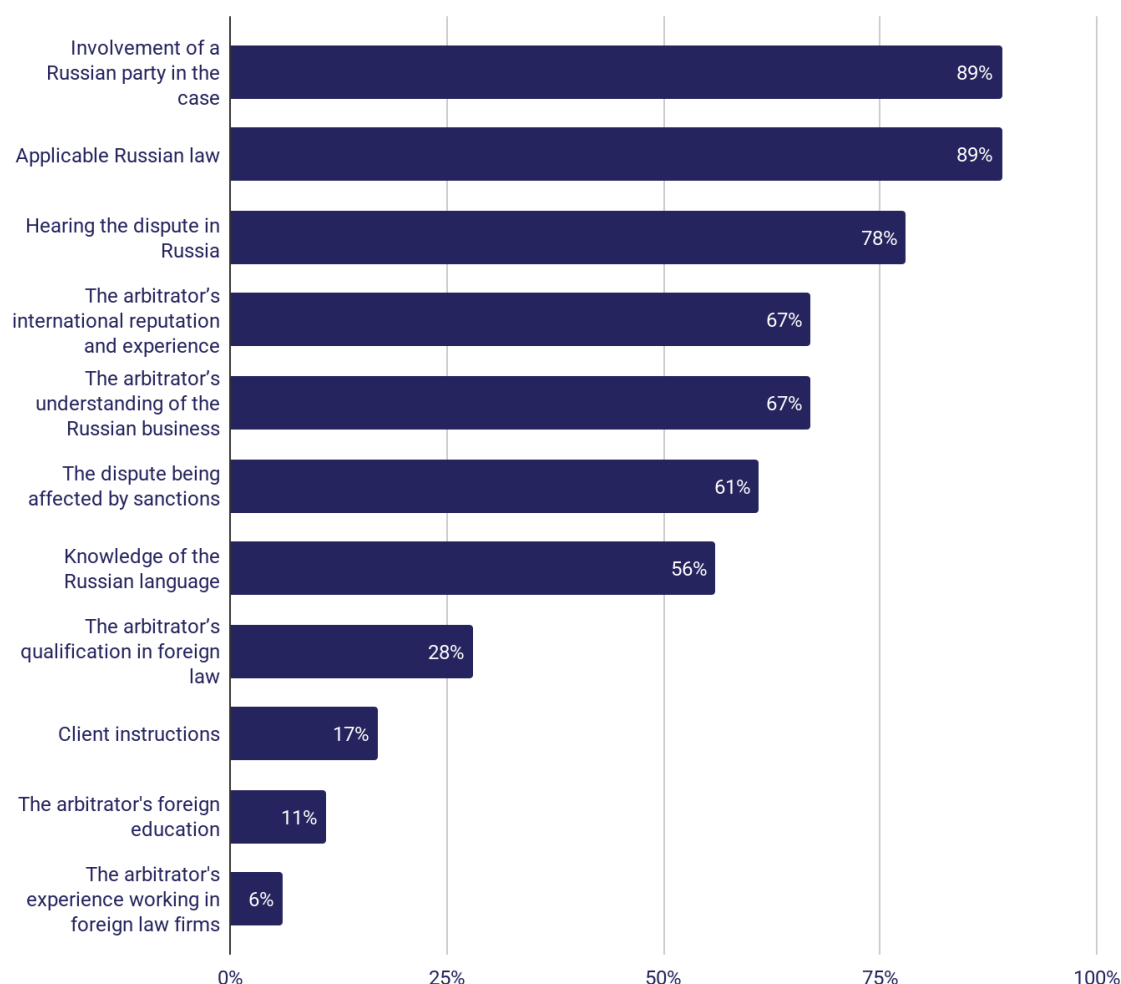
⁶⁸ Regardless of whether the relevant Russian arbitrator holds a second or dual nationality. This study does not cover these issues.

⁶⁹ “Arbitration, Sanctions and Payments: Key Rules for Businesses Operating Internationally, in Quotes”, Pravo.ru, 25 April 2026, available [here](#); “10 Trends in International Arbitration: Findings from a Study of the International Commercial Arbitration (ICA) Market in Russia”, Pravo.ru, 2025, available [here](#) (in Russian).

⁷⁰ One respondent chose not to answer the question regarding the procedures in which they proposed a Russian arbitrator, and four respondents did not appoint Russian arbitrators in either domestic or international disputes.

The connection of a dispute to Russia is the key reason why respondents proposed or appointed Russian arbitrators. This link is most often reflected in the participation of the Russian parties in the dispute, applicable Russian law, the Russian arbitral institution administering the dispute, or the seat of arbitration in Russia. Respondents also value an arbitrator's international reputation and significant experience, as well as his or her understanding of the specifics of Russian business.

Figure 23. Reasons for Selecting Russian Arbitrators in International Disputes
(by Frequency of Mention by Respondents)



One initiative aimed at increasing the visibility of arbitrator candidates is the Guide to Next Generation of Russian Arbitrators, which includes information on arbitrators under 45 – Russian nationals or practitioners who have worked in Russia for at least five years.⁷¹

1.5.2 Selection of Foreign Arbitrators in International Disputes

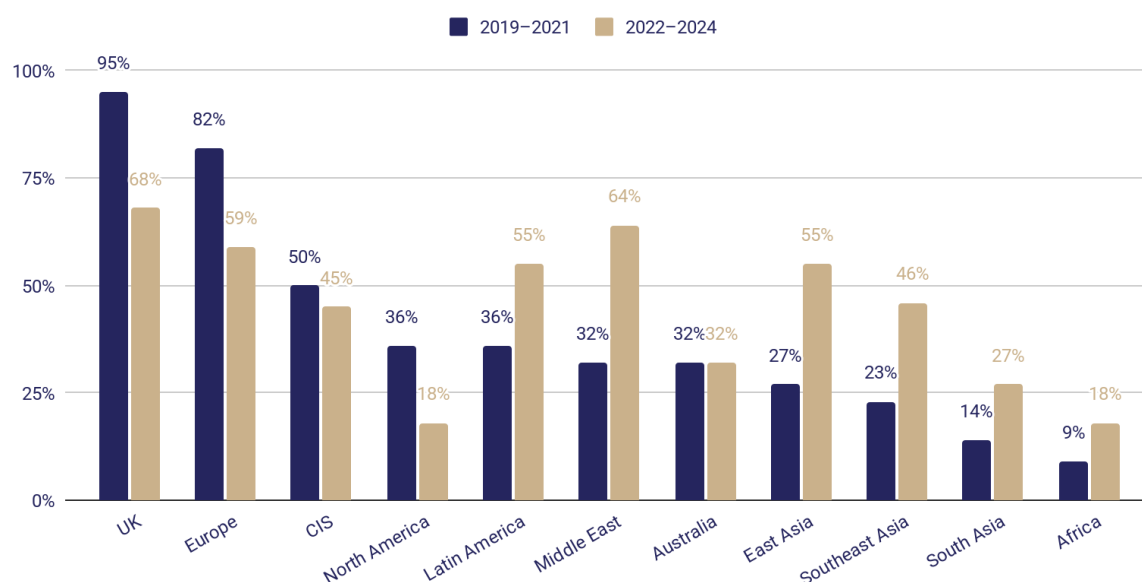
All respondents proposed foreign arbitrators in international disputes in 2019–2024. The vast majority (95%) proposed foreign arbitrators as co-arbitrators, more than half (68%) as presiding arbitrators, and one quarter (27%) as sole arbitrators.⁷²

⁷¹ Guide to Next Generation of Russian Arbitrators is available [here](#).

⁷² One respondent chose to answer.

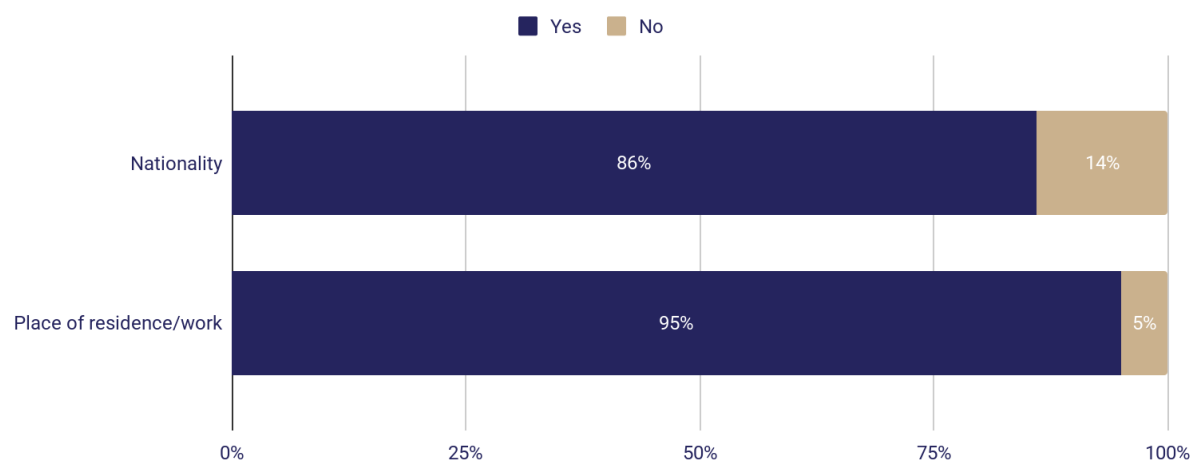
The most frequently mentioned regions for selecting foreign arbitrators in 2019–2021 included the UK, Europe, and the CIS. While their frequency of mention remained high in 2022–2024, since 2022 there has been an increase in references to regions such as Latin America, the Middle East, and Asia. Notably, the number of arbitrators from the Middle East and Asia selected by respondents has doubled.

Figure 24. Regions of Origin of Foreign Arbitrators Selected by Respondents
(by Frequency of Mention by Respondents)⁷³



The growing popularity of regions, “neutral” from a geopolitical perspective for Russian parties, correlates with a trend since 2022 toward taking into account the “friendliness” of the relevant jurisdiction. Most respondents consider the “friendliness” of the country of nationality, residence, or place of work of a foreign arbitrator.

Figure 25. Consideration of the “Friendliness” of a Foreign Arbitrator in 2022–2024⁷⁴



Despite the fact that after 2022 there has been a clear trend toward selecting arbitrators from “friendly” jurisdictions, arbitrators from the UK and Europe continue to be among the preferred choices. As noted

⁷³ One respondent chose to answer.

⁷⁴ Two respondents chose not to answer the question about nationality, and one respondent chose not to answer the question about place of residence/work.

in analytical materials of Pravo.ru, many international contracts from which disputes arise are governed by English law, and Russian parties continue to select Western arbitrators, “relying on their experience and authority in the arbitration community”.⁷⁵

⁷⁵ “The Ideal Arbitrator: Who They Are and How to Choose Them”, Pravo.ru, 8 October 2025, available [here](#) (in Russian).

2 APPOINTMENT OF ARBITRATORS IN DISPUTES ADMINISTERED BY PERMANENT ARBITRAL INSTITUTIONS (PAIs)

2.1 GENERAL INFORMATION ON THE DIVERSITY POLICIES OF ARBITRAL INSTITUTIONS

According to the 2021 International Arbitration Survey published by QMUL and White & Case, arbitral institutions wield the most influence on the promotion of diversity, primarily due to their power to make direct appointments of arbitrators and their access to databases reflecting a larger pool of candidates for tribunals.⁷⁶ Arbitral institutions themselves emphasise that promoting diversity among appointed arbitrators is their important guiding principle.⁷⁷

In this study, we analysed the role played by arbitral institutions in promoting diversity, focusing on institutions that have been granted the status of permanent arbitral institutions (PAIs) in Russia. To this end, we examined the practices of the following Russian PAIs: ICAC, MAC, Arbitration Centre at RSPP, and RAC, as well as the following foreign PAIs: VIAC, HKIAC, ICC, and SIAC.⁷⁸

Four arbitral institutions – RAC, VIAC, HKIAC, and ICC – participated in our 2025 survey and provided full or partial data on arbitrator appointments in Russia-related disputes, which forms the basis of this study. In addition, we analysed publicly available information on the approaches adopted by PAIs in appointing arbitrators. We also drew, where possible and methodologically appropriate, on the findings of the 2021 RWA study on gender diversity in arbitrator appointments, which was based on data provided by MAC, Arbitration Centre at RSPP, and RAC.⁷⁹

We are pleased to note that the arbitral institutions under study are making efforts to promote diversity in arbitrator appointments. All of the institutions, with the exception of ICAC and MAC, have signed the ERA Pledge. Some arbitral institutions have also incorporated provisions aimed at increasing the diversity of appointed arbitrators into their arbitration rules or dedicated guidelines on the proposal and appointment of arbitrators.⁸⁰

2.1.1 Composition of the Collegiate Governing Bodies and Case Management Teams of Arbitral Institutions

In line with the approach taken for law firms (see [Section 1.1.1](#) above), we examined the gender composition of the following PAI's bodies:

- collegiate governing bodies responsible for decision-making on matters within their mandate under the arbitration rules, including the appointment of arbitrators, deciding challenges of arbitrators, and the determination of arbitration costs, including arbitrators' fees;⁸¹ and

⁷⁶ "2021 International Arbitration Survey: Adapting arbitration to a changing world", QMUL, White & Case, 2021, pp. 17–18, available [here](#).

⁷⁷ For example, HKIAC notes that it has a policy aimed at increasing gender diversity in appointing arbitrators and holding public events. See "HKIAC and Hong Kong Ranked Third Worldwide for Arbitration", HKIAC, 7 May 2021, available [here](#).

⁷⁸ On approach to drawing up a list of PAIs for study see Section "[Study Methodology](#)".

⁷⁹ The results of the RWA study were presented on 10 September 2021 at an event during the Uzbek Arbitration Week. The RWA slides presenting the results of the study are available [here](#).

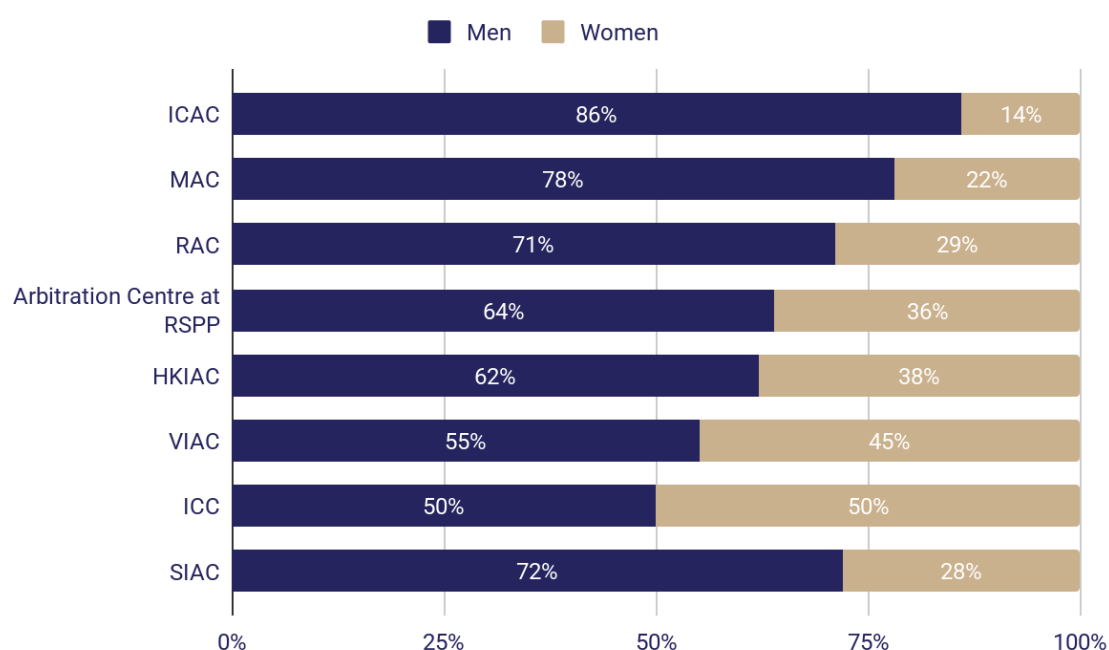
⁸⁰ RAC Guidelines on Appointment of Arbitrators 2022, para. 4(15), available [here](#); "Note to ICC National Committees and Groups on the Proposal of Arbitrators", 2022, para. 40, available [here](#); HKIAC Administered Arbitration Rules 2024, Article 9A, available [here](#).

⁸¹ The following are considered "collegiate governing bodies": (i) ICAC Presidium and the four Nomination Committees; (ii) MAC Presidium and the Nomination Committee; (iii) Board of RAC; (iv) Presidium and the Nomination Committee of Arbitration Centre at RSPP; (v) HKIAC Council, Executive Committee, Proceedings Committee and Appointments Committee; (vi) VIAC Board; (vii) ICC Court; and (viii) SIAC Court of Arbitration.

- case management teams responsible for the day-to-day administration of arbitral proceedings in accordance with the applicable arbitration rules.⁸²

Across all arbitral institutions surveyed, the proportion of women within collegiate governing bodies does not exceed one half. Foreign arbitral institutions based in Europe demonstrate a higher level of gender balance.

Figure 26. Gender Composition of Collegiate Governing Bodies of Russian and Foreign Arbitral Institutions⁸³



Women lead the collegiate governing bodies of half of the arbitral institutions under study, including Arbitration Centre at RSPP, RAC, ICC, and SIAC.

It is noteworthy that Russian law imposes specific requirements on the composition and appointment process of the collegiate governing bodies of Russian PAIs that perform the functions of nomination committees.⁸⁴ Under Russian law, at least two-thirds of the members of a nomination committee shall be elected by a simple majority vote of individuals included on the institution's recommended list of arbitrators. As demonstrated later in this study, the overwhelming majority of individuals included on the recommended lists of arbitral institutions are men (see [Section 2.1.2](#) below). Consequently, among those entitled to participate in the selection of two-thirds of the members of PAI nomination committees,

⁸² By "case management teams" we mean the Administrative Office of RAC, the Secretariat of Arbitration Centre at RSPP, HKIAC, VIAC, ICC, and SIAC, who perform case management functions and are qualified lawyers (thus excluding administrative assistants and staff engaged in finance, business development, or IT support).

⁸³ The gender composition of the collegiate governing bodies of PAIs was examined on the basis of publicly available information posted on the institutions' websites as of 11 May 2026. In cases where a PAI has several collegiate governing bodies, the aggregate number of male and female members across all bodies was calculated, with individuals serving in more than one body counted only once.

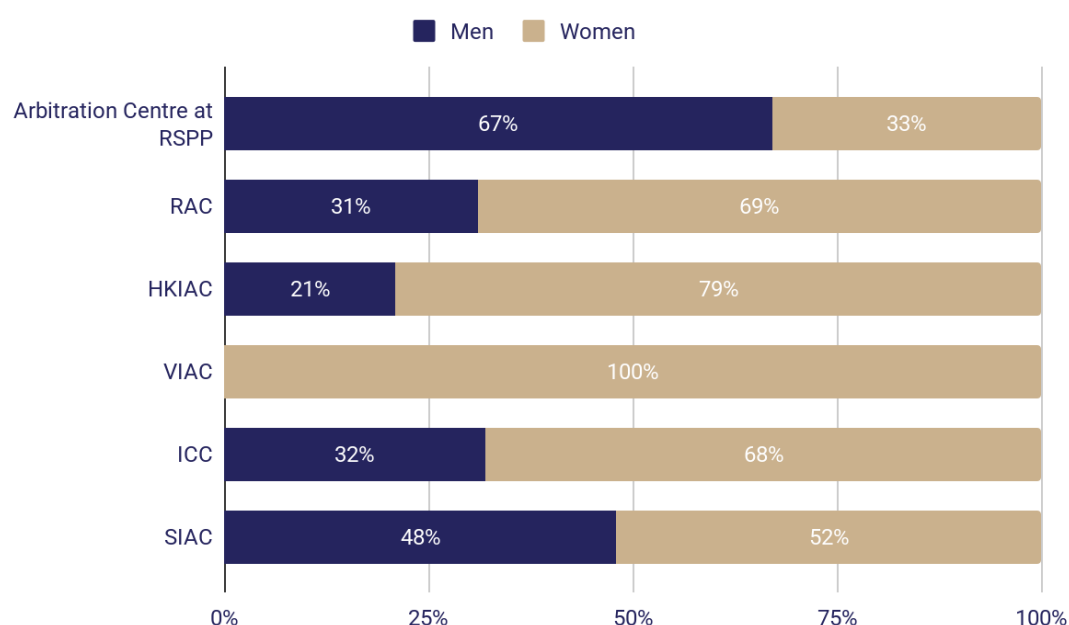
⁸⁴ Federal Law No. 382-FZ dated 29 December 2015 (as amended on 8 August 2024) "On Arbitration (Arbitral Proceedings) in the Russian Federation" ("**Federal Law on Arbitration**"), Article 47(4)–(6). The Law employs the term "nomination committee". In functional terms, the Board of RAC, which is examined in this study, performs the role of such a nomination committee. At ICAC, MAC, and Arbitration Centre at RSPP, the functions of a nomination committee are carried out by specially established collegiate governing bodies bearing the same name.

men outnumber women. This may, in turn, affect the gender composition of the collegiate governing bodies themselves.⁸⁵

At the same time, we view positively the fact that Russian law requires the periodic rotation of nomination committee members. Specifically, at least one-third of the committee's membership must be renewed within a three-year period, and an individual who leaves the committee may not be reappointed to it for three years thereafter.⁸⁶

In contrast to the collegiate governing bodies, the case management teams of arbitral institutions are predominantly composed of women.

Figure 27. Gender Composition of Case Management Teams of Russian and Foreign Arbitral Institutions⁸⁷



Leadership of case management teams is evenly split between men and women. Women head the case management teams of three arbitral institutions – RAC, HKIAC, and VIAC.

The data relating to arbitral institutions reveal a pattern similar to that observed in law firms. Although women participate extensively in the profession, they remain significantly underrepresented in senior positions (particularly within collegiate governing bodies). Nevertheless, the findings suggest that gender balance at the leadership level of arbitral institutions is in any event substantially stronger than at the partnership level in law firms.

An examination of the nationality of members of the collegiate governing bodies and case management teams reveals that, despite administering international disputes, all of the Russian arbitral institutions under study are staffed predominantly by Russian nationals. The most internationally diverse body is the

⁸⁵ “Report of the Cross-institutional Task Force on Gender Diversity in Arbitral Appointments and Proceedings”, ICCA, 2026, pp. 105–106, available [here](#) (it is noted that the lack of diversity in arbitration is largely attributable to affinity bias – the tendency to select people from one’s own circle, which, given the predominant participation of men in the profession, leads to the repeated appointment primarily of men and reproduces gender inequality).

⁸⁶ Federal Law on Arbitration, Article 47(6).

⁸⁷ Using the same methodology as for the collegiate governing bodies, we examined the gender composition of the case management teams of the PAIs based on the publicly available information posted on their websites as of 11 May 2026. In the case of Arbitration Centre at RSPP and RAC, the analysis was limited to the case management teams of their principal offices. The websites of ICAC and MAC do not provide information on the composition of their case management teams.

Subcommittee on International Arbitration of the Board of RAC, with 36% of its members being foreign nationals.⁸⁸

Foreign arbitral institutions demonstrate a greater degree of nationality diversity. Publicly available information indicates that Russian nationals are represented in a number of these institutions, including on the case management teams of HKIAC and SIAC and within the collegiate governing bodies of HKIAC, SIAC, and ICC.

While arbitral institutions generally endeavour to publish biographical information about members of their collegiate governing bodies and case management teams on their official websites, such biographies do not consistently disclose the individuals' year of birth. Consequently, an analysis of the age profile of these bodies is not possible.

2.1.2 Lists of Arbitrators of Arbitral Institutions

Many Russian law firms indicated that they refer to arbitral institutions' lists of arbitrators when selecting and appointing arbitrators (see [Section 1.2.3](#) above). Against this backdrop, we also analysed the diversity of arbitrators included in these lists.

Russian law requires a Russian PAI to maintain and publish on its website a recommended list of arbitrators comprising no fewer than 30 individuals. It further imposes several requirements on the composition of such lists. In particular:⁸⁹

- at least one-third of the listed arbitrators must hold a Russian doctoral or equivalent academic degree in a relevant field;⁹⁰
- at least one-half must have no less than ten years of experience in resolving civil law disputes, either as arbitrators or as judges in Russian courts;⁹¹
- no individual may appear on the recommended lists of more than three PAIs.⁹²

The requirements relating to arbitrators' qualifications and experience limit the inclusion of foreign arbitrators on the recommended lists. Although foreign nationals may have experience resolving disputes as arbitrators and may hold Russian or equivalent academic degrees, they are unlikely to satisfy the "judicial experience" criterion.⁹³ In addition, these requirements, which appear intended to establish a threshold of quality for listed arbitrators, may in practice also act as a barrier to the inclusion of young and less experienced arbitrators.

At the same time, these requirements may provide guidance as to the criteria considered by Russian PAIs when running their recommended lists in order to comply with statutory requirements. For example, prospective candidates may bear in mind that holding a Russian doctoral or equivalent academic degree may enhance their prospects of inclusion in PAI's recommended lists.

If a PAI administers international disputes, it may maintain a united recommended list of arbitrators or separate recommended lists for domestic and international disputes.⁹⁴

⁸⁸ "The Subcommittee on International Arbitration", RAC, available [here](#).

⁸⁹ Federal Law on Arbitration, Article 47(1).

⁹⁰ For the list of relevant academic disciplines, see Order No. 236 of the Ministry of Justice of the Russian Federation dated 14 October 2016 "On Approval of the List of Academic Specialisations in Which at Least One Third of the Arbitrators Included in the Recommended List of Arbitrators of a Permanent Arbitral Institution Must Hold Academic Degrees".

⁹¹ Federal Law on Arbitration, Article 47(3).

⁹² Ibid.

⁹³ Under Article 119 of the Constitution of the Russian Federation, judges may be citizens of the Russian Federation who neither possess foreign citizenship nor hold a residence permit or other document evidencing a right to permanent residence in a foreign state.

⁹⁴ Federal Law on Arbitration, Article 47(2).

During our review of the websites of Russian arbitral institutions, we observed that, in addition to the recommended lists of arbitrators, they also maintain additional lists of arbitrators for international disputes and/or specific categories of disputes. This approach is not mandated by applicable Russian law and should therefore be regarded as an institutional initiative. We view positively the practice of ICAC, Arbitration Centre at RSPP, and RAC in introducing such additional (international and/or sector-specific) lists of arbitrators, as they expand the pool of potential arbitrators, including less experienced candidates, and enhance their visibility.

We analysed the gender composition of the lists of arbitrators maintained by Russian arbitral institutions in order to assess their balance. For the purposes of this analysis, we relied on united recommended lists of arbitrators (for MAC, RAC, and Arbitration Centre at RSPP), separate recommended lists for domestic and international disputes (for ICAC), or additional lists for international disputes that are not considered recommended lists within the meaning of Russian legislation (for RAC and Arbitration Centre at RSPP). The official names of the lists are provided in the footnotes, while for ease of reference in the illustrations we use the terms “united recommended” and “international”. The analysis below does not take into account additional (sector-specific) lists for particular categories of disputes.

An analysis of the lists published on the websites of the Russian arbitral institutions – ICAC,⁹⁵ MAC,⁹⁶ Arbitration Centre at RSPP,⁹⁷ and RAC⁹⁸ – indicates that female arbitrators represent less than half of the listed candidates.

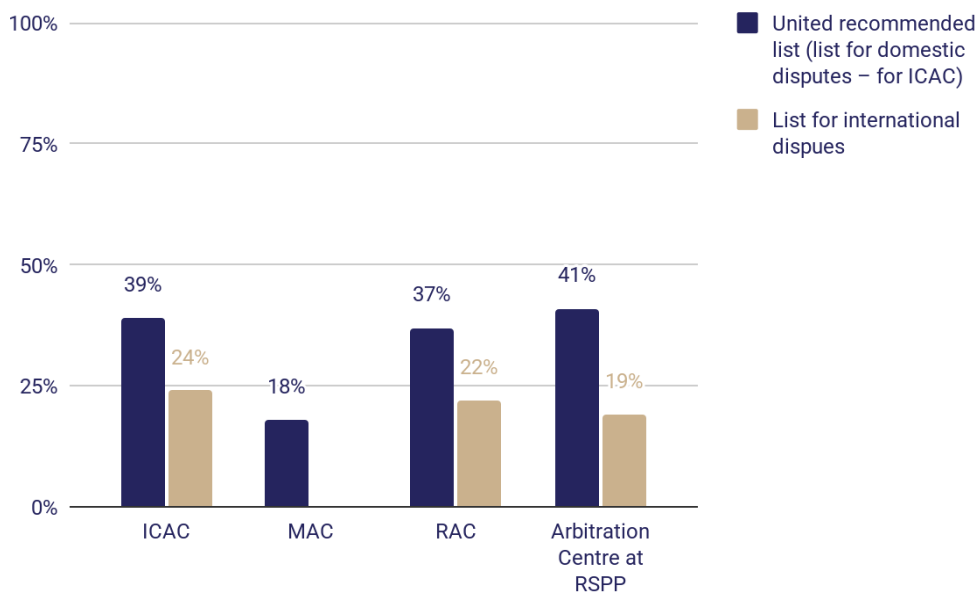
⁹⁵ The List of Arbitrators of ICAC for domestic disputes and the List of Arbitrators of ICAC for international commercial disputes can be found on the [website](#) (in Russian). The analysis is based on the list as of 1 May 2026.

⁹⁶ The United List of Arbitrators of MAC is available on the [website](#). The analysis is based on the list as of 1 May 2026.

⁹⁷ The Recommended List of Arbitrators of Arbitration Centre at RSPP is available on the [website](#). The composition of the International Disputes Panel of Arbitration Centre at RSPP is likewise available on the [website](#) (in Russian) (for the purposes of our calculations, we also included the Chair and Deputy Chair of the Panel). It should be noted that the composition of the International Disputes Panel differs in the English-language version of the [website](#). Although, for the purposes of this analysis, we rely on the Russian-language version of the list, the proportion of women included therein does not differ materially from that in the English-language version (19% as compared with 18%). The analysis is based on the versions of these lists available as of 1 May 2026.

⁹⁸ The RAC United Recommended List of Arbitrators is available on the [website](#). For the purposes of this analysis, the version of the list approved by Resolution No. 04/2025 of the General Meeting of RIMA dated 17 November 2025 was used. The International Arbitration Database is also available on the [website](#). For the purposes of this analysis, the version of the database as of 1 May 2026 was used.

Figure 28. Percentage of Women in the Lists of Arbitrators of Russian Arbitral Institutions⁹⁹



The share of women is considerably lower in lists for international disputes than in united recommended lists. This may be due to the lower visibility of female arbitrators from other jurisdictions to Russian arbitral institutions. The comparatively high proportion of women in united recommended lists may further be explained by the legal requirement to include retired judges in those lists, in light of the fact that, traditionally, around two-thirds of judges in Russia are women.¹⁰⁰

The nationality of arbitrators included in the lists of Russian arbitral institutions is difficult to assess, as none of the lists analysed directly provides this information. However, ICAC and MAC include information on arbitrators' place of employment and education, as well as the languages they speak; RAC's lists provide information on place of employment, including the city and country in which the arbitrator practices, and Arbitration Centre at RSPP provides information on place of employment.

Based on an analysis of these data, the following preliminary conclusions can be drawn:

- fewer than 10% of the arbitrators included on the Russian arbitral institution's united recommended lists and the list of arbitrators for domestic disputes of ICAC are foreign arbitrators;
- in the lists of arbitrators for international disputes of ICAC and Arbitration Centre at RSPP, approximately 30–40% are foreign arbitrators, whereas in RAC's International Arbitration Database, approximately 90% of all arbitrators are foreign nationals.

Since the respondent law firms identified arbitral institutions' lists with a "user-friendly database" as one of the resources they rely on when selecting arbitrators, we note that RAC's website offers a sophisticated search tool covering all of its arbitrator lists. This tool allows users to search for arbitrators by specialisation, country, area of practice, and language proficiency, thereby facilitating the identification of suitable candidates for both domestic and international disputes.¹⁰¹ The website of ICAC likewise enables users to search for arbitrators based on the type of dispute and the relevant

⁹⁹ We analysed the gender balance in the lists of Russian PAIs based on the publicly available information published on the official websites of the PAIs as of 1 May 2026.

¹⁰⁰ See, for example, "Researchers Studied the Gender Composition of the Russian Judicial Community – 66% of Seats are Held by Women", *Pravo.ru*, 2016, available [here](#) (in Russian).

¹⁰¹ "Find an Arbitrator", RAC, available [here](#).

regional branch.¹⁰² Other Russian arbitral institutions, however, do not provide similarly detailed search tools with targeted filtering options.

This distinguishes the approach of Russian arbitral institutions from that of foreign ones, many of which have implemented advanced search and filtering functionalities.

- The SIAC website allows users to search for arbitrators by title or salutation, nationalit(ies) / geographical origin(s), primary practice location, and language(s).¹⁰³ Notably, in addition to its SIAC Panel of Arbitrators, SIAC maintains internal lists of less experienced arbitrators (i.e., SIAC List of Arbitrators and SIAC List of Rising Arbitrators), SIAC Emergency Arbitrator Panel, and SIAC's Specialist Panels (e.g., SIAC Specialist Panel of Arbitrators for Intellectual Property Disputes, SIAC Specialist Panel of Arbitrators for Restructuring and Insolvency Disputes).¹⁰⁴
- The HKIAC website enables searches based on nationality / geographical origin, jurisdiction of admission, place of residence, area of expertise, ADR skills, language, and gender.¹⁰⁵ Similarly to SIAC, apart from the HKIAC Panel of Arbitrators, HKIAC maintains the list of less experienced arbitrators (i.e., HKIAC List of Arbitrators), HKIAC Panel of Emergency Arbitrators as well as HKIAC Panel of Arbitrators for Intellectual Property Disputes and HKIAC Panel of Arbitrators for Financial Services Disputes.¹⁰⁶
- VIAC has implemented comparable search filters. Unlike the other institutions considered, however, VIAC also allows users to search for arbitrators by age, within a range of 25 to 80 years.¹⁰⁷
- ICC website provides a searchable database of arbitrators who have previously been appointed in ICC-administered cases, facilitating the identification of arbitrators with practical case experience.¹⁰⁸ These arbitrators can be searched by nationality, role within the arbitral tribunal, and method of appointment. In addition, certain national committees of ICC maintain their own arbitrator databases.¹⁰⁹

The difference in approach may be explained by the fact that each of the foreign arbitral institutions examined maintains a list comprising at least 850 arbitrators.¹¹⁰

Using these search filters, we identified a total of 45 Russian arbitrators included on the lists of the foreign arbitral institutions under study. Of these, 35 are listed as holding exclusively Russian nationality. The available data on age and gender further indicate that women account for 25% of the arbitrators on the HKIAC list, a figure broadly consistent with the proportion of women represented on the lists for international disputes maintained by Russian arbitral institutions.

Arbitral institutions' lists serve as an important point of reference when those institutions appoint arbitrators. The rules governing the operation of ICAC and MAC, for example, expressly provide that their respective nomination committees may appoint arbitrators only from the institutions'

¹⁰² "Arbitrators", ICAC, available [here](#) (only in Russian).

¹⁰³ "SIAC Panel of Arbitrators", SIAC, available [here](#).

¹⁰⁴ "Admission to SIAC Panel", SIAC, available [here](#). See also "Report of the Cross-institutional Task Force on Gender Diversity in Arbitral Appointments and Proceedings", ICCA, 2026, pp. 122–123, available [here](#).

¹⁰⁵ "Panel & List of Arbitrators", HKIAC, available [here](#).

¹⁰⁶ See "Report of the Cross-institutional Task Force on Gender Diversity in Arbitral Appointments and Proceedings", ICCA, 2026, pp. 122–123, available [here](#).

¹⁰⁷ "Arbitrator Search", VIAC, available [here](#).

¹⁰⁸ "ICC Arbitral Tribunals", ICC, available [here](#).

¹⁰⁹ See, for example, "ICC United Kingdom Arbitrator & ADR Database", ICC United Kingdom, available [here](#).

¹¹⁰ Foreign arbitral institutions do not distinguish in their lists between domestic and international disputes, as Russian arbitral institutions do.

recommended lists.¹¹¹ No similarly stringent restrictions exist in the rules of other Russian or foreign PAIs under study.

Against this background, we asked Russian arbitral institutions to indicate how many arbitrators appointed in domestic and international cases were included on their respective lists of arbitrators. Foreign arbitral institutions were asked an analogous question with respect to Russia-related disputes. Responses to this question were received from RAC and HKIAC.

The figures below show the percentage of arbitrators appointed in arbitral proceedings administered by RAC who were included in the United Recommended List of Arbitrators and in the Databases of Specialists (including the International Arbitration Database).¹¹² It should be taken into account that these categories are not mutually exclusive: the same appointed arbitrator may have been included both in the United Recommended List and in any of the Databases of Specialists. Some appointed arbitrators may not have been included in either list.

In domestic disputes administered by RAC, the share of appointed arbitrators included in the United Recommended List of Arbitrators has declined significantly. Over a five-year period, it has more than halved, falling from 85% to 33%. By contrast, the share of arbitrators from the Databases of Specialists has remained relatively stable, accounting for half or more of all appointed arbitrators. One possible explanation for this trend lies in the constraints of Russian legislation, which, as noted above, governs the composition of recommended lists of arbitrators and thereby limits the pool of individuals eligible for inclusion. At the same time, arbitral institutions, including RAC,¹¹³ are likely seeking to promote arbitration and broaden the pool of professionals with experience serving as arbitrators in disputes.

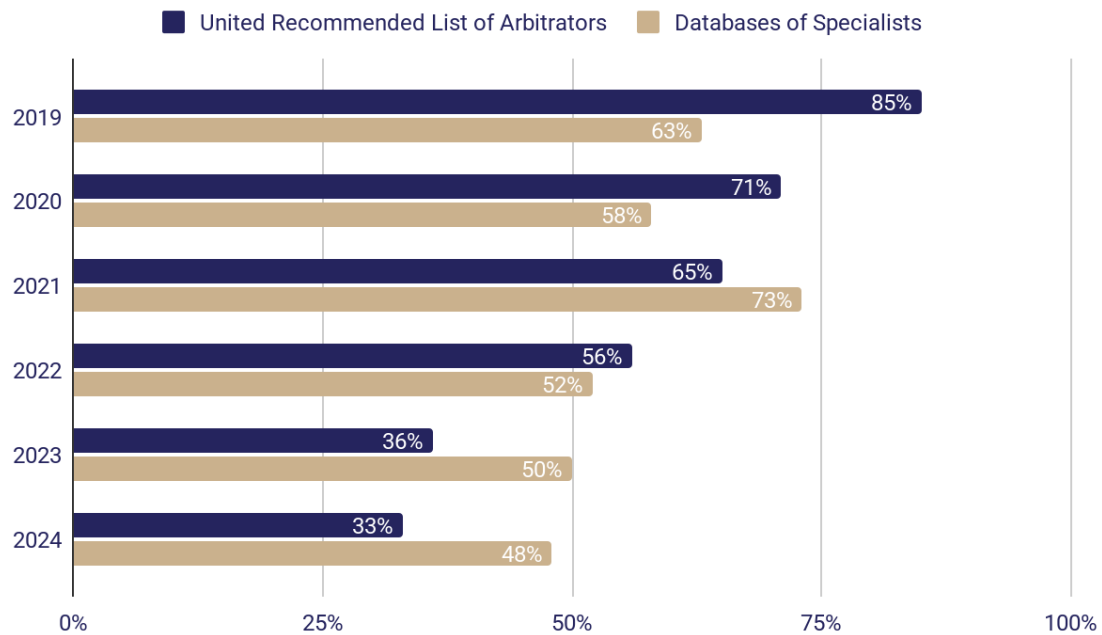
As a result, individuals who do not yet meet the requirements for inclusion in the recommended lists, but who possess the necessary expertise to adjudicate specific categories of disputes of varying complexity, are increasingly being appointed as arbitrators. This may partly explain the declining share of appointments from the United Recommended List of Arbitrators, the relatively stable proportion of appointments from the Databases of Specialists, and the presence of appointments of individuals included in neither of these lists.

¹¹¹ “Regulations on Organizational Principles of Activity of the ICAC”, ICAC, § 4(3), available [here](#); “Competence and Organizational Principles”, MAC, § 3(2), available [here](#).

¹¹² RAC also maintains the Databases of Specialists in the Field of Corporate, Financial, IP, IT, Transport and Aviation, Insurance, Real Estate and Construction Disputes.

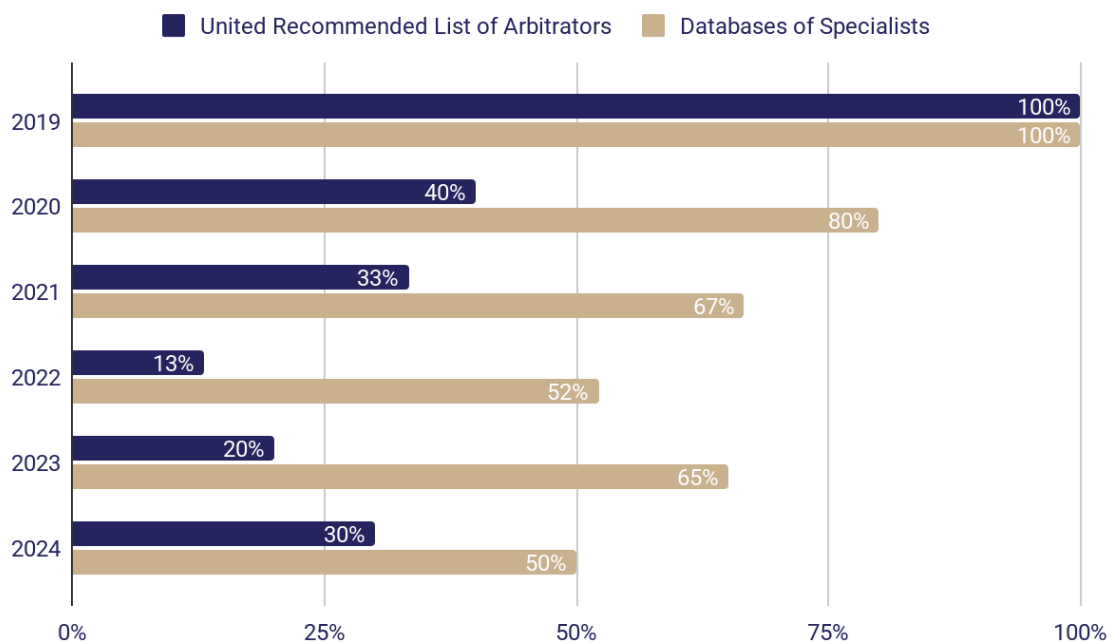
¹¹³ For example, since 2023, RAC has been running an Academy for Arbitrators – “an intensive practice-oriented course for experts wishing to be appointed as arbitrators in the future, as well as already experienced arbitrators who want to improve their knowledge and skills in arbitration”. More information about the Academy is available on the [website](#).

Figure 29. Share of Arbitrators Appointed from the Lists of Arbitrators in Domestic Disputes at RAC



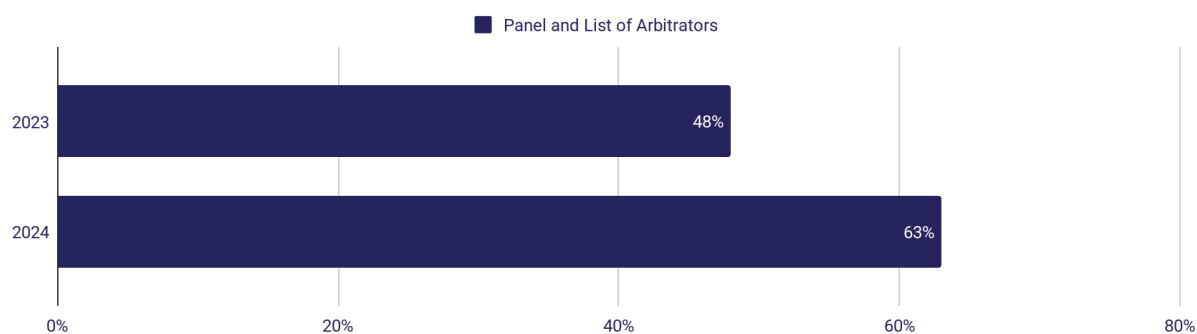
In international disputes, the share of appointed arbitrators included in the Databases of Specialists has generally remained high, averaging 69% over the period under study. By contrast, the share of arbitrators included in the United Recommended List of Arbitrators is significantly lower: since 2020, no more than 40% of arbitrators appointed in international disputes have been included in that list. This may be partly explained by the fact that the United Recommended List of Arbitrators contains only a small proportion of foreign arbitrators, as well as Russian arbitrators residing or practising abroad.

Figure 30. Share of Arbitrators Appointed from the Lists of Arbitrators in International Disputes at RAC



According to the HKIAC data for 2023–2024, nearly half of the arbitrators appointed in Russia-related disputes were included in the HKIAC lists of arbitrators.

Figure 31. Share of Arbitrators Appointed from the Lists of Arbitrators in Russia-Related Disputes at HKIAC



Accordingly, the data presented above suggest that arbitrator lists continue to serve as a significant tool in the constitution of arbitral tribunals.

2.2 STATISTICS OF ARBITRATOR APPOINTMENTS BY GENDER

We collected data from arbitral institutions on the gender of arbitrators appointed between 2019 and 2024 in both sole-arbitrator and three-member tribunals. Institutions were also asked, where possible, to indicate whether each arbitrator had been nominated and/or appointed by the parties, co-arbitrators, or the institution's appointing authority. Russian arbitral institutions were invited to provide separate data for domestic and international disputes, while foreign arbitral institutions were invited to provide data only in relation to Russia-related disputes.¹¹⁴

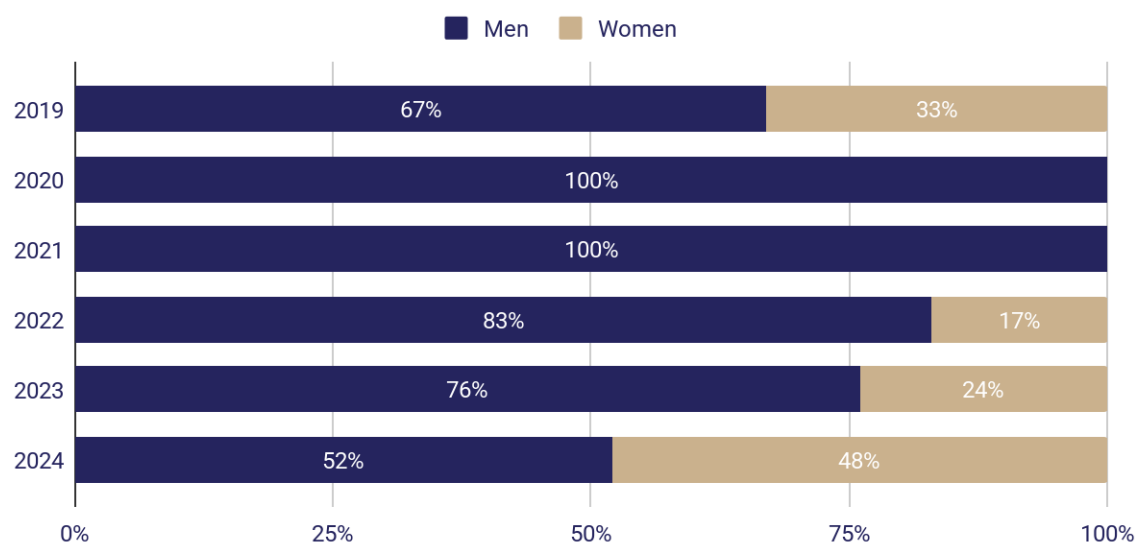
Where appropriate, we also relied on publicly available sources reflecting the broader approach adopted by Russian and foreign arbitral institutions to the appointment of arbitrators by gender.

2.2.1 Russian Arbitral Institutions

As part of the survey, RAC provided data on the appointment of female and male arbitrators in both domestic and international disputes administered under the RAC Arbitration Rules.¹¹⁵ In addition, we analysed publicly available data published on the website of Arbitration Centre at RSPP,¹¹⁶ as well as information provided by Arbitration Centre at RSPP and MAC for the 2021 RWA study.

The RAC data on domestic disputes indicate that three-member tribunals predominantly consisted of men, whereas appointments of sole arbitrators reflected a near-equal representation of women and men.

Figure 32. Gender of Arbitrators in Three-Member Tribunals in Domestic Disputes at RAC

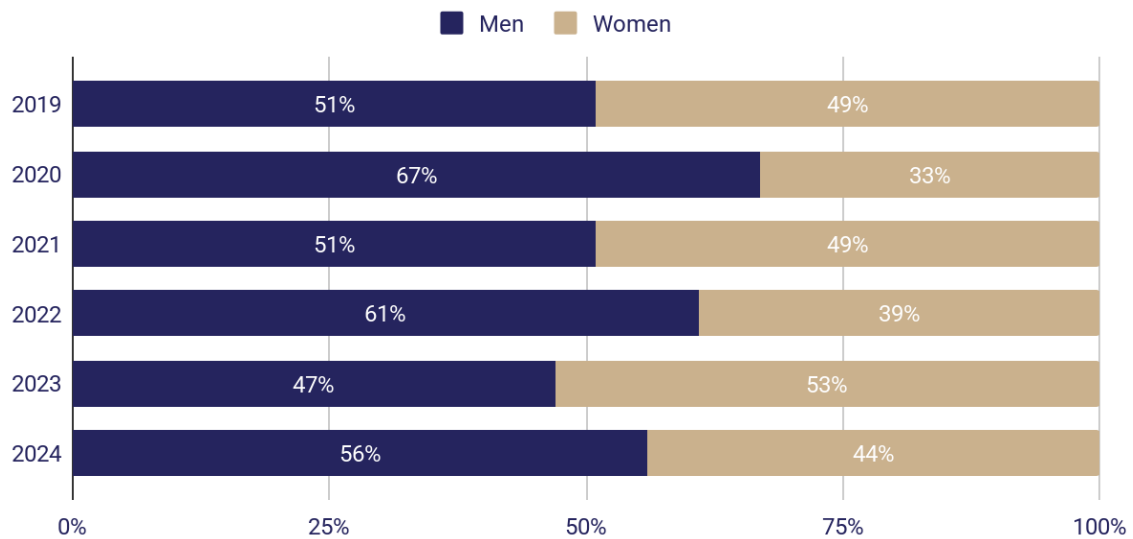


¹¹⁴ In questionnaires for foreign arbitration institutions, we introduced the concept of a "Russia-related dispute". Such a dispute was understood as an arbitration proceeding where at least one party is (a) a Russian party or (b) a party directly or indirectly owned or controlled by a Russian individual or an entity

¹¹⁵ The provided data did not include arbitration proceedings administered under the Rules of the Specialized Division for Disputes in Nuclear Field.

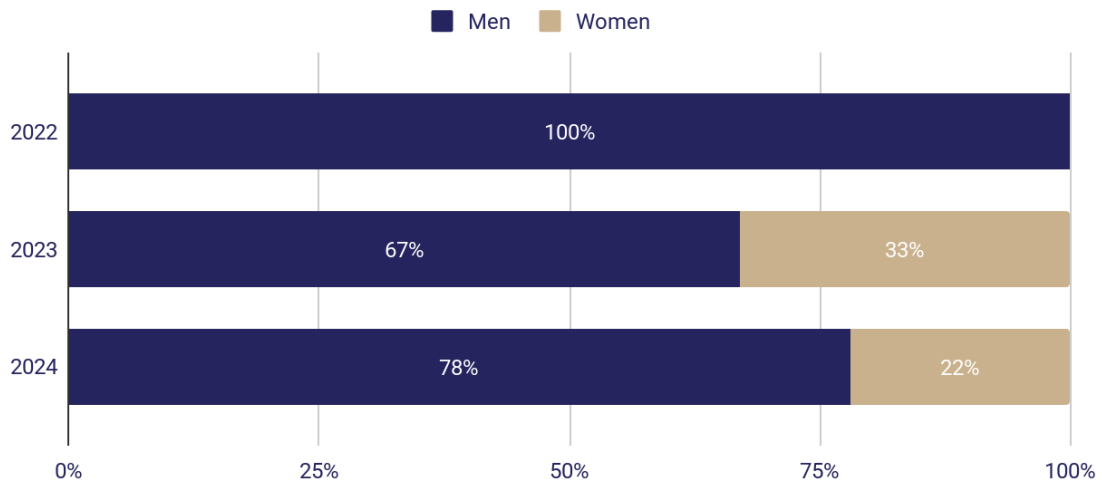
¹¹⁶ ICAC and MAC do not publish data on the gender of arbitrators.

Figure 33. Gender of Sole Arbitrators in Domestic Disputes at RAC



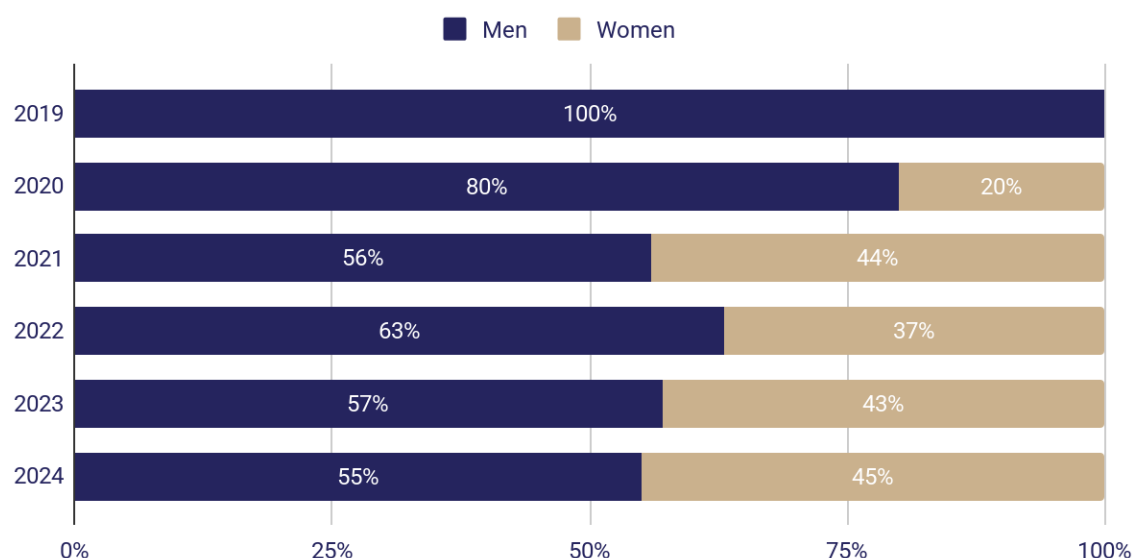
A similar trend is evident in the constitution of tribunals in international disputes. Throughout the period under study, male arbitrators accounted for the majority of appointments to three-member tribunals. By contrast, the proportion of female sole arbitrators was higher and, in certain years, reached 43–45%.

Figure 34. Gender of Arbitrators in Three-Member Tribunals in International Disputes at RAC¹¹⁷



¹¹⁷ The figure presents data for 2022–2024. Prior to 2022, RAC did not administer arbitration proceedings under the RAC International Arbitration Rules in which a three-member tribunal had been constituted.

Figure 35. Gender of Sole Arbitrators in International Disputes at RAC



Since sole arbitrators are more likely to be appointed by the arbitral institution in the absence of the parties' agreement, whereas parties tend to exercise their right to nominate co-arbitrators when a three-member tribunal is to be formed, it may be said that a significant share of female arbitrators during the period under study were appointed by the arbitral institution itself. According to the findings of the 2021 RWA study, between 70% and 90% of all appointments of female arbitrators were made by RAC. The responses provided by RAC for the purposes of the present study likewise indicate that 85% of women were appointed by the Board of RAC.

In an interview given to RWA as part of the InspoWoman project, the President of the Board of RAC, Yulia Mullina, noted that the RAC team, including the Board, actively seeks to promote the appointment of women as arbitrators and that many female arbitrators received their first arbitral appointments at RAC-administered arbitrations.¹¹⁸ This approach is also reflected in the RAC Guidelines on Appointment of Arbitrators, which expressly provide that gender diversity is taken into account when constituting tribunals.¹¹⁹

Overall, women represented approximately 41% of all arbitrators in arbitrations administered by RAC between 2019 and 2024, while men represented approximately 59%.

Based on the Annual Reports of Arbitration Centre at RSPP for 2021–2024,¹²⁰ as well as data for 2019–2020 provided by it for the purposes of the 2021 RWA study, it may be said that men represented, on average, 68% of arbitrators in proceedings administered by this institution.¹²¹

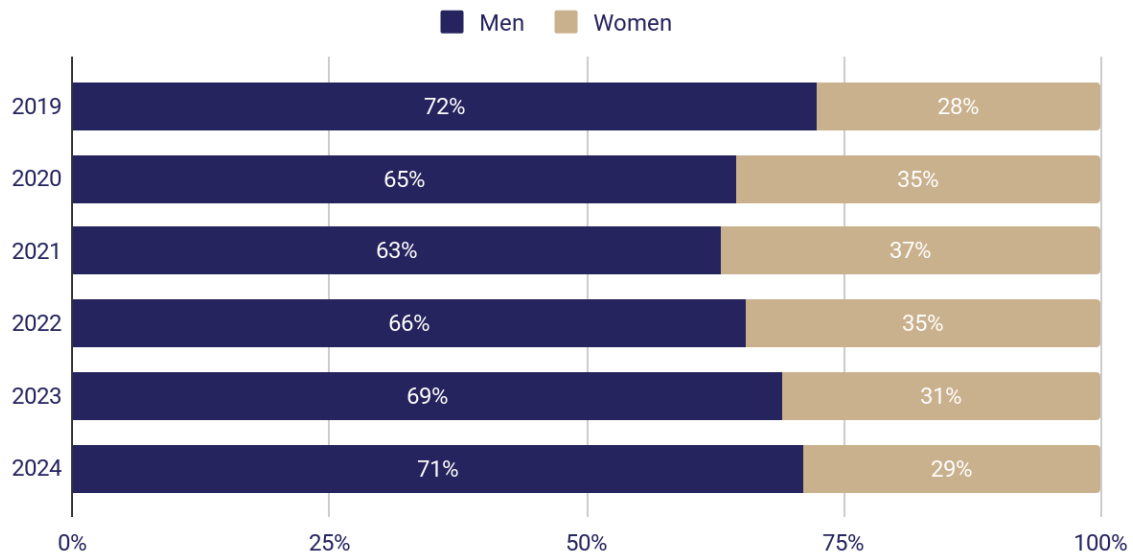
¹¹⁸ The interview is available [here](#).

¹¹⁹ RAC Guidelines on Appointment of Arbitrators 2022, para. 4(15), available [here](#).

¹²⁰ Casework Reports of the Arbitration Centre at RSPP are available [here](#).

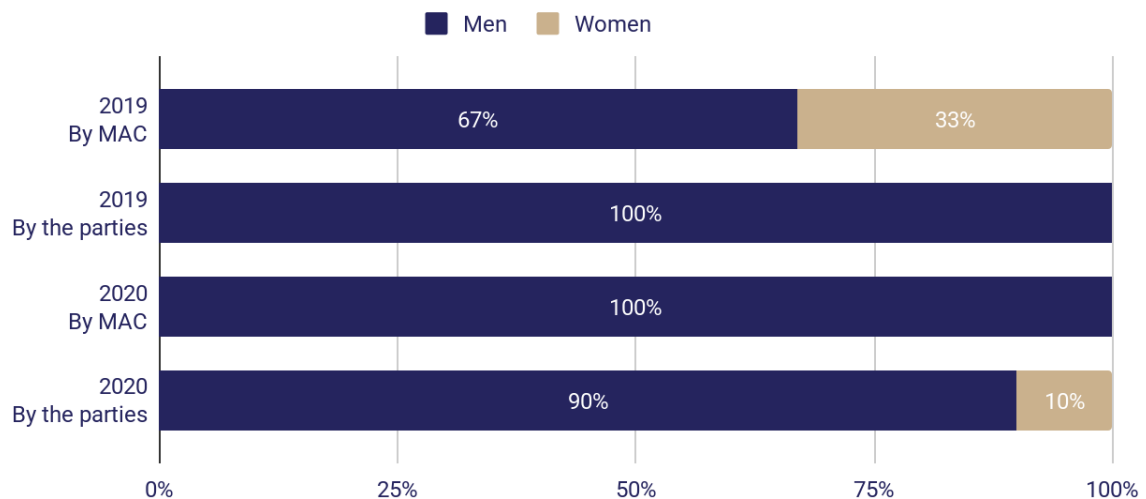
¹²¹ Arbitration Centre at RSPP does not publish and has not provided data on the gender of appointed arbitrators, broken down by international and domestic cases, or by the composition of the tribunal – sole arbitrator or three-member tribunal.

Figure 36. Gender of Appointed Arbitrators at Arbitration Centre at RSPP



MAC does not publish statistics on the gender of arbitrators. However, for the 2021 RWA study, MAC provided data for 2019–2020 on the gender of arbitrators appointed by the institution and by the parties. The data indicate that the majority of appointed arbitrators were men.

Figure 37. Gender of Appointed Arbitrators at MAC (Taking into Account the Appointment Procedure)



Therefore, men continue to constitute the overwhelming majority of arbitrators in both domestic and international disputes administered by Russian PAIs. The number of female arbitrator appointments appears to depend to a large extent on the efforts of arbitral institutions themselves, both in including women on lists of arbitrators to increase their visibility and in considering female candidates when making direct appointments of arbitrators.

2.2.2 Foreign Arbitral Institutions

Among foreign arbitral institutions, data on the gender of arbitrators were provided by HKIAC, VIAC, and ICC. Although Russia-related disputes were administered by both HKIAC¹²² and VIAC¹²³ throughout the entire period of 2019–2024 under study, the data submitted by these institutions as part of the survey covered only the years 2023–2024. ICC, in turn, provided data on Russian women appointed as arbitrators in ICC proceedings between 2019 and 2023. At the time of the survey, ICC's 2024 statistics had not yet been published, although it is now known that Russia-related disputes continued to be administered by ICC throughout the period under review.¹²⁴

The HKIAC data show that in Russia-related disputes, male arbitrators predominated in both sole-arbitrator and three-member tribunals. In three-member tribunals, the share of women was approximately 26–28%, while their representation was somewhat higher in sole-arbitrator cases, reaching 33%. These figures are broadly consistent with HKIAC's overall statistics on arbitrator appointments. According to the publicly available information, women accounted for 27% of all arbitrator appointments in 2023 and 2024. At the same time, the share of female arbitrators increased since 2019, when women represented only 20% of all appointments.¹²⁵

Figure 38. Gender of Three-Member Tribunals in Russia-Related Disputes at HKIAC

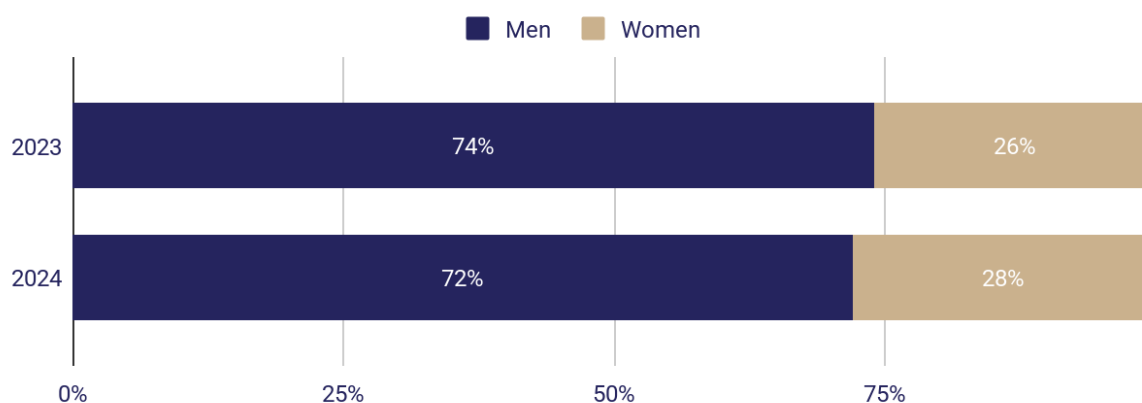
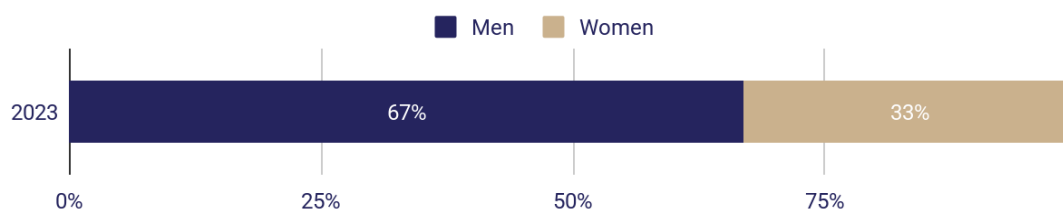


Figure 39. Gender of Sole Arbitrators in Russia-Related Disputes at HKIAC¹²⁶



¹²² "Statistics", HKIAC, available [here](#). Detailed information on the number of such disputes or the number of Russian parties involved in HKIAC proceedings is not available.

¹²³ According to published statistics, it is at least known that disputes initiated in 2019 involved four Russian parties, in 2020 one, in 2021 four, and in 2023 five. It is not known whether Russian parties were involved in disputes initiated in 2022 and 2024. See "2019 Statistics", VIAC, p. 1, available [here](#); "2020 Statistics", VIAC, p. 1, available [here](#); "2021 Statistics", VIAC, p. 1, available [here](#); "2022 Statistics", VIAC, p. 8, available [here](#); "2023 Statistics", VIAC, p. 16, available [here](#); "2024 Statistics", VIAC, p. 15, available [here](#).

¹²⁴ In its annual reports, ICC indicates the number of parties from Russia involved in disputes initiated in the relevant year. Over the period 2019–2024, the number of such Russian parties remained generally stable, ranging from nineteen to twenty-five, except in 2023, when forty-six Russian parties participated in ICC disputes. "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2019 Statistics", ICC, p. 23, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2020 Statistics", ICC, p. 26, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2021 Statistics", ICC, p. 21, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2022 Statistics", ICC, p. 23, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2023 Statistics", ICC, p. 25, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2024 Statistics", ICC, p. 26, available [here](#).

¹²⁵ "Statistics", HKIAC, available [here](#).

¹²⁶ In 2024, at HKIAC, there were no Russia-related cases in which a sole-arbitrator tribunal was constituted.

In 2023, all sole arbitrators in Russia-related disputes were appointed directly by HKIAC.

In three-member tribunals, arbitrators were appointed by the parties and co-arbitrators or directly by HKIAC. The data on appointments to three-member tribunals provided by HKIAC as part of this survey reveal the following trends:

- parties nominated male co-arbitrators approximately twice as often as female co-arbitrators;
- HKIAC appointed more male than female co-arbitrators directly, with men representing between 73% and 83% of such appointments;
- in 2023, co-arbitrators nominated an equal number of men and women as presiding arbitrators, whereas in 2024 no women were nominated for this role;
- the gender of presiding arbitrators appointed by HKIAC differed between the two years: in 2023, 67% of presiding arbitrators were men, while in 2024, 67% were women.

According to the publicly available VIAC statistics, men represented 63–66% of all arbitrators appointed in 2023–2024.¹²⁷ At the same time, women represented 52–64% of arbitrators appointed directly by VIAC across all cases, reflecting the institution's efforts to promote gender balance in the constitution of arbitral tribunals.¹²⁸ By contrast, parties predominantly appointed men, who made up 82–83% of all party appointments.¹²⁹

The VIAC data for 2023–2024 provided as part of the survey indicate that, in Russia-related disputes, all sole arbitrators appointed during the period under study were women, all of whom were appointed directly by VIAC. In three-member tribunals, by contrast, male arbitrators constituted the majority of appointments.

Figure 40. Gender of Three-Member Tribunals in Russia-Related Disputes at VIAC

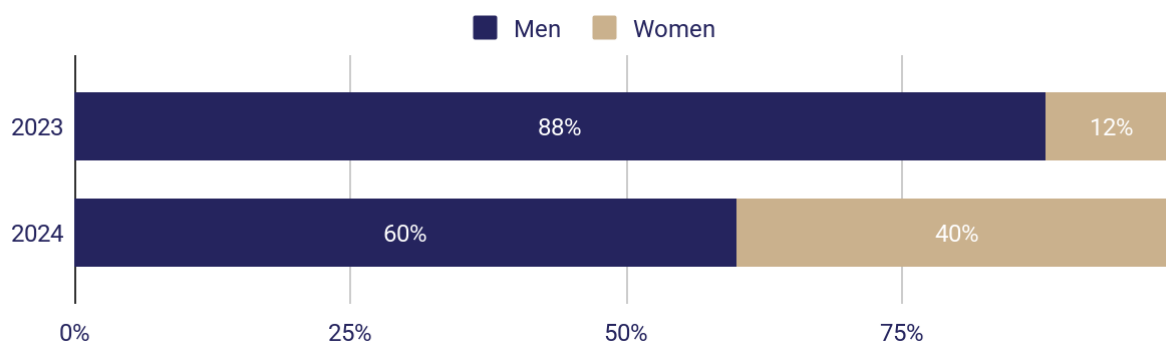
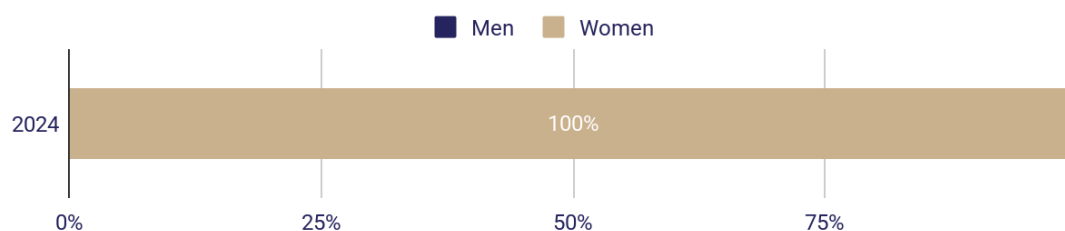


Figure 41. Gender of Sole Arbitrators in Russia-Related Disputes at VIAC¹³⁰



¹²⁷ "2023 Statistics", VIAC, p. 19, available [here](#); "2024 Statistics", VIAC, p. 19, available [here](#).

¹²⁸ "2023 Statistics", VIAC, p. 22, available [here](#); "2024 Statistics", VIAC, p. 22, available [here](#). See also "Report of the Cross-institutional Task Force on Gender Diversity in Arbitral Appointments and Proceedings", ICCA, 2026, p. 126, available [here](#).

¹²⁹ "2023 Statistics", VIAC, p. 20, available [here](#); "2024 Statistics", VIAC, p. 20, available [here](#).

¹³⁰ VIAC provided information only for 2024.

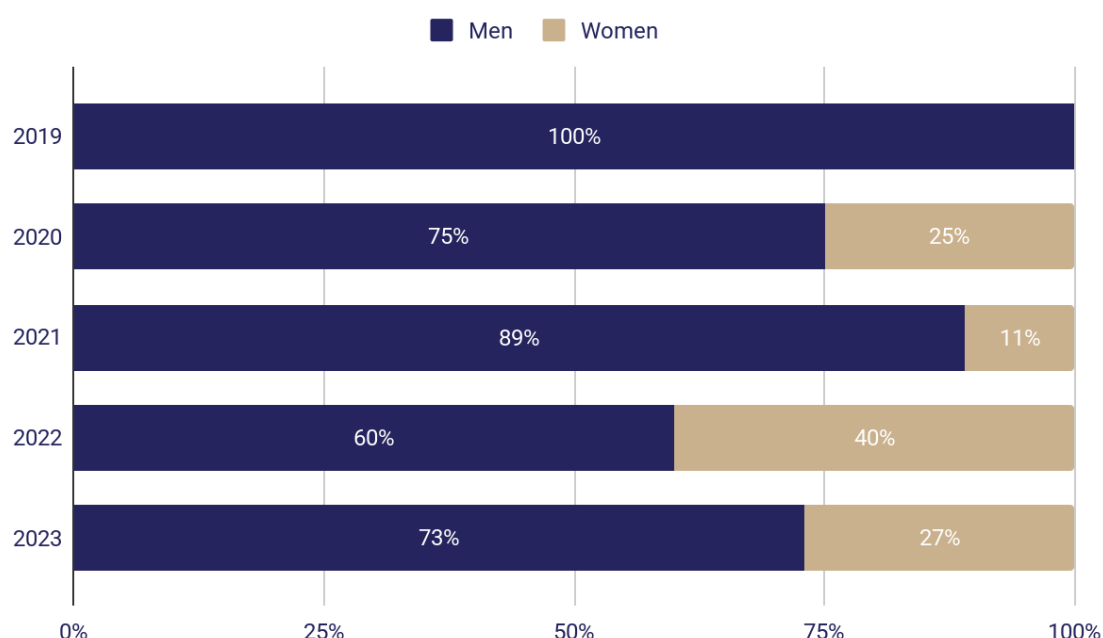
An analysis of the VIAC data on arbitrator appointments in three-member arbitral tribunals allows the following conclusions:

- in line with the general trend, the parties selected male arbitrators as co-arbitrators more often than female arbitrators;
- VIAC directly appointed an equal number of male and female arbitrators as co-arbitrators;
- co-arbitrators selected only male arbitrators as presiding arbitrators;
- VIAC directly appointed only male arbitrators as presiding arbitrators.

The ICC appointment statistics reflect the same general trend. The majority of arbitrators appointed in ICC cases between 2019 and 2024 were men. However, their share has been gradually declining: in 2019, male arbitrators accounted for 79%, whereas in 2024 this figure decreased to 71%.¹³¹ ICC is striving for gender balance in appointments: for example, in 2024 women accounted for 46% of ICC-appointed arbitrators, while men accounted for 54%.¹³²

As part of the survey, ICC provided data on the number of Russian women appointed as arbitrators in ICC-administered arbitration proceedings between 2019 and 2023, which we compared with the total number of Russian arbitrators appointed during the same period based on the published ICC statistical data.¹³³ Thus, unlike the HKIAC and VIAC data analysed above, the ICC data are not linked to Russia-related disputes. Nevertheless, the data indicate that Russian men were appointed as arbitrators in ICC proceedings significantly more often than Russian women, which generally corresponds to the appointment patterns observed in Russia-related disputes in other arbitral institutions.

Figure 42. Gender of Appointed Russian Arbitrators at ICC



¹³¹ "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2019 Statistics", ICC, p. 13, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2020 Statistics", ICC, p. 14, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2021 Statistics", ICC, p. 7, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2022 Statistics", ICC, p. 9, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2023 Statistics", ICC, p. 9, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2024 Statistics", ICC, p. 11, available [here](#).

¹³² "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2024 Statistics", ICC, p. 11, available [here](#).

¹³³ "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2019 Statistics", ICC, p. 25, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2020 Statistics", ICC, p. 28, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2021 Statistics", ICC, p. 23, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2022 Statistics", ICC, p. 21, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2023 Statistics", ICC, p. 25, available [here](#).

SIAC, in its annual reports, publishes only general information on the gender of arbitrators appointed by the institution. During the period under study, the overall share of female arbitrators appointed by SIAC remained broadly stable, ranging between 32% and 46% of all institution-appointed arbitrators.¹³⁴ It is known that SIAC is committed to promoting gender diversity: when appointing arbitrators, the Secretariat typically prepares a shortlist for the President of the SIAC Court of Arbitration, and this list includes at least one woman.¹³⁵

Therefore, due to the efforts of foreign arbitral institutions to promote gender equality, the number of women appointed as arbitrators has been gradually increasing. However, in all the arbitral institutions under study, male arbitrators nevertheless remain predominant. This is explained by the fact that parties more frequently appoint male arbitrators.¹³⁶ These trends are likewise reflected in Russia-related disputes.

¹³⁴ “Annual Report 2019”, SIAC, p. 19, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2020”, SIAC, p. 20, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2021”, SIAC, p. 24, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2022”, SIAC, p. 28, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2023”, SIAC, p. 42, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2024”, SIAC, p. 38, available [here](#).

¹³⁵ “Report of the Cross-institutional Task Force on Gender Diversity in Arbitral Appointments and Proceedings”, ICCA, 2026, p. 125, available [here](#).

¹³⁶ This is a global trend, which is also reflected in the practice of other arbitral institutions. See *ibid.*, pp. 36, 40.

2.3 STATISTICS OF ARBITRATOR APPOINTMENTS BY AGE

We note the challenges associated with collecting statistics on the age of arbitrators, an issue that was also highlighted in the 2021 International Arbitration Survey conducted by QMUL and White & Case.¹³⁷ The principal difficulties in collecting and analysing data on arbitrators' age stem from several factors. First, arbitral institutions may not maintain centralised records of arbitrators' age. As a result, the relevant data may either be unavailable or require additional, and often labour-intensive, processing. Second, the point in time at which an arbitrator's age is recorded is of considerable importance. Given that arbitral proceedings, particularly international ones, may continue for several years, the choice of such a reference point (for example, the date of appointment) has practical significance and affects the comparability of the data. Third, arbitral institutions may use different age categories when publishing statistical information. Taken together, these factors significantly limit the availability and accuracy of age-related statistics.

In light of these considerations, we requested from arbitral institutions statistics on arbitrator appointments across specified age ranges. For this purpose, the arbitrator's age at the time of appointment was taken into account, irrespective of the duration of the arbitral proceedings.

The age groups were structured as follows: (1) under 35, (2) 36–45, (3) 46–60, and (4) over 60.¹³⁸ These categories correspond to the age classification used in the questionnaires prepared for law firms (see [Section 1.4.2](#) above):

- the “under 35” and “36–45” categories indicate the number of appointments of young arbitrators;
- the “46–60” category encompasses arbitrators with more substantial practical experience;
- the “over 60” category allows for a separate analysis of the participation of the most experienced legal practitioners.

This classification ensures comparability with existing approaches in international practice and enables a more precise assessment of the distribution of appointments across different generations of arbitrators.

2.3.1 Russian Arbitral Institutions

First, it should be noted that Russian law provides that an arbitrator in a domestic dispute must be at least 25 years old.¹³⁹ By contrast, with respect to international disputes seated in Russia, the law does not impose any age-related requirements on arbitrators.

According to the information available on the websites of PAIs, only one Russian arbitral institution – RAC – publishes statistics on the age of appointed arbitrators. As part of this study, RAC also provided detailed statistics on arbitrator appointments by age for all periods under study. Accordingly, the analysis below is based solely on the RAC data, with separate consideration of domestic and international disputes.

In domestic disputes administered by RAC, the age distribution of arbitrators appears relatively balanced:

- the share of arbitrators under 35 ranges from 10% to 20% and shows moderate growth over time;

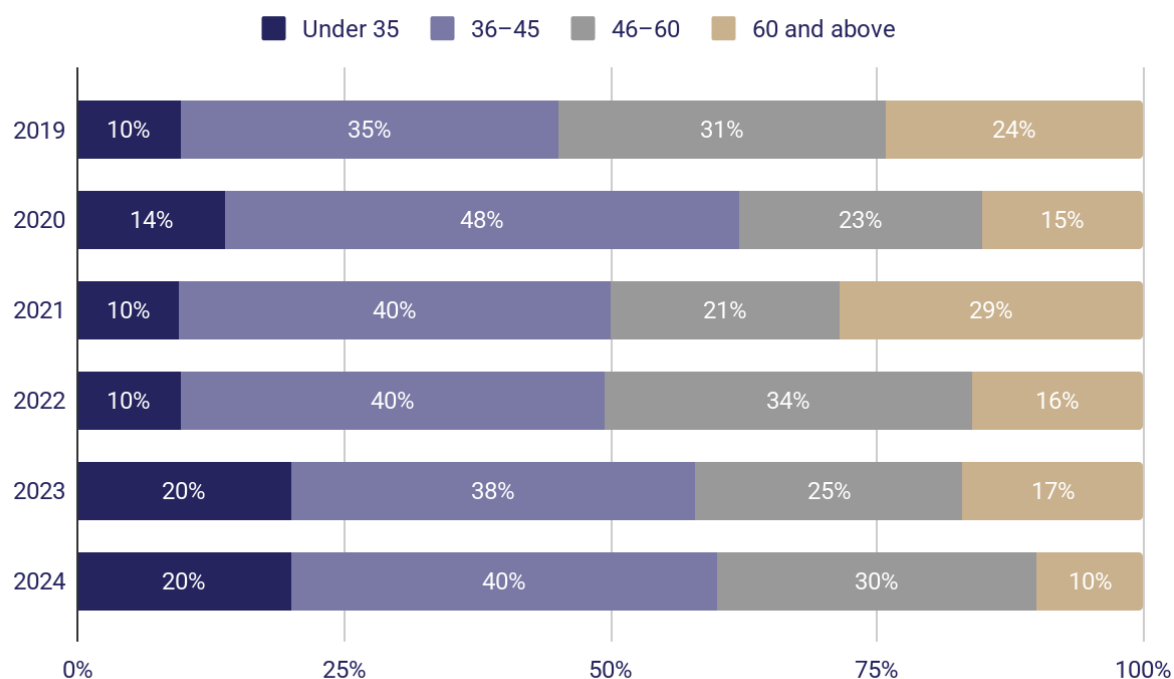
¹³⁷ “2021 International Arbitration Survey: Adapting arbitration to a changing world”, QMUL, White & Case, 2021, p. 16, available [here](#).

¹³⁸ In the questionnaires, the final age category was formulated as “60 and above”. We acknowledge that this wording may have resulted in an overlap with the preceding age range and, consequently, potential double counting of data. In this report, we rely on the data as provided by the respondents; however, for the sake of consistency, we use the formulation “over 60”.

¹³⁹ Federal Law on Arbitration, Article 11(8).

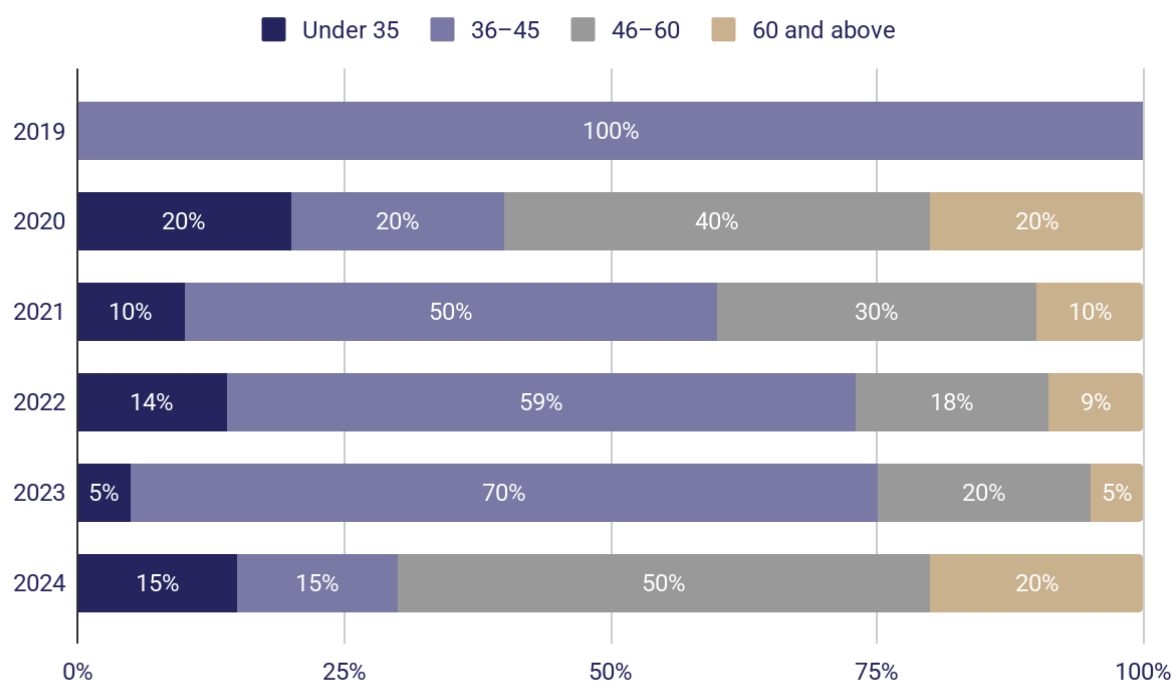
- arbitrators aged 36–45 consistently account for the largest share of appointments, serving as the principal age group;
- approximately one-third of appointed arbitrators during the period under study fall within the 46–60 age group, with no clear upward or downward trend;
- arbitrators over 60 represent the smallest share of appointments, which generally corresponds with the results of the law firm survey, according to which this age category is not the preferred choice for domestic disputes (see [Figure 19](#) above).

Figure 43. Age of Arbitrators Appointed in Domestic Disputes at RAC



In international disputes administered by RAC, the age of arbitrators fluctuates significantly from year to year. However, the data presented confirm that the 36–45 age group is the most frequently appointed, while arbitrators under 35 and over 60 are appointed considerably less often.

Figure 44. Age of Arbitrators Appointed in International Disputes at RAC



RIAC 2025 Highlight

Representatives of RAC who attended the event noted that the institution is prepared to consider the appointment of young arbitrators in disputes involving relatively modest amounts of claims, provided that such candidates have approximately ten years of experience in the legal profession.

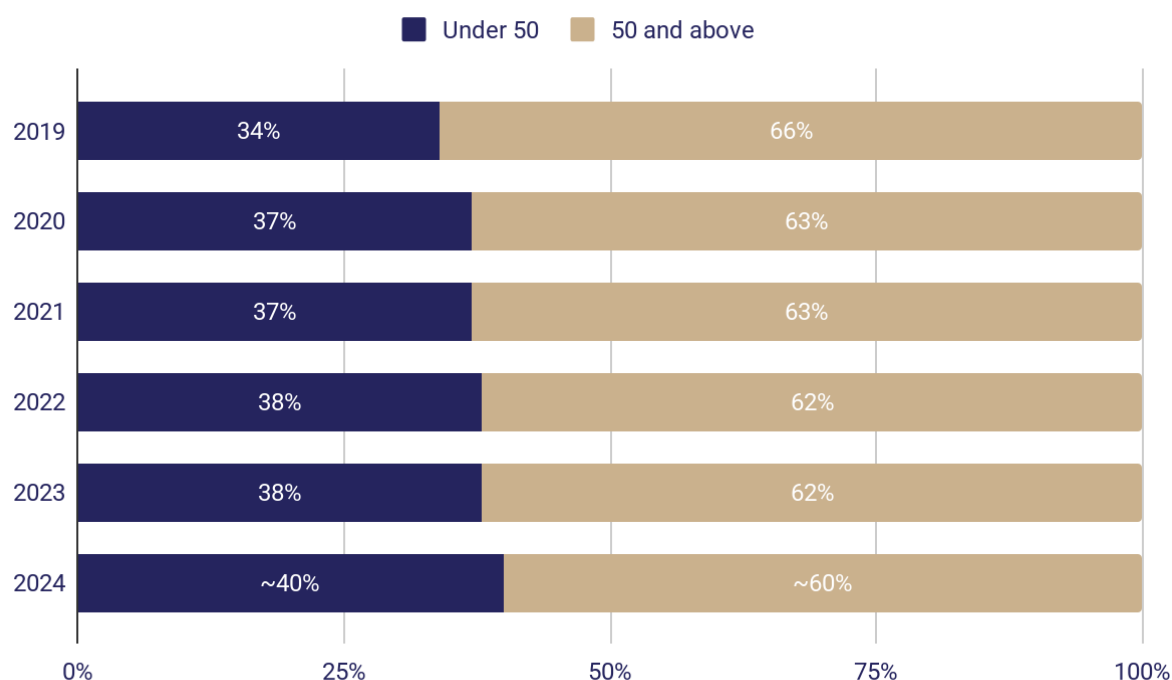
2.3.2 Foreign Arbitral Institutions

Two of the foreign arbitral institutions under study publish statistics on arbitrator appointments by age: ICC and VIAC.¹⁴⁰

In its annual reports, ICC provides information on the overall percentage of appointed arbitrators under 50. Such arbitrators account for no more than 40% of all appointments.

¹⁴⁰ The analysis in this section is based on aggregate data, as arbitral institutions do not publish statistics broken down by arbitrators' nationality or statistics for Russia-related disputes.

Figure 45. Age of Appointed Arbitrators at ICC¹⁴¹



It also follows from the ICC reports that during the period under study the average age of all appointed arbitrators ranged from 55 to 57 years, while the average age of arbitrators appointed by the institution itself was lower, at approximately 50 years.¹⁴²

The ICC Note on the Proposal of Arbitrators states that, as a general rule, prior experience as an arbitrator in ICC cases is not a prerequisite for consideration as a prospective arbitrator. For cases of lower complexity, the ICC Committees and Groups may recommend for appointment individuals who have relevant arbitration experience, although not necessarily prior experience as an arbitrator. In such instances, the ICC Committees and Groups are encouraged to propose new and/or young arbitrators, as this may help the pool of prospective arbitrators in the professional community to grow.¹⁴³

Notwithstanding ICC's policy of expanding the pool of arbitrator candidates and including less experienced and young practitioners, the ICC appointment statistics confirm an overall trend toward the appointment of older arbitrators in international disputes, which account for the predominant share of ICC cases (no less than 70% in 2024¹⁴⁴).

VIAC, in turn, publishes more detailed information on the age of appointed arbitrators. The statistics of VIAC, which also administers predominantly international disputes (91% in 2024¹⁴⁵), for 2023 and 2024 confirm a trend toward the appointment of more senior and experienced arbitrators. At the same time, the data indicate that the 46–55 age group is most frequently appointed at VIAC.

¹⁴¹ The data are based on the publicly available ICC reports and are not linked to Russia-related disputes.

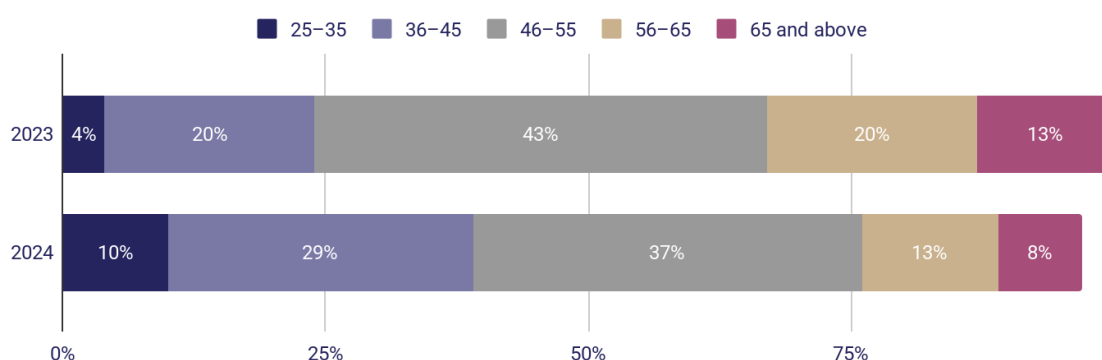
¹⁴² "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2019 Statistics", ICC, p. 14, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2020 Statistics", ICC, p. 15, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2021 Statistics", ICC, p. 10, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2022 Statistics", ICC, p. 10, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2023 Statistics", ICC, p. 10, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2024 Statistics", ICC, pp. 10–11, available [here](#).

¹⁴³ "Note to ICC National Committees and Groups on the Proposal of Arbitrators", 2022, para. 38, available [here](#).

¹⁴⁴ "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2024 Statistics", ICC, p. 4, available [here](#).

¹⁴⁵ "2023 Statistics", VIAC, p. 10, available [here](#); "2024 Statistics", VIAC, p. 9, available [here](#).

Figure 46. Age of Appointed Arbitrators at VIAC¹⁴⁶



Additionally, as part of the survey, VIAC indicated that, in 2024, the age of arbitrators in Russia-related disputes was not below 36, with the majority of appointments falling within the “46–60” and “over 60” age categories. Notably, more than half of the Russian law firm respondents identified arbitrators over 46 as the most suitable for international disputes with amounts in dispute exceeding USD 100 million (see [Figure 20](#) above).

It should also be noted that, similarly to ICC, VIAC seeks to support the appointment of young arbitrators. The former Secretary General of VIAC has stated that young arbitrators may be appointed in cases involving smaller amounts in dispute. According to her, “the younger generation of arbitrators are very diligent, efficient and deliver very good awards”.¹⁴⁷

HKIAC and SIAC do not publish data on the age of arbitrators. However, it is known that both arbitral institutions also support young and less experienced arbitrators and actively involve them in the professional community. In particular, in addition to maintaining lists of arbitrators with less stringent admission criteria,¹⁴⁸ both institutions host dedicated youth initiatives, namely HK45 and Young SIAC.¹⁴⁹ In the absence of published statistics on arbitrator appointments by age, it is difficult to assess the extent to which such initiatives contribute to expanding the pool of arbitrators and to the appointment of young and less experienced practitioners, at least in less complex disputes. The potential role of such institutional initiatives in promoting young arbitrators is discussed in the entry of Veronika Gorenitsa for the RWA Scholarship Programme.¹⁵⁰

¹⁴⁶ The data are based on the publicly available VIAC reports and are not linked to Russia-related disputes.

¹⁴⁷ “A Q&A with the Secretary General of the Vienna International Arbitral Centre”, VIAC, p. 2, available [here](#).

¹⁴⁸ HKIAC maintains the HKIAC List of Arbitrators (see [here](#)), while SIAC, apart from the SIAC List of Arbitrators, maintains the List of Rising Arbitrators (see [here](#)), for which prior experience as an arbitrator is not a mandatory requirement for inclusion.

¹⁴⁹ “HK45”, HKIAC, available [here](#); “About YSIAC”, SIAC, available [here](#).

¹⁵⁰ “RWA Scholarship for Arbitration Rising Stars 2025”, RWA, pp. 17–31, available [here](#) (in Russian).

2.4 STATISTICS OF ARBITRATOR APPOINTMENTS BY NATIONALITY

We requested statistical data from arbitral institutions on the nationality of arbitrators appointed in international disputes for the period of 2019–2024, distinguishing between Russian and foreign arbitrators, as well as data on the regions¹⁵¹ of origin of foreign arbitrators appointed during two separate periods: (1) 2019–2021 and (2) 2022–2024. Foreign arbitral institutions were asked to provide data solely in relation to Russia-related disputes.

By analogy with [Section 1.5](#), for the purposes of this study, Russian arbitrators are understood as Russian citizens, regardless of whether they reside or work in Russia or abroad,¹⁵² while foreign arbitrators are defined as citizens of other states, irrespective of their place of residence or employment.

Where an arbitral institution provided statistical data for individual years, only the data corresponding to the respective periods are presented below.¹⁵³

2.4.1 Russian Arbitral Institutions

Russian law on international commercial arbitration, as well as the arbitration rules of Russian arbitral institutions covered by this study, do not contain provisions on the nationality of arbitrators. In addition, the vast majority of Russian arbitral institutions do not publish data on the nationality of arbitrators appointed in cases administered by them.¹⁵⁴ Only the RAC Guidelines on Appointment of Arbitrators state that RAC takes into account the need to ensure “geographic diversity” when constituting arbitral tribunals.¹⁵⁵

Limited attention to this issue may be explained by the fact that the share of international disputes in the practice of Russian arbitral institutions is still lower than that of leading foreign arbitral institutions. According to the published reports for 2024, the share of international disputes among all cases administered by the relevant institutions is approximately 37% at ICAC,¹⁵⁶ approximately 17% at RAC,¹⁵⁷ and less than 5% at Arbitration Centre at RSPP.¹⁵⁸

As part of the survey, RAC provided information on arbitrators appointed in international disputes. Accordingly, the subsequent analysis is based on data from this arbitral institution.

In international disputes administered by RAC, Russian arbitrators predominate. However, in some years the ratio of Russian to foreign arbitrators has approached parity.

¹⁵¹ Arbitral institutions were asked to classify arbitrators by nationality into the following regional categories: (1) CIS; (2) the EU; (3) the UK; (4) North America; (5) Latin America; (6) Africa; (7) the Middle East; (8) East Asia (including China); (9) Southeast Asia; (10) South Asia (including India); (11) Australia; and (12) Other.

¹⁵² Regardless of whether the relevant Russian arbitrator holds a second or dual nationality. This study does not cover these issues.

¹⁵³ RAC provided data for the period 2019–2024, whereas HKIAC and VIAC provided data for the period 2023–2024.

¹⁵⁴ Information on foreign arbitrators can, for example, be found in the RAC reports for 2020–2023. See “RAC in Figures 2020”, RAC, p. 4, available [here](#); “RAC in Figures 2021”, RAC, p. 6, available [here](#); “RAC in Figures 2022”, RAC, p. 6, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2023”, RAC, p. 16, available [here](#).

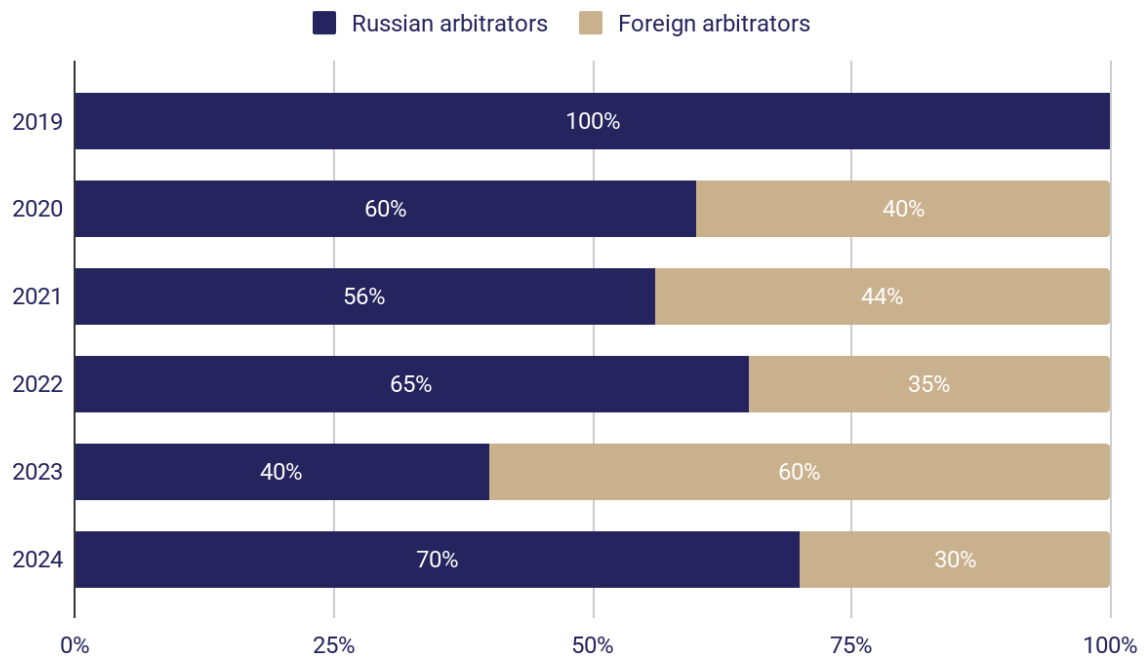
¹⁵⁵ RAC Guidelines on Appointment of Arbitrators 2022, para. 4(15), available [here](#).

¹⁵⁶ “Statistics”, ICAC, available [here](#).

¹⁵⁷ “Annual Report 2024”, RAC, available [here](#).

¹⁵⁸ “Annual Casework Report 2024”, Arbitration Centre at RSPP, p. 2, available [here](#).

Figure 47. Ratio of Russian and Foreign Arbitrators Appointed in International Disputes at RAC



The relatively high share of appointments of Russian arbitrators in international disputes may be explained by the fact that Russian arbitrators could have been appointed, for example, in international disputes between a Russian party and a foreign branch of a Russian company,¹⁵⁹ or between Russian parties where the place of performance of a substantial part of the obligations arising out of the parties' relationship, or the place with which the dispute is most closely connected, was located abroad.¹⁶⁰ In addition, the application of Russian law may also have been a factor in the selection of Russian arbitrators. According to the survey of Russian law firms, the presence of a Russian party and the application of Russian law are the main reasons for selecting Russian arbitrators for the resolution of international disputes (see [Figure 23](#) above).

During the period under study, the share of foreign arbitrators ranged from 30% to 60%, with a significant expansion in the geographic diversity of arbitrators after 2022. While in 2019–2021 appointments of foreign arbitrators were limited to the EU, the UK, North America, and East Asia, in 2022–2024 arbitrators from the CIS,¹⁶¹ Southeast Asia,¹⁶² and European countries outside the EU were also appointed.¹⁶³

¹⁵⁹ In cases where such a branch may be regarded as a place of business for the purposes of Article 1(3) of the Law of the Russian Federation No. 5338-I dated 7 July 1993 "On International Commercial Arbitration" ("**Law on ICA**").

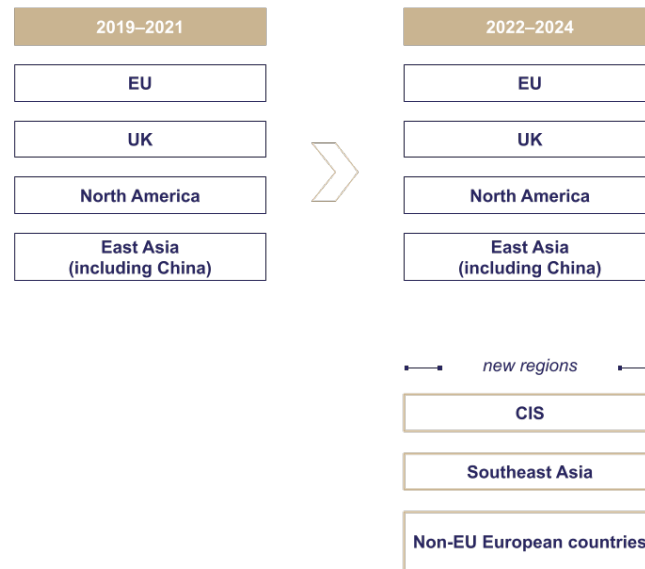
¹⁶⁰ Law on ICA, Article 3(1).

¹⁶¹ In particular, from Belarus, Kyrgyzstan, Uzbekistan and Kazakhstan. "RAC in Figures 2022", RAC, p. 6, available [here](#); "Annual Report 2023", RAC, p. 16, available [here](#).

¹⁶² In particular, from Singapore and Indonesia. See *ibid*.

¹⁶³ In particular, from Serbia. See *ibid*.

Figure 48. Regional Distribution of Foreign Arbitrators Appointed in International Disputes at RAC



These trends are consistent with the findings of the survey of Russian law firms regarding their approach to the appointment of arbitrators. As noted above, in the current geopolitical context, when appointing arbitrators in international disputes, Russian parties take into account issues of nationality, origin, and place of residence of arbitrators, including the “friendliness” of the jurisdiction in which an arbitrator lives or works. This has led to a noticeable increase in the appointment of Russian arbitrators, as well as, for example, arbitrators from Asia (see [Sections 1.2.2](#), [1.5.1](#) and [1.5.2](#) above).

2.4.2 Foreign Arbitral Institutions

All arbitral institutions under study address the issue of arbitrators’ nationality in one form or another in their arbitration rules or dedicated appointment guidelines.

In particular, the HKIAC Administered Arbitration Rules expressly provide that, as a general rule, a sole arbitrator or presiding arbitrator shall not have the same nationality as any party, unless the parties agreed otherwise.¹⁶⁴ This rule does not apply where both parties are of the same nationality.¹⁶⁵ An unofficial commentary to the HKIAC Rules notes that this provision reflects party expectations by ensuring that disputes are resolved by an arbitrator who is “culturally and politically neutral”.¹⁶⁶

The same commentary further states that, when appointing a party-nominated arbitrator, HKIAC may, by contrast, appoint an arbitrator “who shares the nationality and/or cultural background of the defaulting party or is familiar with the legal system and practice adopted in the place of the party”.¹⁶⁷ However, this practice is not formalised: neither the HKIAC Rules nor the HKIAC Practice Note on the Appointment of Arbitrators regulates the nationality of party-appointed arbitrators.¹⁶⁸

The HKIAC Policy on Proceedings Affected by Sanctions provides that, in such cases, HKIAC seeks to appoint as arbitrator a neutral individual who is not a national or resident of a country that is affected by the sanctions regime if that is prohibitive to his or her so acting.¹⁶⁹ Given the significant number of sanctions imposed on Russian persons and the popularity of HKIAC for the resolution of such

¹⁶⁴ HKIAC Administered Arbitration Rules 2024, Articles 11.2 and 11.3, available [here](#).

¹⁶⁵ *Ibid.*, Article 11.2.

¹⁶⁶ M. J. Moser, C. Bao, “A Guide to the HKIAC Arbitration Rules (2nd Edition)”, 2022, para. 7.164.

¹⁶⁷ *Ibid.*, para. 7.48.

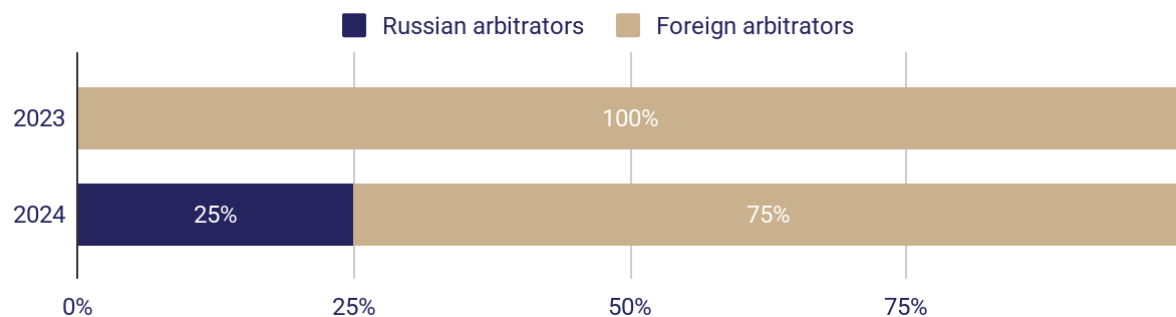
¹⁶⁸ HKIAC Administered Arbitration Rules 2024, Articles 11.2 and 11.3, available [here](#); “Practice Note on Appointment of Arbitrators”, HKIAC, 28 September 2021, Section 3, available [here](#).

¹⁶⁹ HKIAC Policy on Proceedings Affected by Sanctions, HKIAC, para. 3.3, available [here](#).

disputes,¹⁷⁰ it may be assumed that, in Russia-related cases affected by sanctions, HKIAC will seek to avoid appointing candidates from jurisdictions that restrict participation as arbitrators due to sanctions regimes.

Data provided by HKIAC for 2023–2024 as part of the survey demonstrate the predominance of foreign arbitrators in Russia-related disputes.

Figure 49. Nationality of Arbitrators Appointed in Russia-Related Disputes at HKIAC



It should be noted that we did not request from arbitral institutions, including HKIAC, statistical breakdowns distinguishing between sole arbitrators and three-member tribunals. It may reasonably be assumed that, in Russia-related disputes, foreign arbitral institutions appoint a sole arbitrator of a nationality different from that of the parties, which may exclude the appointment of Russian arbitrators in such cases. Where a Russian arbitrator is appointed by a party as co-arbitrator in a three-member tribunal in a Russia-related dispute, foreign arbitrators will in any event predominate on the tribunal, since the presiding arbitrator and the arbitrator appointed by the opposing party are unlikely to be Russian. This may partly explain the predominance of foreign arbitrators in Russia-related disputes.

According to the published HKIAC statistics, in 2024, Russian arbitrators accounted for 0.9% of all arbitrators appointed by HKIAC: they were appointed by the institution in two cases. At the same time, Russian arbitrators accounted for 5% of all party-appointed arbitrators: in this capacity, they were appointed in five cases.¹⁷¹ The published statistics also indicate that Russian law was applicable in a number of cases administered by HKIAC in 2024.¹⁷² This may have been one of the reasons for the appointment of Russian arbitrators (see [Sections 1.5.1](#) and [2.4.1](#) above).

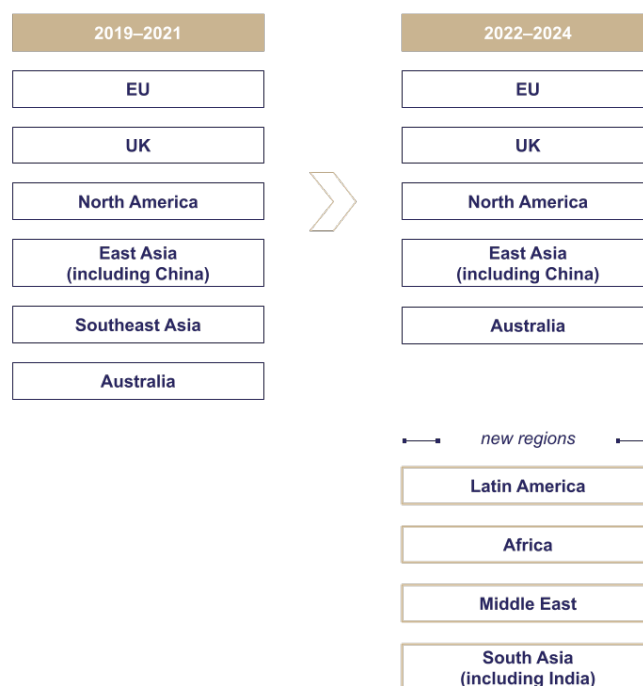
It is also important to note that the pool of foreign arbitrators appointed in Russia-related disputes at HKIAC expanded significantly after 2022. While maintaining the same regions as in the 2019–2021 period (Europe, the UK, North America, Australia and East Asia), arbitrators from other regions were also appointed in 2022–2024, including Latin America, Africa, the Middle East and South Asia – i.e. regions perceived by Russian parties as geopolitically “neutral” and in which “friendly” countries are prevalent (see [Section 1.5.2](#) above).

¹⁷⁰ See, for example, “10 Trends in International Arbitration: Findings from a Study of the International Commercial Arbitration (ICA) Market in Russia”, Pravo.ru, 2025, available [here](#) (in Russian).

¹⁷¹ “Statistics”, HKIAC, available [here](#).

¹⁷² Ibid.

Figure 50. Regional Distribution of Foreign Arbitrators Appointed in Russia-Related Disputes at HKIAC



The SIAC Rules contain, similarly to the HKIAC Administered Arbitration Rules, a general provision that in disputes between parties of different nationalities, the arbitrator shall be of a different nationality than the parties.¹⁷³ However, interestingly, unlike the approach of HKIAC, this rule may be overridden not only by agreement of the parties but also by a decision of the President of the SIAC Court of Arbitration, if she considers it appropriate in light of the circumstances of the case.

According to the SIAC annual reports, Russia-related disputes were heard at SIAC throughout the entire period of 2019–2024 under study.¹⁷⁴ At the same time, Russian arbitrators were appointed in SIAC cases only in 2019, 2020 and 2022: one arbitrator in each of those years.¹⁷⁵ This indicates that, as in HKIAC cases, Russia-related disputes are predominantly heard by foreign arbitrators. The small number of Russian arbitrators appointed in SIAC proceedings may be explained by the fact that none of the SIAC cases during the period under study were governed by Russian law.¹⁷⁶ It is likely that the aforementioned Russian arbitrators were appointed as co-arbitrators by Russian parties.

¹⁷³ This rule was introduced only in 2025. It is set out in Rule 19.7 of the SIAC Rules 2025, available [here](#). Prior to 2025, this approach was applied only to investor-state disputes governed by a specialised set of rules. See Rule 5.7 of the SIAC Investment Rules 2017, available [here](#).

¹⁷⁴ In disputes initiated in 2019, there were two parties that were Russian or controlled by Russian persons; in 2020, there were three; in 2021, fifteen; in 2022, seven; in 2023, twelve; and in 2024, twenty-six. “Annual Report 2019”, SIAC, p. 16, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2020”, SIAC, p. 18, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2021”, SIAC, p. 21, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2022”, SIAC, p. 25, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2023”, SIAC, p. 39, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2024”, SIAC, p. 34, available [here](#).

¹⁷⁵ “Annual Report 2019”, SIAC, p. 18, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2020”, SIAC, p. 20, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2022”, SIAC, p. 27, available [here](#).

¹⁷⁶ “Annual Report 2019”, SIAC, p. 21, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2020”, SIAC, p. 22, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2021”, SIAC, p. 26, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2022”, SIAC, p. 30, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2023”, SIAC, p. 44, available [here](#); “Annual Report 2024”, SIAC, p. 40, available [here](#).

RIAC 2025 Highlight

SIAC seeks to appoint neutral sole arbitrators and presiding arbitrators whose nationality differs from that of the parties. In cases involving Russian parties, the institution aims to appoint arbitrators who are perceived by the parties as neutral in the current geopolitical context.

ICC also takes into account an arbitrator's nationality and residence when confirming or appointing an arbitrator.¹⁷⁷ Similarly to HKIAC and SIAC, the ICC Arbitration Rules provide that the sole arbitrator and the presiding arbitrator appointed by ICC shall not be of the same nationality of any of the parties, unless such an appointment is appropriate in light of the circumstances of the case and neither party objects.¹⁷⁸ At the same time, an unofficial commentary on an earlier version of the ICC Rules indicates that ICC may be inclined to appoint an arbitrator of the same nationality as a party where that party has not exercised its right to nominate an arbitrator itself.¹⁷⁹

ICC has the National Committees and Groups that may participate in the appointment process by proposing arbitrator candidates.¹⁸⁰ These Committees typically propose candidates who are either nationals or residents of their respective countries.¹⁸¹ Once a year, the ICC Court discusses statistics regarding appointments of arbitrators with the nationality of the respective Committee.¹⁸²

Russian arbitrators were appointed in ICC cases every year between 2019 and 2024. While it is not possible to determine the exact ratio of Russian to foreign arbitrators in the Russia-related disputes at ICC, the available data suggest that foreign arbitrators predominate,¹⁸³ which is consistent with appointment patterns observed at other foreign arbitral institutions.

Most Russian arbitrators in ICC cases were party-appointed arbitrators. Russian arbitrators were appointed significantly less frequently as sole arbitrators, and only once did a Russian arbitrator serve as a presiding arbitrator, namely in 2020.¹⁸⁴ It is known that, at least in 2023 and 2024, Russian law was the governing law in several disputes,¹⁸⁵ while in 2020 and 2022 Russian was the language of the proceedings in three cases.¹⁸⁶ These factors may partly explain the appointment of Russian arbitrators.

¹⁷⁷ ICC Arbitration Rules 2026, Article 14(1), available [here](#).

¹⁷⁸ *Ibid.*, Articles 14(5)–(6). The same rule was in the ICC Arbitration Rules 2021.

¹⁷⁹ J. Grierson, A. van Hooft, "Arbitrating under the 2012 ICC Rules", 2012, p. 135.

¹⁸⁰ "National Committee Nomination Commissions", ICC, available [here](#).

¹⁸¹ "Note to ICC National Committees and Groups on the Proposal of Arbitrators", 2022, para. 42, available [here](#).

¹⁸² *Ibid.*, para. 9.

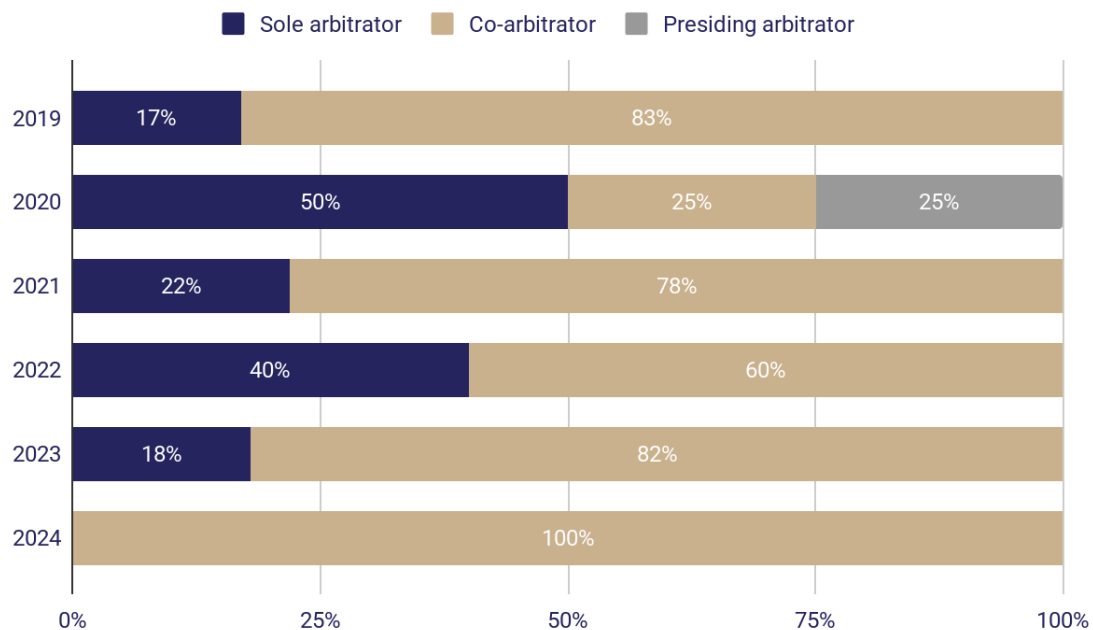
¹⁸³ "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2019 Statistics", ICC, p. 25, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2020 Statistics", ICC, p. 28, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2021 Statistics", ICC, p. 23, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2022 Statistics", ICC, p. 21, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2023 Statistics", ICC, p. 21, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2024 Statistics", ICC, p. 23, available [here](#).

¹⁸⁴ *Ibid.*

¹⁸⁵ "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2023 Statistics", ICC, p. 12, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2024 Statistics", ICC, p. 14, available [here](#). Before 2023, the ICC published data only on the most frequently chosen law applicable to the subject-matter of the dispute.

¹⁸⁶ "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2020 Statistics", ICC, p. 19, available [here](#); "ICC Dispute Resolution. 2022 Statistics", ICC, p. 13, available [here](#).

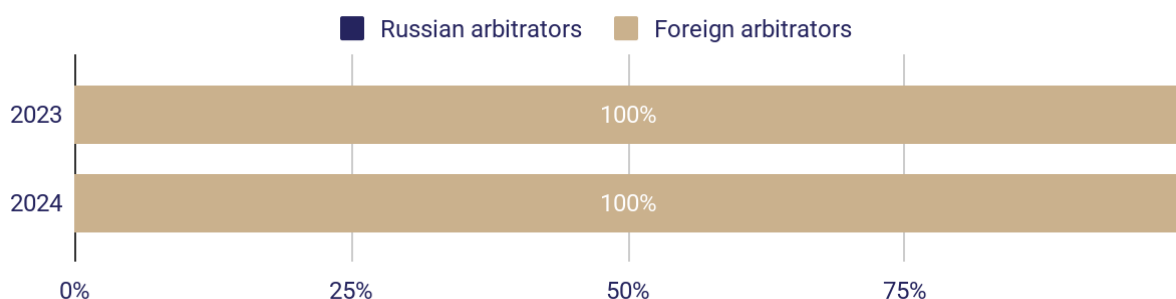
Figure 51. Procedure for Appointment of Russian Arbitrators at ICC¹⁸⁷



Unlike the other foreign arbitral institutions under study, the VIAC Arbitration Rules do not contain provisions governing an arbitrator's nationality: formally, any individual may be appointed as an arbitrator. However, the official VIAC Handbook clarifies that, in practice, the VIAC Board may take nationality into account when making appointments: as a rule, a "neutral" arbitrator – that is, an arbitrator whose nationality differs from that of the parties – is appointed as sole arbitrator or presiding arbitrator.¹⁸⁸ That is why the VIAC Arbitration Rules require parties to indicate their nationality when submitting written submissions.¹⁸⁹

Although VIAC administered Russia-related disputes throughout the entire period of 2019–2024, as part of the survey, VIAC provided statistics on the nationality of arbitrators appointed in Russia-related disputes only for 2023 and 2024. No Russian arbitrators were appointed in any such dispute during that period.

Figure 52. Nationality of Arbitrators Appointed in Russia-Related Disputes at VIAC



¹⁸⁷ The data are based on the publicly available ICC reports and are not linked to Russia-related disputes.

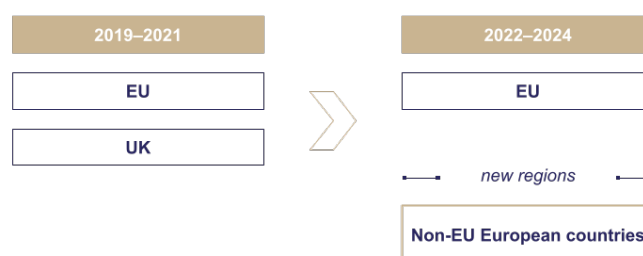
¹⁸⁸ Vienna International Arbitral Centre (VIAC) Secretariat (ed), "VIAC Handbook – Rules of Arbitration and Mediation: A Practitioner's Guide (Third Edition)" 2025, pp. 146–147.

¹⁸⁹ VIAC Arbitration Rules 2021, Articles 7(2.1) и 8(2.1), available [here](#). See also "VIAC Explanatory Notes Vienna Rules / Vienna Mediation Rules", VIAC, 2022, p. 19, available [here](#).

Published statistics for 2019–2022 likewise make no reference to Russian arbitrators. This suggests that, in disputes administered by VIAC, Russian parties are generally not inclined to appoint Russian arbitrators.

VIAC’s survey responses further indicate that, in Russia-related disputes, arbitrators from the EU and the UK were appointed between 2019 and 2021, whereas between 2022 and 2024 appointed arbitrators came from the EU and Switzerland.

Figure 53. Regional Distribution of Foreign Arbitrators Appointed in Russia-Related Disputes at VIAC



These findings are broadly consistent with VIAC’s overall appointment practice. Published statistics show that, between 2019 and 2024, arbitrators from regions outside Europe accounted for between 0% and 10% of all arbitrators appointed during the relevant period.¹⁹⁰ The majority of arbitrators were Austrian nationals.

Accordingly, VIAC’s appointment statistics demonstrate that Russian parties have not fully reoriented towards arbitrators from so-called “friendly” jurisdictions and, in certain cases, remain willing to appoint arbitrators from Europe (see also [Section 1.5.2](#) above).

Overall, the data support the conclusion that, in Russia-related disputes administered by foreign arbitral institutions, arbitrators are predominantly foreign nationals, while Russian arbitrators are appointed relatively rarely. In most cases, foreign arbitrators are nationals of Western states. However, since 2022 there has been a noticeable increase in the appointment of arbitrators from other regions.

¹⁹⁰ See “2019 Statistics”, VIAC, pp. 1–2, available [here](#); “2020 Statistics”, VIAC, p. 3, available [here](#); “2021 Statistics”, VIAC, p. 2, available [here](#); “2022 Statistics”, VIAC, p. 9, available [here](#); “2023 Statistics”, VIAC, pp. 17–18, available [here](#); “2024 Statistics”, VIAC, pp. 16–17, available [here](#).

STUDY METHODOLOGY

The RWA team conducted a preliminary study of the criteria applied in the selection and appointment of arbitrators and formed a pool of respondents, including law firms and arbitral institutions. In defining the scope of the study, we relied on both Russian and international sources. The study was not limited to gender issues and additionally covered questions relating to the age and nationality of arbitrators.

The selection of law firms was based on their experience in international arbitration and their recognition in Russian legal rankings, in particular the Pravo-300 and Kommersant rankings. When selecting arbitral institutions, consideration was given to whether they held the status of a PAI in Russia.¹⁹¹ In including Russian arbitral institutions in the study, account was taken of their PAI status as well as their function of administering international disputes throughout the entire period covered by the study. In including foreign arbitral institutions, consideration was given to their PAI status at the time of the survey (March 2025).¹⁹²

As part of the study, a questionnaire was developed for law firms ([Appendix 1](#)), as well as separate questionnaires for Russian and foreign arbitral institutions ([Appendix 2](#) and [Appendix 3](#)).

Law firms were asked questions concerning their practice over the period of 2019–2024. Given the significant changes that have occurred in the Russian legal market, firms were asked to respond based on the experience of their teams, regardless of changes in employment. Respondents were given the option to refrain from answering if the relevant questions did not reflect their practice or if disclosure of information could conflict with the interests of the firm or its clients.

The questionnaires for arbitral institutions were developed with regard to the statistical data that such institutions typically collect and publish. Arbitral institutions were asked to respond within the limits of the information available to them. The report includes only those data that were provided by the relevant arbitral institutions or derived from publicly available materials.

The questionnaires were sent to 38 law firms and 8 arbitral institutions. As a result, responses from 23 law firms and 4 arbitral institutions were analysed. This report is based on a comprehensive analysis of the collected questionnaires,¹⁹³ as well as external sources, including annual reports of arbitral institutions and published lists of arbitrators. References to the relevant external sources are provided throughout the report.

Certain findings were refined and adjusted following discussion of preliminary study results on approaches to arbitrator appointments by Russian law firms in international disputes at an event held on 16 May 2025 as part of RIAC.

The report includes figures that visually present respondents' answers or analysis of publicly available sources. Where respondents chose not to answer a question from the questionnaire, a footnote to the relevant figure indicates this, and the number of non-responses was not taken into account when preparing the figure and the accompanying analysis. If a figure was based exclusively on publicly available sources, this is also explicitly indicated in a footnote.

¹⁹¹ Up-to-date information on PAIs can be found on the [website](#) of the Ministry of Justice of the Russian Federation.

¹⁹² The Cairo Regional Centre for International Commercial Arbitration received PAI status on 21 May 2025, and the Dubai International Arbitration Centre – on 5 December 2025. The RWA team sent questionnaires to participants in February 2025; therefore, these arbitral institutions were not surveyed.

¹⁹³ Since information on specific arbitration disputes is confidential, the RWA team relied in good faith on the data provided by law firms and arbitral institutions and did not carry out additional verification of its accuracy.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

The RWA team expresses its sincere gratitude to all respondents who participated in the survey.

Among the law firm respondents (in alphabetical order):

- AkchurinaLegal
- ALUMNI Partners
- ALRUD
- Asari Legal
- Better Chance
- Brevia Law Offices
- CHERVETS.PARTNERS
- Denuo
- Dyakin, Gortsunyan and Partners
- E L W I
- EPAM Law
- Ivanyan and Partners
- KIAP
- Kucher Kuleshov Maximenko and Partners (KKMP)
- Kulkov, Kolotilov & Pokryshkin
- Mansors
- Monastyrsky, Zyuba, Stepanov & Partners
- NSP
- Olga Kokoz Legal
- Resolut
- Stonebridge Legal
- VERBA LEGAL
- Voskhod Law Firm

Among the arbitral institution respondents (in alphabetical order):

- Hong Kong International Arbitration Centre (HKIAC)
- ICC International Court of Arbitration (ICC)
- Russian Arbitration Center at the Russian Institute of Modern Arbitration (RAC)
- Vienna International Arbitral Centre (VIAC)

We also express our special gratitude to Ivanyan and Partners for organising the joint event “Who Is Appointed by Russian Parties? Key Insights from the Market Survey” for the presentation of the preliminary results of the study on 16 May 2025, as part of RIAC.¹⁹⁴

We further extend our gratitude to all attendees and participants of the discussion held on 16 May 2025. We highly value the interest shown in the subject of the study. The questions and comments from the audience helped refine certain findings and add new dimensions to the research.

We thank Pravo.ru for covering the event and publishing the preliminary results of the study.¹⁹⁵

¹⁹⁴ “Who Is Appointed by Russian Parties? Key Insights from the Market Survey”, RIAC, 2025, available [here](#).

¹⁹⁵ “Who Russian Parties Choose as Arbitrators: A Study”, Pravo.ru, 2 June 2025, available [here](#) (in Russian).

APPENDIX 1.

SAMPLE QUESTIONNAIRE FOR LAW FIRMS (ENGLISH TRANSLATION)

Questionnaire for Law Firms

Appointment of Arbitrators in Domestic and International Disputes

Introduction

Russian Women in Arbitration (RWA) is conducting a survey on the appointment of arbitrators in domestic and international disputes. The survey, *inter alia*, aims at collecting and consolidating information on the approaches to the selection and appointment of arbitrators that have developed in Russia, as well as identifying the significance of certain characteristics – gender, age, and nationality – in this process. The RWA team will prepare and publish a report summarising the findings of the survey.

Confidentiality

The information collected through this survey will only be accessible to the RWA team¹⁹⁶ and will not be disclosed to third parties. All data will be presented in an anonymised form. We plan to acknowledge the law firms that participated in the survey in the introduction to the final report. However, if you do not wish your firm's name to be included in the study materials, please let us know.

Instructions for completing the questionnaire

- All questions relate to domestic or international arbitration disputes.
- Most questions allow for one or more answer options. You may indicate your choice in any convenient way (e.g., bolding, italics, highlighting, underlining, etc.).
- For some questions, we ask you to provide detailed responses. Your views will be valuable for our research, and we would appreciate it if you could provide more detailed comments where possible. You may do so in any manner convenient to you.
- If a question refers to a specific time period (e.g., 2019–2024), we kindly ask you, where possible, to provide the most comprehensive answer based on your experience (or the experience of your team) over the stated period, regardless of any change in employment.
- If you have not been involved in any disputes referred to in a given question, you may skip it.
- If you believe that the answer to any question may be contrary to the interests of your firm and/or your clients, you may skip the question.
- Should you have any questions, please contact us by email: rwa.russianwomenarbitration@gmail.com.
- We would be very grateful if you could leave the details of a contact person we can contact at the end of the questionnaire if we have questions.

¹⁹⁶ Natalia Andreeva, Diana Aramian, Anna Avdulova, Elena Burova, Margarita Drobyshevskaya, Anastasiya Ryabova, and Polina Tulina.

Questions

Section 1. General questions about your arbitration practice

1. Please indicate the name of your firm: _____
2. Are there women in your firm's arbitration team?
 - a. Yes
 - b. No
3. If "yes", please indicate the approximate percentage of women in the team:

a. 10%	d. 40%	g. 70%	j. 100%
b. 20%	e. 50%	h. 80%	
c. 30%	f. 60%	i. 90%	
4. Please specify the approximate proportion of domestic and international disputes in your firm's practice (domestic disputes / international disputes):

a. 0% / 100%	d. 30% / 70%	g. 60% / 40%	j. 90% / 10%
b. 10% / 90%	e. 40% / 60%	h. 70% / 30%	k. 100% / 0%
c. 20% / 80%	f. 50% / 50%	i. 80% / 20%	
5. Please indicate which Russian arbitral institutions administered disputes in which your team acted as counsel between 2019 and 2024:
 - a. MAC
 - b. ICAC
 - c. RAC
 - d. Arbitration Centre at RSPP
 - e. Other: _____
6. Please indicate which foreign arbitral institutions administered disputes in which your team acted as counsel between 2019 and 2024:

a. CIETAC	d. ICC	g. PCA ¹⁹⁷	j. VIAC
b. DIAC	e. ICSID	h. SCC	k. Other:
c. HKIAC	f. LCIA	i. SIAC	_____
7. Please indicate the types of disputes in which your team acted as counsel between 2019 and 2024:

a. Commercial disputes	g. Investor-state disputes
b. Corporate disputes	h. IP disputes
c. Construction disputes	i. Other: _____
d. Energy disputes	
e. Banking disputes	
f. Maritime disputes	

¹⁹⁷ Individual functions related to the administration of arbitration.

Section 2. Your approach to the selection and appointment of arbitrators

8. Did your team participate in the selection and appointment¹⁹⁸ of arbitrators between 2019 and 2024?
 - a. Yes
 - b. No
9. If “yes”, please indicate the procedures for selection and appointment of arbitrators which your team used:
 - a. Agreeing on a list of potential arbitrators for inclusion in the arbitration clause
 - b. Nomination/appointment of a party-appointed arbitrator
 - c. Agreeing on the presiding arbitrator with the opposing party
 - d. Drawing up a shortlist of presiding arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure
 - e. Agreeing on the sole arbitrator with the opposing party
 - f. Drawing up a shortlist of sole arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure
 - g. Other: _____
10. Which criteria do you use when selecting arbitrators? Please select one or more of the characteristics below:
 - a. Gender
 - b. Age
 - c. Origin
 - d. Nationality (citizenship)
 - e. Education
 - f. Standing within the arbitration community
 - g. Qualification in the applicable law
 - h. Specialisation in the subject matter of the dispute
 - i. Academic experience
 - j. Prior experience with applicable institutional rules
 - k. Language
 - l. Place of residence
 - m. Peer recommendations
 - n. Prior experience as an arbitrator
 - o. Arbitrator workload
 - p. Client instructions
 - q. Statements at public events or on social media
 - r. Political views
 - s. Legal position on issues raised in the dispute
 - t. Prior experience as counsel or in-house lawyer
 - u. Membership in legal associations or professional communities
 - v. Your personal contact with the arbitrator candidate
 - w. Availability for a pre-appointment interview

¹⁹⁸ Direct appointment of an arbitrator or advising the client on a suitable arbitrator candidate.

- x. Other: _____
11. Please select the 5 most important characteristics of an arbitrator candidate listed in the question above that influence the likelihood of their appointment, and rank them from least important (1) to most important (5): _____
 12. Does your approach to identifying a candidate change depending on whether the dispute is international or domestic?
 - a. Yes
 - b. No
 13. If “yes”, please specify how your approach differs depending on the nature of the dispute: _____
 14. When selecting an arbitrator, do you prepare an internal shortlist of candidates with a detailed analysis of their experience?
 - a. Yes, always
 - b. No
 - c. Sometimes, depending on the size/nature of the dispute
 15. When preparing such a shortlist, do you consider the need to ensure diversity among candidates in terms of gender, age, or nationality?
 - a. Yes
 - b. No
 - c. Sometimes
 16. Please select the resources you use when searching for arbitrator candidates for domestic disputes:
 - a. List of arbitrators of the administering arbitral institution
 - b. List of arbitrators of another arbitral institution with a more user-friendly database
 - c. Guide to Next Generation of Russian Arbitrators
 - d. Legal rankings (e.g., Pravo-300, Forbes ranking, etc.)
 - e. Personal view of the legal market and suitable candidates
 - f. Peer recommendations
 - g. Internal arbitrator database maintained by the firm
 - h. Other: _____
 17. Please select the resources you use when searching for arbitrator candidates for international disputes:
 - a. List of arbitrators of the administering arbitral institution
 - b. List of arbitrators of another arbitral institution with a more user-friendly database
 - c. Arbitration Law’s Roster of International Arbitrators (Juris)
 - d. GAR’s Arbitrator Research Tool
 - e. International Arbitration Institute (IAI) Paris Database
 - f. Jus Connect
 - g. Kluwer Arbitration Profile Navigator
 - h. Ciarb Member Directory
 - i. MAXWELL CONNECTher
 - j. IAReporter

- k. Legal rankings (Legal 500, Best Lawyers, Chambers and Partners, IFLR 1000, etc.)
- l. Personal view of the legal market and suitable candidates
- m. Peer recommendations
- n. Internal arbitrator database maintained by the firm
- o. Other: _____

Section 3. Selection and appointment of female arbitrators

18. Did you propose female candidates as arbitrators in domestic disputes during the periods indicated?

2019–2021

- a. Yes
- b. No

2022–2024

- a. Yes
- b. No

19. In which selection and appointment procedures did you propose a female arbitrator candidate in domestic disputes? Please select one or more of the categories below:

- a. Agreeing on a list of potential arbitrators for inclusion in the arbitration clause
- b. Nomination/appointment of a party-appointed arbitrator
- c. Agreeing on the presiding arbitrator with the opposing party
- d. Drawing up a shortlist of presiding arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure
- e. Agreeing on the sole arbitrator with the opposing party
- f. Drawing up a shortlist of sole arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure
- g. Other: _____

20. In which categories of domestic disputes did you propose a female arbitrator candidate? Please select one or more of the categories below:

- | | |
|--------------------------|----------------------|
| a. Commercial disputes | f. Maritime disputes |
| b. Corporate disputes | g. IP disputes |
| c. Construction disputes | h. Other: _____ |
| d. Energy disputes | |
| e. Banking disputes | |

21. Did you nominate female candidates as arbitrators in international disputes during the periods indicated?

2019–2021

- a. Yes
- b. No

2022–2024

- a. Yes
- b. No

22. In which selection and appointment procedures did you propose a female arbitrator candidate in international disputes? Please select one or more of the categories below:

- a. Agreeing on a list of potential arbitrators for inclusion in the arbitration clause
- b. Nomination/appointment of a party-appointed arbitrator
- c. Agreeing on the presiding arbitrator with the opposing party
- d. Drawing up a shortlist of presiding arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure
- e. Agreeing on the sole arbitrator with the opposing party
- f. Drawing up a shortlist of sole arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure

- g. Other: _____
23. In which categories of international disputes did you propose a female arbitrator candidate? Please select one or more of the categories below:
- | | |
|--------------------------|----------------------------|
| a. Commercial disputes | g. Investor-state disputes |
| b. Corporate disputes | h. IP disputes |
| c. Construction disputes | i. Other: _____ |
| d. Energy disputes | |
| e. Banking disputes | |
| f. Maritime disputes | |
24. When searching for female arbitrators for international disputes, do you use any specialised resources for identifying female arbitrators (e.g., ArbitralWomen Member Directory, MAXWELL CONNEXTher, ERA Female Arbitrator Search, etc.)?
- a. Yes
b. No
25. Do you see a need for creating a similar database of Russian female arbitrators?
- a. Yes
b. No
26. Do you see any advantages in appointing female arbitrators?
- a. Yes
b. No, gender is not a relevant factor
27. If “yes”, please specify the advantages you perceive in female arbitrators: _____

Section 4. Selection and appointment of arbitrators taking into account their age

28. Would you appoint an arbitrator under 35 in a domestic dispute with the specified claim value? Please select one of the options below for each category:
- | Up to RUB 10 mln | Up to RUB 100 mln | Over RUB 100 mln |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| a. Yes | a. Yes | a. Yes |
| b. Rather yes | b. Rather yes | b. Rather yes |
| c. Rather no | c. Rather no | c. Rather no |
| d. No | d. No | d. No |
29. Would you appoint an arbitrator under 40 in an international dispute with the specified claim value? Please select one of the options below for each category:
- | Up to USD 10 mln | Up to USD 100 mln | Over USD 100 mln |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| a. Yes | a. Yes | a. Yes |
| b. Rather yes | b. Rather yes | b. Rather yes |
| c. Rather no | c. Rather no | c. Rather no |
| d. No | d. No | d. No |
30. Which age group of arbitrators do you consider most suitable for resolving a domestic dispute with the specified claim value? Please select one of the options below for each category:

- | | Up to RUB 10 mln | Up to RUB 100 mln | Over RUB 100 mln |
|----|-------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| a. | Under 35 | Under 35 | Under 35 |
| b. | 36–45 | 36–45 | 36–45 |
| c. | 46–60 | 46–60 | 46–60 |
| d. | 60 and above | 60 and above | 60 and above |
| e. | Does not matter | Does not matter | Does not matter |
31. Which age group of arbitrators do you consider most suitable for resolving an international dispute with the specified claim value? Please select one of the options below for each category:

- | | Up to USD 10 mln | Up to USD 100 mln | Over USD 100 mln |
|----|-------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| a. | Under 35 | Under 35 | Under 35 |
| b. | 36–45 | 36–45 | 36–45 |
| c. | 46–60 | 46–60 | 46–60 |
| d. | 60 and above | 60 and above | 60 and above |
| e. | Does not matter | Does not matter | Does not matter |

32. Do you see any advantages in appointing arbitrators under 35–40?
- Yes
 - No
33. If “yes”, please indicate the advantages that, in your view, arbitrators under 35–40 have:
- More time to resolve the dispute
 - More attentive approach to the substance of the dispute and the parties’ positions
 - Strict adherence to procedural deadlines
 - Strong technical skills
 - Experience as a tribunal secretary
 - Desire to establish oneself as an arbitrator
 - Willingness to act as an arbitrator for a modest fee
 - Other: _____

Section 5. Selection and appointment of arbitrators taking into account their nationality

34. Did you propose Russian arbitrator¹⁹⁹ candidates in international disputes during the periods indicated?

2019–2021

- Yes
- No

2022–2024

- Yes
- No

35. If “yes”, in which selection and appointment procedures did you propose a Russian arbitrator candidate in international disputes:
- Agreeing on a list of potential arbitrators for inclusion in the arbitration clause
 - Nomination/appointment of a party-appointed arbitrator
 - Agreeing on the presiding arbitrator with the opposing party
 - Drawing up a shortlist of presiding arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure
 - Agreeing on the sole arbitrator with the opposing party

¹⁹⁹ A Russian national working in Russia or abroad.

- f. Drawing up a shortlist of sole arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure
 - g. Other: _____
36. Please select the main reasons why you decided to propose a Russian arbitrator candidate in an international dispute:
- a. One of the parties is a Russian entity or is controlled by a Russian entity
 - b. Applicable Russian law
 - c. The dispute was administered by a Russian arbitral institution and/or the seat of arbitration was in Russia
 - d. The dispute is affected by sanctions
 - e. The arbitrator has international standing and substantial experience in international disputes
 - f. The arbitrator has qualification in foreign law
 - g. The arbitrator understands the specifics of doing business in Russia
 - h. The arbitrator is fluent in Russian
 - i. The arbitrator has experience working in foreign law firms
 - j. The arbitrator has a foreign education
 - k. The arbitrator has experience serving as tribunal secretary
 - l. Client instructions
 - m. Other: _____
37. Did you propose foreign arbitrator candidates in international disputes in 2019–2024?
- a. Yes
 - b. No
38. If “yes”, in which selection and appointment procedures did you propose a foreign arbitrator candidate in international disputes:
- a. Agreeing on a list of potential arbitrators for inclusion in the arbitration clause
 - b. Nomination/appointment of a party-appointed arbitrator
 - c. Agreeing on the presiding arbitrator with the opposing party
 - d. Drawing up a shortlist of presiding arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure
 - e. Agreeing on the sole arbitrator with the opposing party
 - f. Drawing up a shortlist of sole arbitrator candidates under a listing procedure
 - g. Other: _____
39. Please indicate the regions from which foreign arbitrators you proposed/appointed in international disputes during 2019–2021 were:
- a. CIS
 - b. EU
 - c. UK
 - d. North America
 - e. Latin America
 - f. Africa
 - g. Middle East
 - h. East Asia (including China)
 - i. South East Asia
 - j. South Asia (including India)
 - k. Australia
 - l. Other: _____

40. Please indicate the regions from which foreign arbitrators you proposed/appointed in international disputes during 2022–2024 were:

- | | |
|------------------|---------------------------------|
| a. CIS | g. Middle East |
| b. EU | h. East Asia (including China) |
| c. UK | i. South East Asia |
| d. North America | j. South Asia (including India) |
| e. Latin America | k. Australia |
| f. Africa | l. Other: _____ |

41. When selecting a foreign arbitrator in 2022–2024, did you take into account the “friendliness”²⁰⁰ of the jurisdiction in which the arbitrator resides or works, or of which they are a citizen?

Place of residence/work

- a. Yes
- b. No

Nationality

- a. Yes
- b. No

Section 6. Final questions

42. Please provide contact information of the person we can contact in case of questions:

²⁰⁰ Considering the list of foreign states approved by Decree of the Government of the Russian Federation No. 430-r dated 5 March 2022.

APPENDIX 2.

SAMPLE QUESTIONNAIRE FOR RUSSIAN ARBITRAL INSTITUTIONS (ENGLISH TRANSLATION)²⁰¹

Questionnaire for Arbitral Institutions registered as the Permanent Arbitral Institution (PAI) in the Russian Federation

Statistics on the Appointment of Arbitrators in Domestic and International Disputes

Introduction

[Russian Women in Arbitration \(RWA\)](#) is conducting a survey on the appointment of arbitrators in domestic and international disputes. The survey, *inter alia*, aims to collect and analyse data on the diversity of the composition of arbitral institution teams and of arbitrators appointed in domestic and international disputes by the parties, co-arbitrators, and appointing authorities of arbitral institutions. The RWA team will prepare and publish a report summarising the findings of the survey.

Confidentiality

The information collected through this survey will only be accessible to the RWA team.²⁰² We will not disclose the raw data to third parties.

Research Findings

Upon completion of the study, we will prepare and publish an analytical report indicating the participating PAIs and presenting the analysis of the information provided by them. In addition, the report will include an analysis of the survey results obtained from more than a dozen leading Russian law firms participating as respondents. We also plan to present and discuss the results at our event in May 2025, held during the [Russian International Arbitration Congress](#).²⁰³

Instructions for completing the questionnaire

- The majority of the questions require numerical responses. We would appreciate it if you could collect the statistical data for 2019–2024 necessary to answer our questions. You may complete the questionnaire in any format convenient to you, either electronic or paper. If completed in paper form, we kindly ask that you send us a scanned copy.
- When answering questions 1–6, please provide separate statistics on arbitrator appointments in domestic and international disputes.
- If you believe that the answer to any question may be contrary to the interests of the RAC or you do not collect the requested data (for example, on the age of arbitrators), you may leave a comment and skip the question. However, to ensure the quality of our research, we would appreciate it if you could complete the questionnaire as thoroughly as possible.
- Should you have any questions, please contact us by email: rwa.russianwomenarbitration@gmail.com.
- We would be very grateful if you could leave the details of a contact person we can contact at the end of the questionnaire if we have questions.

²⁰¹ **Note at the time of preparing the study:** Since only RAC participated in the survey, Appendix 2 provides, as an example, the questionnaire that was sent to RAC.

²⁰² Natalia Andreeva, Diana Aramian, Anna Avdulova, Elena Burova, Margarita Drobyshevskaya, Anastasiya Ryabova, and Polina Tulina.

²⁰³ More information about the event of Russian Women in Arbitration at RIAC available [here](#).

Questions

Section 1. Appointment of arbitrators (male and female) in a three-member tribunal

If the RAC is unable to collect all information requested in this section, we would appreciate it if you could complete as many columns as possible.

1. Please indicate the number of appointments of arbitrators (male and female) in a three-member tribunal in international disputes.

Arbitrator	Party-appointed arbitrators				Presiding arbitrators				All arbitrators	
Appointed by	Parties		Board ²⁰⁴		Co-arbitrators ²⁰⁵		Board		All appointments	
Year	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female
2019										
2020										
2021										
2022										
2023										
2024										

2. Please indicate the number of appointments of arbitrators (male and female) in a three-member tribunal in domestic disputes.

Arbitrator	Party-appointed arbitrators				Presiding arbitrators				All arbitrators	
Appointed by	Parties		Board ²⁰⁶		Co-arbitrators ²⁰⁷		Board		All appointments	
Year	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female
2019										
2020										
2021										
2022										
2023										
2024										

²⁰⁴ In cases where an arbitrator is appointed for a party by the Board.

²⁰⁵ In cases where the presiding arbitrator is appointed by arbitrators appointed by the parties.

²⁰⁶ In cases where an arbitrator is appointed for a party by the Board.

²⁰⁷ In cases where the presiding arbitrator is appointed by arbitrators appointed by the parties.

Section 2. Appointment of sole arbitrators

If the RAC is unable to collect all information requested in this section, we would appreciate it if you could complete as many columns as possible.

3. Please indicate the number of sole arbitrators (male and female) appointed in international disputes.

Appointed by	Parties		Board		All appointments	
Year	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female
2019						
2020						
2021						
2022						
2023						
2024						

4. Please indicate the number of sole arbitrators (male and female) appointed in domestic disputes.

Appointed by	Parties		Board		All appointments	
Year	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female
2019						
2020						
2021						
2022						
2023						
2024						

Section 3. Appointment of arbitrators from the recommended list

5. Please indicate the number of appointments of arbitrators (male and female) selected by the parties²⁰⁸ from the International Arbitration Database, the United Recommended List of Arbitrators, and the Databases of Specialists in specific categories of disputes (financial, corporate, etc.).

Where possible, please provide separate statistics on appointments from the United Recommended List of Arbitrators (URLA) and from the Databases of Specialists in specific categories of disputes (Databases of Specialists).

Type of disputes	International disputes		Domestic disputes	
Year	From the URLA	From the Databases of Specialists	From the URLA	From the Databases of Specialists
2019				
2020				
2021				
2022				
2023				
2024				

Section 4. Age of arbitrators appointed in domestic and international disputes

Please complete Section 4 if the RAC collects data on the age of arbitrators at the time of appointment.

6. Please indicate the number of arbitrators in each age group who were appointed in domestic and international disputes.

	International disputes				Domestic disputes			
Year	Under 35	36–45	46–60	60 and above	Under 35	36–45	46–60	60 and above
2019								
2020								
2021								

²⁰⁸ **Note at the time of preparing the study:** Despite the wording of the question, which implied providing information on the appointments of arbitrators chosen by the parties, as far as we understand, RAC provided data on the total number of appointments of arbitrators (men and women) from a United Recommended List of Arbitrators and Databases of Specialists in certain categories of disputes. The information provided did not distinguish between the arbitrators chosen by the parties and the arbitrators appointed by the arbitration institution itself. For this reason, the study uses information to the extent that it was provided by RAC.

2022								
2023								
2024								

Section 4. Nationality of arbitrators appointed in domestic and international disputes

7. Please indicate the number of Russian²⁰⁹ and foreign arbitrators appointed in international disputes.

Year	Russian nationality	Foreign nationality
2019		
2020		
2021		
2022		
2023		
2024		

8. Please indicate from which regions the foreign arbitrators appointed in international disputes during the indicated periods were:

2019–2021

- a. CIS
- b. EU
- c. UK
- d. North America
- e. Latin America
- f. Africa
- g. Middle East
- h. East Asia (including China)
- i. South East Asia
- j. South Asia (including India)
- k. Australia
- l. Other: _____

2022–2024

- a. CIS
- b. EU
- c. UK
- d. North America
- e. Latin America
- f. Africa
- g. Middle East
- h. East Asia (including China)
- i. South East Asia
- j. South Asia (including India)
- k. Australia
- l. Other: _____

²⁰⁹ A Russian national working in Russia or abroad.

Section 6. General questions on structure of the RAC

9. Please indicate the number of the acting members of the Board of the RAC: _____.
10. Please indicate the number of women among the acting members of the Board of the RAC: _____.
11. Are there any women in the Administrative Office of the RAC?
- a. Yes
 - b. No
12. If "yes", please indicate the approximate percentage of women in the Administrative Office of the RAC:
- | | |
|--------|---------|
| a. 10% | f. 60% |
| b. 20% | g. 70% |
| c. 30% | h. 80% |
| d. 40% | i. 90% |
| e. 50% | j. 100% |

Section 7. Final questions

13. Please provide contact information of the person we can contact in case of questions: _____

APPENDIX 3.

SAMPLE QUESTIONNAIRE FOR FOREIGN ARBITRAL INSTITUTIONS²¹⁰

Questionnaire for Arbitral Institutions registered as the Permanent Arbitral Institution (PAI) in the Russian Federation

Statistics on the Appointment of Arbitrators

Introduction

[Russian Women in Arbitration](#) (RWA) is conducting a survey on the appointment of arbitrators in domestic and international disputes. The survey, *inter alia*, aims to collect and analyse data on the diversity of arbitrators appointed in Russia-related disputes administered by the arbitral institutions registered as the PAIs in Russia. The RWA team will prepare and publish a report summarizing the findings of the survey.

Confidentiality

The information collected through this survey will only be accessible to the RWA team.²¹¹ We will not disclose the raw data to third parties.

Research Findings

The RWA team will prepare and publish an analytical report indicating the participating PAIs and presenting the analysis of the information provided by them. Both domestic and international PAIs were contacted to participate in this survey. The analytical report will also contain data from a solid number of Russian law firms approached by RWA to contribute to this research. We plan to present and discuss the results at our event in May 2025, held during the [Russian International Arbitration Congress](#).²¹²

Instructions for completing the questionnaire

- We kindly request that you provide the statistics on arbitrators' appointments in Russia-related disputes. The latter refers to disputes where at least one party is (a) a Russian party or (b) a party directly or indirectly owned or controlled by a Russian individual or an entity.
- Being mindful of the confidentiality concerns, we do not request a fixed number of appointments. Instead, in questions 1 to 5, we kindly request you to provide the proportion (in percent) of certain types of arbitrators out of the total number of appointments in the Russia-related cases.
- We would be grateful if you could collect the statistical data from 2019 to 2024 to answer our questions. Please indicate cases under all applicable arbitration rules and/or types of arbitral proceedings. You can fill out the questionnaire in any way that is convenient for you.
- If you believe that the answer to any question may be contrary to the interests of your arbitral institution or you do not collect the requested data (for example, on the age of arbitrators), you may leave a comment and skip the question.
- Should you have any questions, please contact us by email: rwa.russianwomenarbitration@gmail.com.
- We would be very grateful if you could leave the details of a contact person we can contact at the end of the questionnaire if we have questions.

²¹⁰ **Note at the time of preparing the study:** Appendix 3 provides a unified questionnaire that was sent to foreign arbitral institutions.

²¹¹ Natalia Andreeva, Diana Aramian, Anna Avdulova, Elena Burova, Margarita Drobyshevskaya, Anastasiya Ryabova, and Polina Tulina.

²¹² More information about the event of Russian Women in Arbitration at RIAC available [here](#).

Questionnaire

Section 1. Appointment of arbitrators (male and female) in a three-member arbitral tribunal

1. Please indicate the approximate percentage of the members of the arbitral tribunals (male and female) appointed in Russia-related disputes.

If you cannot collect all information under this question, we would be grateful if you could fill in the columns regarding “All Arbitrators”.

Year	Co-arbitrators nominated/appointed by ²¹³				Presiding Arbitrator nominated/appointed by				All Arbitrators	
	Parties		Appointing Authority		Co-arbitrators		Appointing Authority		Total Appointments	
	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female
2019										
2020										
2021										
2022										
2023										
2024										

Section 2. Appointment of sole arbitrators

2. Please indicate the approximate percentage of the sole arbitrators (male and female) appointed in the Russia-related disputes.

Appointed by	Parties ²¹⁴		Appointing Authority		Total Appointments	
Year	Male	Female	Male	Female	Male	Female
2019						
2020						
2021						
2022						
2023						
2024						

²¹³ In this question we refer to co-arbitrators/a presiding arbitrator nominated by the parties/co-arbitrators and appointed by the Appointing Authority.

²¹⁴ In this question we refer to a sole arbitrator nominated by the parties and appointed by the Appointing Authority.

Section 3. Appointments from the List

3. Please indicate the approximate percentage of the arbitrators included in the List/Base/Panel of Arbitrators and appointed in the Russia-related disputes.

Year	From the List/Base/Panel of Arbitrators
2019	
2020	
2021	
2022	
2023	
2024	

Section 4. Arbitrators' age

Please complete Section 4 if your arbitral institution collects data on the arbitrator's age at the time of its appointment.

4. Please indicate the approximate percentage of the arbitrators from each age group appointed in the Russia-related disputes.

Year	Under 35	36–45	46–60	Above 60
2019				
2020				
2021				
2022				
2023				
2024				

Section 5. Arbitrators' nationality

5. Please indicate the approximate percentage of the arbitrators (Russian²¹⁵ and foreign nationals) appointed in the Russia-related disputes.

Year	Russian nationals	Other nationals
2019		
2020		
2021		
2022		
2023		
2024		

6. Please indicate from which regions “other nationals” were appointed in the Russia-related disputes during the indicated periods:

2019–2021

- a. CIS
- b. EU
- c. UK
- d. North America
- e. Latin America
- f. Africa
- g. Middle East
- h. East Asia (including China)
- i. South East Asia
- j. South Asia (including India)
- k. Australia
- l. Other: _____

2022–2024

- a. CIS
- b. EU
- c. UK
- d. North America
- e. Latin America
- f. Africa
- g. Middle East
- h. East Asia (including China)
- i. South East Asia
- j. South Asia (including India)
- k. Australia
- l. Other: _____

²¹⁵

A Russian national working in Russia or in a foreign country.

Section 6. General questions on structure

7. Please indicate the number of the acting members of the [HKIAC Council/ICC International Court of Arbitration/SIAC Court of Arbitration/VIAC Board]: _____.
8. Please indicate the number of women among the acting members of the [HKIAC Council/ICC International Court of Arbitration/SIAC Court of Arbitration/VIAC Board]: _____.
9. Are there any women in the [HKIAC/ICC/SIAC/VIAC] Secretariat team?
 - a. Yes
 - b. No
10. If “yes”, please indicate the approximate percentage of women in the [HKIAC/ICC/SIAC/VIAC] Secretariat team:

a. 10%	f. 60%
b. 20%	g. 70%
c. 30%	h. 80%
d. 40%	i. 90%
e. 50%	j. 100%

Section 7. Final questions

11. Please provide contact information of the person we can contact in case of questions: _____

